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James Crystal.

AN

4-2
ABRIDGMENT

OF THE

CHRISTIAN DOCTRINE:

WITH

PROOFS OF SCRIPTURE

ON

POINTS CONTROVERTED.

BY WAY OF QUESTION AND ANSWER.

COMPOSED IN 1643,

BY REV. HENRY TUBERVILLE, D. D.

OF THE ENGLISH COLLEGE OF DOUAY:

NOW APPROVED AND RECOMMENDED FOR HIS DIOCESS, BY THE

RIGHT REV. BENEDICT,

BISHOP OF BOSTON.

"This is the way, walk ye in it."—*Isaiah* lxx. 4.

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1833.

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Estate of Rev Thomas Chrystal

April 6 '09

THE AUTHOR TO THE READER.

THE principal part of this Catechism is an Abridgment of the Christian Doctrine; defended and cleared by proofs of scripture, in points controverted between Catholics and Sectaries; and explained by the familiar way of question and answer.

To this, in the former impressions, was only adjoined a necessary exposition of the Mass, our Lady's Office, and the festival days of the year: but to this last edition is added, an Explanation of certain ceremonies of the Church, which now renders it more complete for instructing the ignorant, in the whole doctrine and discipline of the Catholic Church. Besides, I have corrected some false citations, and other errata, which by the printer's negligence, occurred in the former impressions.

Peruse it, good reader, with such charity as I have penned it, and if by its perusal thou shalt become more knowing in the law of Christ, and in practice more dutiful to God, and thy neighbour, it will abundantly recompense the labour of

Thy well-wishing friend,

And servant in CHRIST,

H. T.

APPROBATIO.

Cum Liber inscriptus, An Abridgment of the Christian Doctrine, &c. auctore viro docto H. T. mihi probe noto, in tertia Editione, quam non indiligenter perlegi, nihil contineat contra sanam Doctrinam vel bonos Mores; multa vero partim scitu necessaria, partim valde utilia, dilucide & succincte, in Fide Catholica instituentis proponat, dignum censeo qui ob publicam utilitatem Typis evulgetur.

Datum Duaci, Martii 11, 1649.

Gulielmus Hydeus, S. T. D., ac professor,
Colligii Anglorum Duacensis Præses
& Librorum Censor.



APPROBATION.

We feel pleasure in recommending to the faithful of our Diocess this edition of "An Abridgment of the Christian Doctrine, with proofs of Scripture, on points controverted," as we have found it essentially conformable to the Dublin edition of 1820, of the correctness of which we entertain no doubt.

✠ BENEDICT, *Bp. Bn.*

Boston, April 24th, 1833.

AN
ABRIDGMENT
OF THE
CHRISTIAN DOCTRINE, &c.

CHAP. I.

What a Christian is: And of the Blessed Trinity.

Quest. CHILD, what religion are you of?

Ans. Sir, by the benefit and grace of God, I am a Christian.

Q. Whom understand you by a Christian?

A. Him that inwardly believes and outwardly professes the law of Christ.

Q. When are we obliged to make an external profession of it?

A. As often as God's honour, our own, or neighbour's good requires it.

Q. How prove you that we are bound outwardly to profess our faith?

A. Out of St. Matt. x. 32, where Christ saith, Every one, therefore, that shall confess me before men, I will confess him before my Father who is in heaven. But he that shall deny me before men, I also will deny him before my Father who is in heaven.

Q. Are we bound also to venture the ruin of our estates, the loss of our friends, and to lay down our very lives for the profession and defence of our faith?

A. Doubtless we are: seeing the reward we expect in heaven, infinitely exceeds all the pleasures and punishments of this life. And because Christ the Son of the living God, has suffered far greater things for us, even to a disgraceful death on the cross? and therefore, it were base ingratitude in us, not to be ready to give our lives for him as often as his honour shall require it. Luke, xiv. 26, 33.

Q. In what doth the faith and law of Christ chiefly consist?

A. In two principal mysteries, namely, the unity and trinity of God, and the incarnation and death of our Saviour.

Q. What means the unity and trinity of God ?

A. It means, that in God there is but one only divine nature or essence, and that in the same one divine nature there are three persons, the Father, and the Son, and the Holy Ghost.

Q. How show you that ?

A. Out of 1 *John*, v. 7. There are three that give testimony in heaven, the Father, the Word, and the Holy Ghost, and these three are one.

Q. Why are there but three Persons only ?

A. Because the Father had no beginning, nor proceeds from any other person ; the Son proceeds from the Father, and the Holy Ghost proceeds from the Father and the Son.

Q. Why are these three Persons but one God ?

A. Because they have but one and the same essence or Godhead ; one power, one wisdom, one and the same goodness.

Q. What means the incarnation and death of our Saviour ?

A. It means that the second person of the blessed Trinity was made man, and died on the cross to save us

Q. In what are these two mysteries signified ?

A. In the sign of the cross, as it is made by Catholics for when we put our right hand to our head, saying, In the name, we signify Unity ; and when we make the sign of the cross, saying, Of the Father, and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost, we signify Trinity.

Q. How doth the sign of the cross represent the incarnation and death of our Saviour ?

A. By putting us in mind that he was made man and died upon the cross for us.

CHAP. II.

Faith Explained.

Q. *WHAT* is faith ?

A. *It is a gift of God, or a supernatural quality, in*

are fused by God into the soul, by which we firmly believe
our all those things which he hath any way revealed to us.

Q. Is faith necessary to salvation?

A. It is; St. Paul assuring that without faith it is im-
possible to please God. *Heb. xi. 6.* and *St. Mark, xvi.*
16, saying, He that believeth not shall be condemned.

Q. Why must we firmly believe matters of faith?

A. Because God hath revealed them, who can neither
deceive, nor be deceived.

A second reason is, because not only all points of
faith, but also the rule, or necessary and infallible means
whereby to know them, to wit, the church's oral and
universal tradition, are absolutely certain, and cannot
lead us into error in faith; else we can never sufficient-
ly be assured what is faith, or what is not.

Q. If a man should deny, or obstinately doubt of some
one point of faith, would he thereby lose his whole faith?

A. Yes, he would; because true faith must always
be entire, and he that fails in one, is made guilty of all,
by discrediting the authority of God revealing it.

Q. Is it not enough to believe all that is written in
the Bible?

A. No, it is not: For we must also believe all apos-
tolic tradition.

Q. How prove you that?

A. Out of *2 Thess. ii. 15.* Therefore brethren (saith
St. Paul) stand and hold ye the traditions which ye
have learned, whether by word, or by our Epistle.

Q. What other proof have you?

A. The apostle's Creed, which all are bound to be-
lieve, although it be not in Scripture.

Q. Is faith only, as excluding good works, sufficient
to salvation?

A. No: it is not: *St. James, ii. 24,* saying, Do you
see how that by works a man is justified, and not by
faith only? And *St. Paul,* saying, *1 Cor. xiii. 2.* If I
should have all faith, so that I could remove mountains,
and not have charity, I am nothing. And if I should
distribute all my goods to feed the poor, and if I should
deliver my body to be burned, and have not charity, it
profiteth me nothing.

Q. What faith will suffice to justify?

A. Faith working by charity in Jesus Christ.

Q. What vice is opposite to faith? A. Heresy.

Q. What is Heresy?

A. It is an obstinate error in things that are of faith.

Q. Is it a grievous sin?

A. A very grievous one, because it wholly divides a man from God, and leads to atheism, Christ saying, If he will not hear the church let him be to thee as an heathen and a publican, *Matt. xviii. 17.*

CHAP. III.

The Creed Expounded.

Q. WHAT is the creed?

A. It is the sum of belief.

Q. Who made it?

A. The twelve apostles.

Q. At what time did they make it?

A. Before they divided themselves into the several countries of the world to preach the Gospel.

Q. For what end did they make it?

A. That so they might be able to teach one and the same doctrine in all places.

Q. What doth the creed contain?

A. All those chief things which we are bound to believe, concerning God and his church.

Q. What is the first article of the creed?

A. I believe in God the Father Almighty, Creator of heaven and earth.

Q. What signifies I believe?

A. It signifies as much as I most firmly and undoubtedly hold.

Q. What means, I believe in God?

A. It means not only that I firmly believe there is a God, but also that I am piously affected to him, as to my chiefest good and last end, with confidence in him; or otherwise that I move unto him by faith, hope, and charity.

Q. What signifies the word Father?

A. It signifies the first person of the most blessed Trinity, who by nature is the Father of his own only begotten Son; the second Person of the blessed Trinity, by adoption is the Father of all good Christians; and by creation is the Father of all creatures.

Q. What means the word Almighty?

A. It means that God is able to do all things as he pleaseth; that he sees all things, knows all things, and governs all things.

Q. Why is he called Almighty in this place?

A. That we might doubt of nothing which follows.

Q. What signify the words, Creator of heaven and earth?

A. They signify that God made heaven and earth, and all creatures in them, of nothing, by his sole word, *Gen. i.*

Q. What moved God to make them?

A. His own mere goodness, that so he might communicate himself to angels, and to men, for whom he made all other creatures.

Q. When did God create the angels?

A. On the first day when he created heaven and earth, *Gen. i.* where Moses implies the creation of angels in the word heaven, and makes no other mention of it. The Nicene creed, interpreting the Apostles' Creed, says, that the words Creator of heaven and earth, mean all things visible and invisible.

Q. For what end did God create them?

A. To be partakers of his glory, and our guardians.

Q. How prove you by Scripture, that they be our guardians?

A. Out of *St. Matt. xviii. 10*, where Christ saith, 'See that you despise not one of these little ones: For I say unto you, their angels in heaven always see the face of my Father who is in heaven.'

Q. Do the angels know our necessities, and hear our prayers?

A. Doubtless they do, since God has deputed them to be our guardians: which is also proved out of *Zach. i. 12.* where an angel prays for two whole cities; the words are, 'Then the angel of the Lord answered and

said, O Lord of hosts, how long wilt thou not have mercy on the cities of Juda and Jerusalem, against which thou hast been angry these seventy years?’

Q. What Scripture have you for praying to angels ?

A. *Gen.* xlviii. 16, where Jacob on his death bed prayed to an angel for Ephraim and Manasses, saying, ‘The angel of the Lord that delivered me from all evils, bless these children.’

This place is cited for prayer to the angels in the notes of the Rhemish Testament upon it, and is confirmed to signify a created angel by St. Basil, lib. 3. cont. *Dunon.* sub initio: And St. Chrysosthom. 7. in laudem Sancti Pauli.

Q. How did Lucifer and his fellow angels fall from their dignity in heaven ?

A. By a rebellious sin of pride.

Q. With what shall their ruins be repaired ?

A. With holy men.

Q. When and to what likeness did God create man ?

A. On the sixth day, and to his own likeness: *Gen.* i. 27.

Q. In what doth the similitude consist ?

A. In this, that man is in his soul an incorporeal, intellectual and immortal spirit, as God is. And in this, that as in God there is but one most divine nature or essence, and yet three distinct Persons; so in man there is but one indivisible soul, and yet in that soul three distinct powers, will, memory, and understanding.

Q. How do you prove the soul to be immortal ?

A. Out of *Matt.* x. 28, where Christ saith, ‘Fear not them that kill the body, and cannot kill the soul.’

Q. What other proof have you ?

A. Out of *Eccles.* xii. 7. At our death the dust returns to the earth from whence it was, and the spirit to God that gave it.

Q. In what state did God create man ?

A. In the state of original justice, and perfection of all natural gifts.

Q. Do we owe much to God for our creation ?

A. *Very much*, seeing he made us in such perfect state, creating us for himself, and all things else for us.

Q. How did we lose original justice ?

A. By Adam's disobedience to God, in eating the forbidden fruit.

Q. In what state are we now born ?

A. In the state of original sin, and prone to actual sin, subject to death.

Q. How prove you that ?

A. Out of *Rom. v. 12.* 'By one man sin entered into the world, and by sin death; and so unto all men death did pass, in whom all have sinned.'

Q. Had man ever died, if he had never sinned ?

A. No, he had not, but had been converted by the tree of life, and been translated alive into the fellowship of the angels.

The Second Article.

Q. SAY the second article.

A. And in Jesus Christ his only Son our Lord.

Q. Of what treats this article ?

A. Of the second Person of the blessed Trinity, in whom we also believe and put our trust.

Q. What is the second Person ?

A. He is true God, and true Man, in one Person.

Q. How prove you that ?

A. Out of *St. John's Gospel*, chap. i. 1. 'In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God, &c. And the Word was made flesh, and dwelt among us.'

Q. What other proof have you ?

A. Out of *Phil. ii. 6, 7*, where *St. Paul* saith, 'That Christ when he was in the form of God, thought it not robbery to be equal with God, but he hath lessened himself, taking the form of a servant, made unto the likeness of men; and found in habit as a man.'

Q. Why should God be made man ?

A. To redeem and save lost man.

Q. Was his incarnation necessary for that end ?

A. In a manner it was; because our offences against God were in some sort infinite; as being against his infinite goodness; and therefore required an infinite satisfaction; which no one could make but God, and therefore he was made man.

Q. What other proof have you for the necessity of the Incarnation?

A. Because God is in himself so spiritual, subtle and abstract a thing, that if he had not in his mercy adapted his own inscrutable greatness to the littleness of our sensible capacity, by being made man, scarce one of a thousand would ever have been able to know any thing to the purpose of him; or consequently love and serve him as they ought, (which is the necessary means of our salvation) since nothing is efficaciously willed which is not first well understood.

Q. What benefit have we by the knowledge of God made man?

A. It much inflames us with the love of God, which could not more have dignified men's nature, or showed more love to the world, than to send down his only Son to redeem it in our flesh.

Q. What signifies the name of Jesus?

A. It signifies a Saviour, *St. Matt. i. 21.*

Q. Is any special honour due to that name?

A. There is, because it is the highest title of God made man.

Q. How prove you that?

A. Out of *Phil. ii. 8, 9, 10*, where we read, 'God hath given unto Christ because he hath humbled himself unto the death of the cross, a name which is above all names, the name Jesus.'

Q. What other proof have you?

A. Because there is no other name under heaven given to man, in which we must be saved. *Acts iv.*

Q. How prove you that we must bow at this name?

A. Out of *Phil. ii. 10*. That in the name of Jesus every knee should bow of those that are in heaven, earth, and in hell.

Q. What signifies the name Christ?

A. It signifies anointed.

Q. Why was he called anointed?

A. Because he was a priest, a prophet, and a king to all which unction appertains.

Q. With what was Christ anointed?

A. With all the plenitude of divine grace.

What mean the words, his only Son our Lord ?

They mean that Jesus Christ is the only Son of the Father, begotten as he is God, and of the same ~~er~~ from all eternity, without a mother ; and there-
is coequal and consubstantial to his Father ; and
sequently infinite, omnipotent Creator, and so Lord
as and all things, as the Father is.

The Third Article.

Q. WHAT is the third article ?

A. Who was conceived by the Holy Ghost, born of a Virgin Mary.

Q. What means, who was conceived by the Holy Ghost ?

A. It means that the second Person of the blessed Trinity took flesh of the Virgin Mary, not by a human generation, but by the work of the Holy Ghost.

Q. How prove you that ?

A. Out of St. *Luke* i. 31, 35. Behold (saith the angel) thou shalt conceive and bear a Son, &c. the Holy Ghost shall come upon thee, and the virtue of the Highest shall overshadow thee.

Q. What understand you by the words, born of the Virgin Mary ?

A. I understand that Christ was born of her at midnight, in a poor stable at Bethlehem, between an ox and an ass.

Q. Why at midnight ?

A. To signify that he came to take away the darkness of our sins.

Q. Why in Bethlehem ?

A. Because it was the head city of David's family, and Christ was of David's race.

Q. Why in a poor stable ?

A. To teach us to love poverty and contempt of this world.

Q. Why between an ox and an ass ?

A. To fulfil that of the prophet, Thou shalt be known, O Lord, between two beasts, *Habacuc* xii. *juxta* Sept

Q. What doth the birth of Christ avail us ?

A. It perfecteth in us faith, hope, and charity.

Q. What signifies, "born of the Virgin Mary ?"

A. It signifies that Our Lady was a virgin not only before, but also in, and after childbirth.

The Fourth Article.

Q. WHAT is the fourth article?

A. Suffered under Pontius Pilate, was crucified, dead and buried.

Q. What understand you by suffering under Pontius Pilate?

A. I understand that Christ, after a painful life of thirty-three years, suffered most bitter torments under the wicked president Pontius Pilate.

Q. Where did he begin those sufferings?

A. In the garden of Gethsemani; that as sin began in the garden by the first Adam, so might grace also, by the second.

Q. What are those torments?

A. His bloody sweat, his whipping at the pillar, his purple garment, his crown of thorns, his Sceptre of reed, his carrying the cross, and many others.

Q. What understand you by the words, was crucified?

A. I understand, he was nailed to a disgraceful cross between two thieves, for our offences, and to save us.

Q. Is it lawful to honour the cross?

A. Yes, with a relative honour it is, because it is special memorial of our Saviour's passion, and is called the sign of the Son of man, St. *Matt.* xxiv. 30.

Q. What other reason have you?

A. Because the cross was the sacred altar, on which Christ offered his bloody sacrifice.

Q. What scripture have you for it?

A. *Gal.* vi. 14. 'God forbid, (saith St. Paul,) that I should glory, but in the cross of our Lord Jesus Christ'

Q. What other proof have you?

A. Out of *Phil.* iii. 18. Many walk (saith St. Paul) of whom I have often told you, and now again weeping I tell you that they are enemies to the cross of Christ, &c. whose end is perdition. And out of *Ezek.* ix. 4, where we read, That such as were signed with the sign TAU (which was a picture and figure of the cross,) were saved from the exterminating angel, and only such.

Q. What signifies the word dead ?

A. It signifies that Christ suffered a true and real death.

Q. Why was it requisite he should die ?

A. To free us from the death of sin.

Q. Why died he, crying with a loud voice ?

A. To show he had power of his own life ; and he freely gave it up for us, being strong and vigorous.

Q. Why died he bowing down his head ?

A. To signify his obedience to his Father, in the acceptance of his disgraceful death.

Q. What means buried ?

A. It means, that his body was laid in a new sepulchre, and buried with honour, as the prophet had foretold, *Isa.* xi. 10.

The Fifth Article.

Q. WHAT is the fifth article ?

A. He descended into hell, the third day he arose again from the dead.

Q. What means, he descended into hell ?

A. It means, that as soon as Christ was dead, he descended into *Limbo*, to free the holy fathers who were there.

Q. How prove you that ?

A. Out of *Acts* ii. 24, 27. 'Christ being slain, God raised him up loosing the sorrows of hell, as it was foretold by the prophet,' *Psalms* xv. 10. 'Thou wilt not leave my soul in hell, nor wilt thou give thy Holy One to see corruption.'

Q. What other proof have you ?

A. *Ephes.* iv. 8, 9. 'He ascending on high, hath led captivity captive ; he gave gifts to men ; and that he ascended,' what is it but because he descended into the lower parts of the earth ?

Q. Did he not descend to purgatory to free such as were there ?

A. It is most probable he did according to 1 *Pet.* iii. 19, 20. 'Christ being dead, came in spirit ; and preached to them also that were in prison, who had been incredulous in the days of Noah, when the ark was building.'

Q. What understand you by, on the third day he **rose** again from the dead ?

A. I understand, when Christ had been dead part of three days, on the third day, which was Sunday, he raised up his blessed body from the dead.

Q. Why did he not raise it again sooner ?

A. To testify that he was truly dead, and to fulfil the prophecies.

Q. Did he reassume all the parts of his body ?

A. He did, even to the last drop of his vital blood, and the very scattered hairs of his head.

Q. Why did he retain the stigmas and marks of the sacred wounds ?

A. To confound the incredulity of men, and to present them often to his Father, as a propitiation of our sins.

Q. What benefit have we by the resurrection ?

A. It confirms our faith and hope, that we shall **rise** again from death : ' For he who raised up Jesus will raise us also with Jesus.' 2 Cor. iv. 14.

The Sixth Article.

Q. **WHAT** is the sixth article ?

A. He ascended into heaven, sits at the right hand of God the Father Almighty.

Q. What means, He ascended into heaven ?

A. It means that when Christ had conversed forty days on earth with his disciples, after his resurrection teaching them heavenly things, then he ascended triumphant into heaven, by his own power.

Q. From what place did he ascend ?

A. From the top of Mount Olivet, where the print of his blessed feet are seen to this day.

Q. Why from thence ?

A. That where he began to be humbled by his passion, there he might also begin to be exalted.

Q. Before whom did he ascend ?

A. Before his mother, apostles and disciples, Act 9, &c.

Q. *In what manner* did he ascend ?

A. *Lifting up his hands*, and blessing them.

Q. *Why is it added, Into Heaven ?*

A. To draw our hearts to heaven after him; 'If ye have risen with Christ, seek ye the things which are above.' *Col. iii. 1.*

Q. What understand you by, Sits at the right hand of God?

A. I do not understand, that God the Father hath any hands, for he is incorporeal, and a spirit: but that Christ is equal to his Father in power and majesty, as he is God; and that as man he is in the highest created glory.

The Seventh Article.

Q. WHAT is the seventh article?

A. From thence he will come to judge the living and the dead.

Q. What understand you by this article?

A. I understand Christ will come at the last day from heaven, to judge all men according to their works.

Q. Does every man receive a particular judgment at his death?

A. He doth, but in the general judgment we shall be judged not only in our souls, as at our death, but also in our bodies.

Q. Why is that necessary?

A. That as Christ was openly rejected, so he may there be openly acknowledged to the great joy and glory of his friends, as also to the confusion of his enemies.

Q. How prove you that in the judgment all men shall receive according to their works?

A. Out of 2 *Cor. v. 10.* 'We must all be manifested (saith St. Paul) before the judgment seat of Christ, that every one may receive the proper things of the body, according as he hath done, whether good or evil.' And out of St. *Matt. xvi. 27.* 'The Son of man (saith our Lord) shall come in the glory of his Father, with his angels, and then he will render to every one according to his works.'

Q. Is there any merit in our good works?

A. There is, according to *Apoc. xxii. 12.* 'Behold I come quickly (saith our Lord) and my reward is with me; to render to every man according to his works.'

Q. In what place shall this judgment be made?

A. In the Valley of Jehosaphat, as many suppose, between Jerusalem and Mount Olivet.

Q. How prove you this?

A. By its conformity to that of the prophet. 'I will gather together all nations, I will send them into the Valley of Jehosaphat, and there will I plead with them upon my people, and my inheritance *Israel*,' *Joel* iii.

Q. What signs shall go before it?

A. The sun and moon shall lose their lights, there shall be wars, plagues, famines, and earthquakes, in many places.

Q. In what manner will Christ come unto it?

A. In great power and majesty, attended with legions of angels.

Q. Who are they that shall be judged?

A. The whole race and progeny of man.

Q. What are the things that shall be judged?

A. Our thoughts, words, and works, even to the secrets of our souls.

Q. Who will accuse us?

A. The Devils, and our own guilty consciences: in which all our thoughts, words and deeds shall presently appear, and be laid open to the whole world.

Q. How shall the just and reprobate be placed?

A. The just shall be on the right; the reprobate on the left hand of the Judge.

Q. What shall be the sentence of the just?

A. 'Come, O ye blessed of my Father, and receive ye the kingdom which is prepared for you, for I was hungry and ye gave me to eat, I was thirsty, and ye gave me to drink,' &c. *St. Matt.* xxv. 35, 36.

Q. What shall be the sentence of the reprobate?

A. 'Go ye cursed into eternal fire, which hath been prepared for the devil and his angels; for I was hungry, and ye gave me not to eat,' &c. the same chap. v. 41, 42. You see of what weight good works will be at that day.

Q. Why is it added, the living and the dead?

A. To signify that Christ shall judge, not only such as are living at the time of his coming, but likewise all

such as have been dead, from the creation of the world; as also by the living, are understood angels and saints, by the dead, devils and damned souls.

The Eighth Article.

Q. WHAT is the eighth article?

A. I believe in the Holy Ghost.

Q. Of what treats this article?

A. Of the third Person of the blessed Trinity, in whom we also believe and put our trust, who proceeds from the Father and the Son, and is the self-same God with them, distinct in nothing but in person.

Q. How prove you that?

A. Out of 1 *John* v. 7. 'There are three that give testimony in heaven, the Father, the Word, and the Holy Ghost, and these three are one.'

Q. Why is the name of Holy Ghost appropriated to the third Person, since angels are all spirits and holy?

A. Because he is such by excellency and essence; they only by participation.

Q. At least why should it not be common to the other two persons?

A. Because they are known by the proper names of Father and Son, but we have not any proper name for the Holy Ghost.

Q. In what forms has the Holy Ghost appeared unto man?

A. In the form of a dove, to signify the purity and innocence which he caused in our souls: and in the form of a bright cloud, and fiery tongue, to signify the fire of charity, which he produced in our hearts, as also the gift of tongues; and hence it is, he is painted in these forms.

The Ninth Article.

Q. WHAT is the ninth article?

A. I believe in the holy Catholic Church, the communion of saints.

Q. What understand you by this?

A. I understand that Christ hath a church upon earth which he established in his own blood, and that he hath

commanded us to believe that church, in all things appertaining to faith, and morals, *Matt.* xviii. 17.

Q. What kind of faith must we believe her with ?

A. With the same faith that we believe her Spouse, the Son of God, that is, with divine faith, but with ~~this~~ difference among other, that we believe in God ; but though we believe the church, yet we do not properly believe in the church.

Q. What is the church ?

A. It is the congregation of all the faithful under Jesus Christ, their invisible head, and his vicar upon earth, the Pope.

Q. What are the essential parts of the church ?

A. A Pope or supreme head, bishops, pastors, and laity.

Q. How prove you that bishops are of divine institution ?

A. Out of *Acts* xx. 28. Take heed unto yourselves, and to the whole flock, wherein the Holy Ghost hath placed you bishops, to rule the church of God, which he hath purchased with his own blood.

Q. How believe you St. Peter, and the Pope his successor, to be the visible head of the church ?

A. First out of St. *John* xxi. 16, 17, and 18, where Christ gave St. Peter (for a reward of his special faith and love) absolute power to feed and govern his whole flock, saying, Feed my Lambs, feed my lambs, feed my sheep ; therefore the rest of the apostles were his sheep, and he their head or pastor.

Secondly, out of St. *Matt.* xvi. 18, where Christ saith, *Thou art Peter, and upon this Rock will I build my church.* Therefore the rest of the apostles were built on him ; and hence also it is, that in Scripture, St. *Peter* is still named first.

Q. What are the marks of the true church ?

A. Unity, sanctity, universality, and to be apostolical.

Q. What mean you by the church's unity ?

A. That all her members live under one evangelical law, obey the same supreme head, and his magistrates profess the same faith, even to the least article, and use *the same sacraments* and sacrifices.

Q. How prove you out of Scripture that the church is one ?

A. 1 *Cor.* x. 17. Being many (saith *St. Paul*) we are one bread, one body, all who participate of one bread.

Q. Why may not a well-meaning person be saved in any religion ?

A. Because there is but one Lord, one faith, one baptism, *Ephes.* iv. 5, and without (that one) faith, it is impossible to please God. *Heb.* xi. 6.

Q. What other reason have you for it ?

A. Because, as in a natural body, that part which has not a due connection to the heart or root, presently dies for want of continuity; for in the church (the mystical body of Christ) that man who has not a due subordination and connection to the head and common councils thereof, (that is, the Pope and general councils from whence under Christ we have our spiritual life and motion, as we are Christians,) must needs be dead, nor indeed can he be accounted a member of that mystical body.

Q. Who, I beseech you, are those who are not to be accounted members of the church ?

A. All such as are not in the unity of the church, by a most firm belief of her doctrine, and due obedience to her pastors; as Jews, Turks, Heretics, &c.

Q. Why may not Heretics and Schismatics justly claim to be in the Unity of the Church and Members of Christ's body ?

A. Because Catholics can show to each sect of Heretics and Schismatics the time they began; the date of their separation from the Church; the name of the person or persons of their sect who first separated themselves, and the cause of their condemnation; whilst the Catholic Church always was from the beginning.

Q. What if a Protestant should tell you, that the difference between them and us, are not differences in fundamentals, or in faith, but in opinion only, and therefore do not exclude them out of the unity of the Catholic Church ?

A. I should answer, they contradict themselves; for they accuse us of robbing God of his honour, in holding priestly absolution from sins; in adoring Christ's body

and blood, as really present in the eucharist, and holding the Pope's supremacy in things belonging to the spiritual government of the Church, also the infallibility of the Church and general councils, in delivering and defining points of faith, which are no matters of indifference, but high fundamentals.

Q. How do you prove all obstinate Innovators to be Heretics?

A. Because they wilfully stand out against the definitive sentence of the Church of God, and submit not to any tribunal appointed by Christ to decide religious controversies; but follow their own interpretation of the dead letter of the scriptures.

Q. And is not this the reason also why Protestants and all other sectarians are so divided in religious matters?

A. Yes, it is; for how is it possible that people who imagine that there is no person or tribunal, or even the Church of God, infallible, for expounding the bible; people, who expound it each according to his respective fancy; people, who have no control over the erroneous interpretation of each other; how is it possible that such people would have the unity of faith, in the bond of peace; or that they be not tossed to and fro, and carried about with every wind of doctrine?

Q. Why may not the letter of the Scripture be a decisive judge of controversies?

A. Because it has never been able from its first publication, to decide any one dispute; as the whole world knows from experience: all heretics equally pretend to scripture authority in defence of their errors and heresies.

Q. How then can we ascertain the truth amidst conflicting opinions?

A. By the infallible authority, definition, and proposition of the Catholic Church.

Q. For what end, then, was the Scripture written, if not to be a decider of controversies?

A. The writing of the Holy Scriptures was for the purpose of the better preserving the revealed will of God, *and that by a sensible and common reading of it, without any critical or controversial disputes of words, we might be able to know that God is, and what he is, as*

also that there is a heaven and a hell, rewards for virtue, and punishment for vice, with examples of both, all which we find in the letter of the Scripture, by a plain and ordinary reading.

Q. Is the church we speak of visible?

A. She is and must be visible at all times, as consisting of a hierarchy of pastors, governing, teaching, administering sacraments to the world's end, and of other people governed, taught and receiving sacraments at their hands, all publicly professing the same faith, all which things are visible.

Q. How prove you that?

A. First, out of *Eph.* iv. 1, and 12. 'Christ gave some apostles, some evangelists, some doctors, some pastors, to the consummation of the saints, to the edifying of the body of Christ, and to the work of the ministry, until we all meet in the unity of faith.'

Secondly, out of *St. Matt.* v. 14, where Christ saith of his church, "You are the light of the world, a city seated on a high mountain cannot be hid."

Q. Why then would Protestants have the church to be invisible?

A. Because we have convinced them, that there were no Protestants to be seen or heard of in the world before *Martin Luther*.

Q. Why is the church said to be holy, or to have sanctity?

A. Because she hath a holy faith, a holy law, holy sacraments, and is guided by the Holy Ghost, to all truth and holiness.

Q. How else prove you her sanctity?

A. Because Christ gave himself for his church that he might sanctify her, cleansing her by the laver of water in the world, that he might present her to himself a glorious church, not having spot or wrinkle, but that she might be holy and unspotted. *Eph.* v. 26, 27.

Q. Notwithstanding the sanctity of the Catholic Church, are not some Catholics as wicked as Protestants?

A. Yes, verily, and more wicked, for where sanctity is less, their sacrilege cannot be so great. No man could damn his own posterity, but he that had original justice

to lose: nor any man to betray Christ, but he that had eaten at his table. Protestants have not a holy faith, such holy sacraments, nor a holy church to abuse, as Catholics have, and therefore no wonder, if some Catholics be worse than any Protestants; yet Catholics have some saints, but Protestants have none.

Q. Is the church infallible?

A. She is, and therefore to be believed, and all men may rest securely on her judgment.

Q. How prove you that?

A. First, because she is the pillar and ground of truth. 1 Tim. iii. 15.

Secondly, out of St. *Matt.* xvi. 18, where Christ saith, "Upon this Rock will I build my church, and the gates of hell shall not prevail against her."

Thirdly, out of St. *John*, xiv. 26. But the Paraclete, (saith he,) the Holy Ghost, shall teach you all things whatsoever I shall say to you. And xvi. 13. But when the Spirit of truth cometh, he shall teach you all truth.

Q. How declare you that the definitions of a council perfectly ecumenical, that is, a general council approved by the Pope, are infallible in matters of faith?

A. Because such a council is the church representative, and has the same infallibility that the church spread over the world hath.

Q. What other reason have you?

A. Because the definitions of such a council are the dictates of the Holy Ghost, according to that of the apostles, deciding in council, it hath seemed good to the Holy Ghost, and to us, *Acts* xv. 28.

Q. What think you then of such as accuse the church of errors in faith and of idolatry?

A. Truly I think them to be Heretics or Infidels, for our Lord saith, He that will not hear the church let him be unto thee as a heathen and a publican, St. *Mat.* xviii. 17.

Q. Is not the church at least too severe in its censures and excommunications against sectaries?

A. No, she is very reasonable and charitable in that for vicious, passionate, and self-interested men at times are brought to reason, for fear of punish

and are forced to their own good, when no authority ordained by Christ is able to persuade them to it.

Q. What understand you by the word catholic, or by the universality of the church?

A. I understand the church is universal, both for time and place.

Q. How for time?

A. Because she hath been from Christ to this time, and shall be from thence to the end of the world.

Q. How prove you that?

A. Out of *St. Matt. xxviii. 20.* Going therefore (saith our Lord) teach ye all nations, &c. and behold I am with you all days, even to the consummation of the world.

Q. What mean you by the universality of place?

A. I mean that the church shall be spread over all nations.

Q. How prove you this?

A. First, out of *St. Matt.* above cited, Teach all nations.

Secondly, out of *Psalme lxxxv. 9.* All nations, whatsoever thou hast made, shall come and adore before thee, O Lord.

Thirdly, out of *Apoc. vii. 9,* where we read, that the church shall be gathered out of all nations, people, tribes, and tongues.

Q. Why do we call the church the Roman Church?

A. Because, since the translation of *St. Peter's* chair from Antioch to Rome, the particular Roman Church has been head of all the churches, and to her the primacy has been affixed.

Q. What is the rule by which the church preserves entire the deposit of Faith and confounds all sectaries?

A. Apostolical traditions, or receipt of doctrine by hand to hand from Christ and his apostles.

Q. How prove you that?

A. Out of *Rom. vi. 17.* "Therefore I beseech you, brethren (saith *St. Paul*) mark them which make dissensions and scandals, contrary to the doctrine which you have learned, and avoid them; for such do not serve Christ our Lord."

Q. What other proofs have you ?

A. Out of *St. Paul*, saying, “ But although we or an angel from heaven evangelize to you, besides that which we have evangelized to you, be he anathema, or besides, what you have received be he anathema.” *Gal.* i. 8, 9.

Q. Can the church err in faith, standing to this rule, and admitting nothing for faith, but what is consented by the whole church to have been so received ?

A. She cannot, otherwise the whole church must there conspire in a notorious lie, to damn herself and her posterity, or else she must be ignorant what hath been taught her for faith by the church of the precedent age, which are both natural impossibilities.

Q. How prove you these to be impossibilities by nature ?

A. By the constancy and immutability of contingent causes, whose particulars may be defective, but the universals cannot.

Q. Explain that a little.

A. Because one man or two or three may be born but with one arm, or one eye only, through defect of their particular causes ; but that all nature should fail at once, and all men be so born, is totally impossible in nature ; in like manner, one man or two may conspire in palpable lies to damn themselves and their posterity, or be deceived in what hath been taught them for faith, from their very cradles ; but that the whole church should so far break with the nature of man (which is reason) to conspire in such a lie, or to be so mistaken, is as impossible in nature, as it is for men to be no men.

Q. May not some errors have been received for faith, and crept insensibly over the whole church, no man perceiving or taking notice of them ?

A. No, that is as impossible as that the plague or burning fever should infect or spread itself over a whole kingdom for many years, no man perceiving it, or seeking to prevent it ; for nothing causes greater notice to be taken, than any public or notorious change in matters of religion.

Q. May not the power of temporal princes, or the

over prevalence of human wit and reason, have introduced errors into the church?

A. Neither is that possible, seeing we are not regulated in things which are of faith, either by power, or any strength of reason, but by the rule of apostolical tradition, and by inquiring of the whole church of every age, what hath been taught by our forefathers, from Christ and his apostles.

Q. Was not the Millenary heresy an apostolical tradition?

A. No, it was not; for there is no assurance or consent among those who write of it, that it was ever preached or delivered by the apostles.

Q. Did not St. *Austin* and *Innocentius*, with their councils, hold the communion of children a thing necessary to their salvation?

A. They speak not of sacramental communion, as is evident to all who have read their works, but of the effect of it, that is, of their incorporation into the mystical body of Christ, which is made in baptism, and this only they affirmed to be necessary to their salvation.

Q. At least do not heretics say and aver, that the church hath apostatized and erred in faith?

A. They do indeed, but it will not serve their turn, barely to say it, unless they were also able to prove it, (which they neither are or will be) by evident and undeniable proofs.

Q. How prove you that?

A. First, because that presumption and possession of her integrity and infallibility is on the church's side; and therefore ought not to be yielded up, without clear evidence of her prevarication.

Secondly, because he that accuses his neighbour's wife of adultery, without convincing proof thereof, is not to be hearkened unto, but to be hated by all good men, as a most infamous slanderer; much more ought they who shall accuse the church, the spouse of Christ, of errors and apostacy, unless their proofs be evident and undeniable, to be detested as blasphemous heretics.

Thirdly, because if less than manifest and convincing evidence be sufficient to prove matters of this high na-

ture, it is not impossible but every false tongue shall set dissensions between man and wife, and stir up the most faithful subjects in the world to a rebellion against their princes, both spiritual and temporal.

Q. What other reason have you yet, why the church and law of Christ may not fail and be utterly extinguished?

A. Because the causes of religion (to wit, the hope of good, and fear of evil from God) are universal and necessary, always knocking at men's hearts, and putting them in mind of some good or other, and therefore must needs have perpetual and necessary effects, which in such as are convinced that Christ is God, can be no other than the faith, hope and love of Christ, and the observance of his law, and that for ever, speaking of the whole church, although particular men may err and fall away.

Q. What is it for the church to be apostolical?

A. To have been begun and propagated by the apostles, and to have a succession of pastors, and doctrine from them.

Q. What means the communion of saints?

A. It means first that the faithful do all communicate in the same faith and sacraments, in the same sacrifice, and also in the merits of one another.

Q. How prove you that?

A. Out of 1 *Cor.* xii. 26. And if one member suffer any thing, all the members suffer with it; or if one member do glory, all the members rejoice with it, you are the body of Christ, and members of a member.

Secondly, It means that the faithful on earth communicate with the angels and the saints in heaven; we by praising and praying to them, they by praying for us.

Q. How do you prove this communion?

A. Out of *Luke* xv. 10. There is joy before the angels of God upon one sinner that doth penance. And out of 1 *John* i. 3, That you also may have fellowship with us, and our fellowship may be with the Father and with his Son Jesus Christ.

Q. How prove you that the saints have any power to do us good?

A. Out of *Apoc.* ii. 26, 27, where Christ hath promised them power over us: To him, said he, that shall overcome, and keep my works to the end, to him will I give power over nations, and he shall rule them with an iron rod.

Q. How prove you that it is lawful to pray to angels?

A. Out of *Apoc.* i. 4, where *St. John* did it: Grace (saith he) to you, and peace from him that is, that was, and that shall come, and from the seven spirits that are in the sight of his throne.

Q. What other proof have you?

A. Out of *Apoc.* viii. 4, where we read, that they present the church's prayers to God. The smoke of the incense of the prayers of the saints ascended from the hand of the angel before God.

Q. How prove you that we may pray to saints?

A. Out of *Gen.* xlviii. 16, where *Jacob* taught his children to do it, saying, And let my name be invocated upon them, the names also of my fathers, *Abraham* and *Isaac*.

Q. How prove you that they pray for us?

A. Out of *Apoc.* v. 8. The twenty-four elders fell down before the Lamb, having every one harps, and vials full of odours, which are the prayers of the saints.

Q. Is it no dishonour to God, for us to pray to saints to pray for us?

A. No, it is not, nor yet to beg it of men; for *St. Paul* did it: We hope (saith he) that God will deliver us, you also helping in prayer for us. *2 Cor.* i. 11.

The Tenth Article.

Q. WHAT is the tenth article?

A. The forgiveness of sins.

Q. What do you understand by this?

A. I understand that God is both able and willing to forgive our sins, if we be heartily sorry for them, and confess them; and hath given power to his church to remit them by baptism and penance.

Q. How prove you that?

A. Out of *Matt.* viii. 9, where it is recorded by the

Holy Ghost, that the multitude glorified God, who hath given such power unto man, as to forgive sins, (Christ having before proved the said power by a miracle) ver. 6, 7.

Q. Is any sin so great that God cannot forgive it?

A. No, there is not; for his mercy is far above our malice.

Q. Can any one mortal sin be remitted without the rest?

A. It cannot, because the remission of mortal sin is a renewing of friendship with God by his grace, which can never be effected, so long as there remains in us any mortal sin.

Q. Can we have absolute certainty, that our sins are forgiven us?

A. Without special revelation we cannot: I am not guilty in conscience (saith St. Paul) of any thing, but herein I am not justified. 1 Cor. iv. 4.

Q. What other proof have you?

A. Because a man knows not whether he be worthy of love or hatred. Eccl. i. 9.

Q. Can we be certain of our final perseverance?

A. Not without special revelation, and therefore St. Paul said, I chastise my body and bring it into subjection, lest when I preach to others I myself become reprobate, 1 Cor. ix. 27, and Phil. ii. 12. He exhorteth saying, with fear and trembling, work out your salvation.

Q. How then shall we have peace of conscience?

A. Because we may have moral certainty and a most lively hope, that our sins are forgiven us by the due use of the sacraments, which is enough for our peace.

The Eleventh Article.

Q. WHAT is the eleventh article?

A. The resurrection of the flesh.

Q. What means this article?

A. It means that these very bodies in which we now live, shall at the day of judgment be all raised up from death to life.

Q. By what means shall this be done?

y the omnipotent command of God, and the
of angels.

How prove you that?

ut of 1 *Thess.* iv. 16. For our Lord in com-
ment, and in the voice of an archangel, and in
mpet of God, will descend from ~~heaven~~, and the
at are in Christ shall rise again.

shall the same bodies rise again?

he same in substance, though different in qualities.

How prove you that?

ut of *Job* xix. 25, 26, 27. For I know that my
er liveth, and in the last day I shall rise out of
th, and shall be compassed again with my skin,
my flesh I shall see God, whom I myself shall
I mine eyes shall behold, and not another.

What shall be the qualities or doweries of a glo-
dy?

mpassability, agility, clarity, subtilty.

How do you prove its impassability, or incorrupt-

but of 1 *Cor.* xv. 53. For this corruptible must
ncorruption, and this mortal put on immortality.

How prove you its agility?

but of the same chapter, ver. 43, 44. It is sown
nity, it shall rise in power; it is sown a natural
ut it shall rise in a spiritual body, (that is, in mo-
ed some operations equal to a spirit;) which also
its subtilty.

How prove you its clarity?

But of the same chapter, ver. 24. "For star (said
ers from star in glory, so also the resurrection of
id." And ver. 43. "It is sown in dishonour, it
se in glory."

[In what space of time shall the dead rise, and the
e thus changed?

'In a moment, in the twinkling of an eye," 1 *Cor.*

At what age and stature shall men rise?

At a perfect age, which is thirty-three, and in that
; which they should have had at a perfect age,
it deformity by defect or excess.

Q. How prove you this?

A. Out of *Ephes. iv. 13.* "The church shall last until we all meet into a perfect man, into the measure of the age of the fulness of Christ."

Q. What example have you in nature for the resurrection?

A. A grain of corn, which first rots in the earth and then springs up and lives again.

Q. What benefit have we by the knowledge of the resurrection?

A. It emboldens us to suffer persecution and death itself, in hope of future glory, according to that of *St. Paul*: "For sufferings of these times are not comparable to that of future glory, which be revealed in us:" *Rom. viii. 18.*

The Twelfth Article.

Q. WHAT is the twelfth article?

A. And life everlasting.

Q. Why is this the last article?

A. Because everlasting life is the last end of man, and the last reward we expect by faith.

Q. What understand you by this article?

A. I understand that such as keep the commandments, and die in the state of grace, shall live with God in bliss for ever.

Q. How prove you that keeping the commandments is of necessity for obtaining it?

A. Out of *Matt. xix. 17.* where Christ said to the young man, asking what he should do to obtain it, "if thou wilt enter into life, keep the commandments."

Q. Is everlasting life given as a reward of our good works?

A. It is, according to *Rom. ii. 6, 7.* "God will render to every one according to his works, to them truly, that according to patience in good works, seek glory and honour, and incorruption, life everlasting," &c.

Q. Were all men created for everlasting life?

A. They were, for God "would have all men to be saved," *1 Tim. ii. 4.* "He willeth not the death of any sinner, but rather that he be converted and live." *Ezek. xxxiii. 11.*

Why then are many damned ?

By reason of their own wilful transgression of law, and final impenitence.

How prove you that man is the free cause of his sin and damnation ?

First, out of *Job* xi. 23. "God (saith he) hath given thee grace for penance, but he abuseth it unto pride."

Secondly, out of *Hos.* xiii. 9. "The perdition is from thee, O Israel ; in me only is thy aid."

Thirdly, out of *Rom.* ii. 4. "The benignity of God calls thee to repentance, but thou heapest to thyself wrath against thyself by thy disobedience, according to thy own impenitent heart."

In what consists everlasting life ?

In the clear vision and fruition of God, according to our Saviour, in *John* xvii. 3. "This is the life eternal, that they know thee the only true God, and Jesus Christ, whom thou hast sent."

Shall we see nothing in Heaven but God ?

Yes, all the attributes and perfections of God, and also, as in a mirror or looking glass, the nature and perfections of all creatures ; for he contains all in himself in the most eminent manner.

How prove you that ?

Out of the apostle, saying, "from whom all things, and in whom all things." *Rom.*

What effect will follow out of the clear vision and fruition of God ?

A divine love, steadfast possession, and ineffable joy, and out of that praise, jubilation, and thanksgiving.

What means the word *Amen* ?

It means that the whole creed is divine truth, and that we most heartily assent to it.

CHAP. IV.

Hope and Prayer Explained.

WHAT is Hope ?

It is a virtue infused by God into the soul, by which we have a confident expectation of glory to be

obtained by the grace and merits of Christ, and our own merits proceeding from his grace.

Q. On what is the confidence chiefly grounded ?

A. On the merits and promises of Christ, who hath promised glory to such as hope in him, and do his works, as also grace whereby to do them.

Q. Are our good works then meritorious of a reward of glory ?

A. As proceeding from the grace of Christ, and built upon his promises, they are.

Q. How prove you that ?

A. First, out of *Mark* ix. 14. "For whosoever shall give you to drink a cup of water in my name because you are Christ's, Amen, I say to you, he shall not lose his reward."

Secondly, out of *1 Cor.* iii. 8. "And every one shall receive his own reward, according to his own labour, for we are God's coadjutors."

Thirdly, out of *Matt.* v. 11. "Blessed are ye (saith our Lord) when they shall revile and persecute you; for very great is your reward in heaven."

Q. Is it lawful for us to do good works in hope of a reward ?

A. Not only lawful but laudable, according to that, I "have inclined my heart to do thy justifications for ever, for a reward." *Psalms* cxviii. 12.

Q. What other proof have you ?

A. Out of *1 John* iii. 22. "Whatsoever (saith he) we shall ask of God, we shall receive of him, because we keep his commandments, and do those things that are pleasing before him."

Q. How declare you the necessity of hope ?

A. Because it produces in us obedience to the law of God, as also a willingness to suffer for his sake, and final perseverance.

Q. How prove you that ?

A. Out of *Job* xiii. 15. "Although he kill me, yet will I hope in him." And *Psalms* lv. 5. "In God have I hoped, I will not fear what flesh can do unto me."

It is according to the Psalmist, "Him that hopeth in our Lord, mercy shall encompass." *Psalms* xxxi. 10

And, "Our Lord is well pleased in them that hope in his mercy." *Psalm cxlvi. 11.*

Q. What other good doth Hope?

A. It moves us to devout and humble prayer.

Q. What is prayer?

A. It is the lifting up of the mind to God, by which we beg for good things, and to be free from evils, or by which we bless and praise God.

Q. What are the conditions of good prayer?

A. That it may be made with reverence, attention, humility, and perseverance.

Q. What vices are opposite to hope?

A. Despair and presumption.

Q. What is despair?

A. It is a diffidence in the mercy of God, and merits of Christ, even to death.

Q. What is presumption?

A. It is a foolish and desperate confidence of salvation, without endeavouring to live well or keep the commandments.

Q. How is despair the cause of sin?

A. Because despairing men are wont to say, if I shall be damned, I shall be damned, and so use no endeavour to do good or avoid evil.

Q. How is presumption the cause of sin?

A. Because presumptuous men used to say, God is merciful and will forgive our sins, how great soever, and at what time soever, we do penance; and out of this take liberty to sin.

Q. How must our hope be balanced between these two extremes?

A. By a filial fear, and an humble distrust of our own works, as they are ours.

Q. Is prayer good against both these?

A. It is, according to that of *Luke xxii. 40*, "pray ye, that so ye may not fall into temptation."

Q. For what else availeth prayer?

A. For the avoiding of evils and the obtaining all benefits.

Q. How prove you that?

A. Out of *John xv. 23*, "Whatsoever (saith our Sa-

viour) ye shall ask my Father in my name, he v
it you." And *Luke* xi. 9. "Ask and it shall t
you," &c.

Q. Is it lawful to pray in an unknown tongu

A. It is, "for he that speaks in a tongue (un
speaks not to men but to God," 1 *Cor.* xiv. 2.
petition has the same force if it be understood
that is petitioned, whether the petitioner unders
or not.

Q. What other proof have you ?

A. Out of the same chap. ver. 16, 17, wher
saith, "but if thou bless in spirit, (that is in a ton
known) he that supplieth the place of the vulg:
shall he say Amen, &c. thou indeed givest thanl
but the other is not edified." You see in itself th
is good, for he gives thanks well.

Q. What means the apostle, when he exhort
pray always ? *Thess.* v. 17.

A. He means we should daily spend some
prayer, according to *James* v. 16. "Pray for o
ther that you may be saved, for the continual pi
a just man availeth much."

Q. Is it possible to pray always ?

A. In some sense it is : namely, by offering
our actions to God's honour.

Q. In what place is prayer best ?

A. In churches : because these are places cons
and devoted to prayer, and there our prayers are
ted by the peculiar presence of God, and his spe
sistance besought by the Church's pastors in the
eration of those places.

Q. How prove you that ?

A. Out of *Matt.* xviii. 20. "Where there are
three gathered together in my name (saith our
there I am in the midst of them."

Q. How prove you that material churches
God's appointment ?

A. First, Because God commanded *Solomon*
him a temple, and dedicate it to his service, 2
vii. 12.

Secondly, out of *Luke* xix. 46, where Christ c

material temple his house, casting the buyers and sellers out of it. "My house, (saith he) is the house of prayer, but you have made it a den of thieves."

Thirdly, out of *Luke* xviii. 10, where the publican "ascended to the temple to pray, and descended into his house justified."

Q. How do you prove it lawful to dedicate or consecrate material temples?

A. Out of *Paralip.* above cited, chap. 7, and out of *John*. x. 22, where it is recorded that Christ himself kept the dedication of the temple in *Jerusalem*, instituted by *Judas Maccabæus*, 1 *Mac.* iv. 56, 59.

Q. How do you prove it lawful to adorn the churches with tapestry, pictures, and the like?

A. Out of *Mark* xiv. 15, where Christ commanded his last supper to be prepared in a great chamber adorned.

Q. What proof have you for the order and number of the canonical hours?

A. For *Matins*, *Lauds*, and *Prime*, that of *Psalms* v. 4. "Early in the morning will I stand up to thee, early in the morning wilt thou hear my voice."

Q. What for the third, sixth and ninth hours?

A. For the third, out of *Acts* ii. 16. "At the third hour the Holy Ghost descended on the Apostles." For the sixth, out of *Acts* x. 9. "Peter and John went up into the higher part to pray about the sixth hour:" and for the ninth, out of *Acts* iii. 1. "And at the ninth hour Peter and John went up into the temple to pray."

Q. What for the Even-song and Complin?

A. That of the *Psalmist*, "Morning and evening, will I declare the works of our Lord," *Psalms* liv. 18, and again, "the lifting up of my hands is as an evening sacrifice," *cxl.* 2.

Q. Is it good to use outward ceremonies in a time of prayer, as kneeling, knocking the breast, and such like?

A. It is, for they declare the inward reverence, and devotion of the heart; and Christ himself prostrated, when he prayed in the garden, *Mat.* xxvi. 39. And the poor publican beat his breast, and cast down his

eyes, in that prayer by which he merited to des justified, *Luke xviii. 13, 14.*

Q. Why is the morning so fit a time for prayer

A. To open the windows of the soul to the lig divine grace, and offer up the works of the whole to God's honour.

Q. Why is the evening also?

A. To shut the windows of the soul against the ness of sin, and the illusions of the devil; as also to der thanks for all the benefits of the day past.

Q. What things ought we to pray for?

A. For all good things both spiritual and temp and to be freed from evil; for so our Lord hath t us by his prayer.

CHAP. V.

The Lord's Prayer Expounded.

Q. WHAT is the Pater Noster?

A. It is the most holy prayer, that ever was.

Q. Who made it?

A. Christ our Lord, the eternal wisdom of his ther, *Matt. vi. 9.*

Q. Why did he make it?

A. To teach us a set form of prayer, and how ought to pray.

Q. Why did he make it in so short and plain a man

A. That all persons might be able to understand it.

Q. What doth it contain?

A. All those chief things which we can ask or for of God.

Q. How many petitions does it contain?

A. Seven.

Q. What understand you by these words, which prefixed to the petition, Our Father who art in He

A. I understand that God is our Father, both b ation and by adoption: and if we be in the st grace, we may confidently come to him, and b blessings of him.

Q. How prove you that?

A. Out of 1 *John* iii. 1. "See what manner of charity the Father hath given us, that we should be named, and be the sons of God."

Q. Why do you say, our Father, and not my Father?

A. Because God is the common Father of all, and all good Christians must pray for one another, according to that article in the Creed, "I believe in the communion of saints."

Q. What understand you by the words, Who art in heaven?

A. I understand that God who fills heaven and earth, and is in all things, times, and places, is in heaven in a peculiar manner, declaring and manifesting his glory to the blessed; and therefore when we pray, we must lift up our minds to him, and keep them fixed upon heavenly things.

Q. How prove you that?

A. Out of *Jer.* xlviii. 10. "Cursed be he that doth the word of God negligently."

The First Petition.

Q. WHAT is the first petition?

A. Hallowed be thy name.

Q. What do we beg by this?

A. That God may be known by the whole world, and that he may be worthily praised, served, and honoured by all his creatures, which cannot be effected but by his grace.

Q. Who are those that say this petition ill?

A. Such as dishonour the name of God by blaspheming, swearing, lying, cursing, and scurrilous discourses.

The Second Petition.

Q. WHAT is the second petition?

A. Thy kingdom come.

Q. What do we beg of God by this petition?

A. We beg, that our miseries and afflictions in this life may be such, as that we may be made partakers of his joyful and heavenly kingdom hereafter.

Q. What else do we beg?

A. That Christ may reign in us in this life by grace in the next by glory, presenting us a kingdom to inherit.

Q. Who say this petition ill?

A. Such as are willing slaves to sin, and to

The Third Petition.

Q. WHAT is the third petition?

A. Thy will be done on earth as it is in heaven.

Q. What do we beg by this?

A. That God would enable us by his holy Spirit to keep his commandments, and obey his will in all things.

Q. What mean you by the words, on earth as in heaven?

A. We beg by those, that we may be as ready and willing to do the will of God on earth, as the saints and angels are in heaven.

The Fourth Petition.

Q. WHAT is the fourth petition?

A. Give us this day our daily bread.

Q. What do we beg by this?

A. All food and nourishment for our souls and bodies.

Q. What is the food of the soul?

A. The word of God, the holy sacraments, especially the blessed Eucharist, and divine grace.

Q. How prove you, that by this petition we intend the blessed bread of the Eucharist?

A. Because in *Matt. vi. 11*, we read "our daily bread."

Q. Why is the Eucharist called our daily bread?

A. Because it is daily offered for our sins, and we ought daily to receive it, at least with a pure heart and desire.

Q. Who say this petition ill?

A. Such as are cold and careless in communicating the sacraments, and in hearing divine service, or such as ascribe their temporal good things to their own industry and providence, rather than to any special bounty or gift of God.

The Fifth Petition.

Q. WHAT is the fifth petition ?

A. And forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors.

Q. What do we beg by this petition ?

A. That God would pardon us the sins of our life
past, as also the punishments which are due unto them.

Q. Why are sins, and the penalties of sin, called debts ?

A. Because they make us debtors to the justice of
God, whom by sin we rob of his due honour.

Q. Why is it added, As we forgive our debtors ?

A. To signify that God will not forgive us, unless we
so forgive our brethren ; " If you will not forgive men,
neither will your Father forgive you your offences."
Mat. vi. 15.

Q. Who says this petition ill ?

A. Such as bear malice against their neighbour, and
seek revenge.

The Sixth Petition.

Q. WHAT is the sixth petition ?

A. And lead us not into temptation.

Q. What do we beg by this ?

A. That God would not permit us to be tempted above
our strength.

Q. Doth God tempt any man to sin ?

A. No, " God is not a tempter of evils, he tempts no
man." *James i. 13.*

Q. What other proof have you ?

A. Out of *Psa. v. 7.* " Thou art not a God willing
iniquity." And out of *Rom. ix. 14.* " Is there iniquity
with God ? No, God forbid."

Q. By whom then are we tempted ?

A. By the devil, and our own concupiscence.

Q. Can a man live in this world, and be free from
all temptations ?

A. Morally speaking he cannot : " for the whole life
of man on earth is a warfare." *Job vii. 1.*

Q. Why then do we pray to be delivered from temptations ?

A. That we may not be overcome, or vanquished by
them.

Q. Is temptation of itself a sin?

A. No, not without consent on our part; nay, it is a great occasion of merit, if we resist it as we ought.

Q. How prove you that?

A. First, out of *Apoc.* ii. 10, 11. "Be thou faithful unto death (saith our Lord) and I will give thee the crown of life: he that overcometh, shall not be hurt by the second death."

Secondly, because Christ himself, who never sinned, would be tempted, "and the tempter came unto him," &c. *Matt.* iv. 3.

Q. Are we never overcome but by our own default?

A. Never, according to that answer which was given to St. Paul, desiring to be freed from a temptation. "My grace is sufficient for thee."

Q. What other proof have you?

A. Out of *James* iv. 7. "Resist the devil, and he will flee from you."

Q. Who are they that say this petition ill?

A. Such as seek after occasion of sin, and wilfully expose themselves unto temptations.

Q. What are the best remedies against temptations?

A. To have recourse by humble prayer to God and to his saints, and to such especially as have undergone temptations of the same kind; to resist them valiantly at the first entrance, and to remember often the four last things, death, judgment, hell, and heaven.

The Seventh Petition.

Q. WHAT is the seventh petition?

A. But deliver us from evil.

Q. What do we beg by this petition?

A. That God would deliver us from all our evils both spiritual and temporal, especially from the evils of sin past, present, and to come.

Q. Who is the author of the evil of sin?

A. The devil; for "Sin in God there is none." *John* iii. 5.

Q. What other proof have you?

A. Out of *Wisdom* xiv. 9. "Hateful to God is the pious man and his impiety."

Q. Who say this petition ill?

A. They who commit their evils before God, and multiply their sins without remorse.

CHAP. VI.

The Hail Mary, or Angelical Salutation.

Q. What is the Hail Mary?

A. It is a most honourable salutation to the blessed Virgin Mary, and prayer to her.

Q. How do you prove it lawful to honour her?

A. Out of *Luke* i. 48, where (by inspirations from God) she prophesied, saying, "All generations shall call me blessed."

Q. How many parts hath the Hail Mary?

A. It hath three parts.

Q. What is the first part?

A. Hail Mary, full of grace, the Lord is with thee.

Q. Who made this part?

A. The Holy Ghost, though it was delivered by the angel *Gabriel*, *Luke* i. 28.

Q. What signifies the word Hail?

A. It signifies, Rejoice or be glad, O Mother of God.

Q. Why do we invite her by this prayer to rejoice?

A. Because it renews the memory of her blessed Son's conception, which is an infinite cause of joy to her and the whole court of heaven.

Q. What signifies the word Mary?

A. It signifies star of the sea.

Q. Why is she properly called the star of the sea?

A. Because she shines on us by her exemplary virtue in this sea of miseries, like a most glorious star.

Q. What mean you by the words, full of grace?

A. I mean that the Blessed Virgin hath a special fullness and prerogative of grace for the conception of her Son.

Q. What means, The Lord is with thee?

A. It means that the whole Trinity was with her at the time in a particular manner.

Q. How declare you that?

A. Because the Father was with her, as with Spouse, the Son as with his Mother, the Holy Ghost was with her, as with his choicest tabernacle.

Q. Are they also now with her?

A. They are in glory, and will be so for all eternity.

The Second Part of the Hail Mary.

Q. WHAT is the second part of it?

A. Blessed art thou among women, blessed is the fruit of thy womb, JESUS.

Q. Who made this part?

A. These words, Blessed art thou among women, were first delivered by the angel; and after with the rest, uttered by St. Elizabeth, being inspired by the Holy Ghost. *Luke i. 28, 42.*

Q. What understand you by Blessed art thou among women?

A. I understand, she alone was chosen out amongst all women to be the Mother of God, and therefore ought to be blessed and praised by all women.

Q. Why by married women?

A. Because their children are made the sons of God by the nativity and merits of her Son, of whom she daily also begs blessings for them.

Q. Why by virgins?

A. Because she is their queen and chiefest patroness, and obtains for them of her Son Jesus, the gift of chastity.

Q. Why by widows?

A. Because she is their best example, and advocate to their Spouse, her Son.

Q. What means, Blessed is the fruit of thy womb, Jesus?

A. It means, that Jesus is her true and natural Son, and in him she is the author of all our blessings, and to be blessed both by men and angels.

Q. Why are Catholics such great honourers of the name of Jesus?

A. Because it is a name above all names, as you have heard in the creed; and as St. Paul exhorts, saying,

whatsoever you do in word or work, do all in the of our Lord Jesus Christ, giving thanks to God ther by him." *Colos. iii. 17.*

The Third Part of the Hail Mary.

WHAT is the third part of the *Hail Mary*?

Holy Mary, Mother of God, pray for us sinners, and in the hour of our death. Amen.

Who made this part?

The holy Catholic Church in the Council of *Ephesus* year of our Lord 431, (Pope *Celestine* presiding) against Nestorius, the heretic, who denied our

Lady to be the Mother God, and would only call her the Mother of *Christ*. See *Baronius*, *An. 4. 31.*

What means, Pray for us sinners now?

It means, that we need divine assistance every day.

What means, And at the hour of our death?

It meaneth that we then especially shall need the blessed *Mary*, and her Son *Jesus*, and therefore pray for it. The word *Amen*, signifies, let it be done, so.

CHAP. VII.

Charity Expounded.

What is Charity?

It is the gift of God, or a supernatural quality infused by God into the soul of man, by which we love God above all things, and our neighbours as ourselves, for his sake.

Why is it called supernatural?

Because it is not in the power of nature to obtain by the special grace and gift of God.

Is charity imputed as protestants would have it, or is it a quality truly inherent in the soul?

It is truly inherent in the soul, as wisdom is inherent in a soul that is wise, and love in a soul that loveth.

Q. How prove you that ?

A. First out of *Rom.* v. 5. "The charity which is poured forth in our hearts, by the Holy which is given us."

Secondly, out of *Dan.* vi. 22. "Before his God) justice hath been found in me."

Thirdly, out of *Ephes.* iii. 17, 18, where St. Paul for his brethren, "That Christ may dwell by your hearts : that, being rooted and founded in you may be able to comprehend, with all the what is the breadth, and length, and height depth."

Q. What is it to love God above all things ?

A. To be willing to lose all things, rather than grace or love of God by mortal sin.

Q. Who has this love ?

A. They who keep the commandments of God according to that, "This is the charity of God, that keep his commandments ; and his commandment is not heavy." 1 *John* v. 3.

Q. Hath not he charity then, that breaks an commandments ?

A. He hath not ; for "he that saith, he knoweth and doth not keep his commandments, is a liar, truth is not in him." 1 *John* ii. 4.

Q. What is it to love our neighbours as ourself ?

A. To wish him as much good as we wish ourself and to do him no wrong.

Q. Who is our neighbour ?

A. All men, women, and children, even those injure us, or differ from us in religion, but are Catholics.

Q. Why so ?

A. Because they are the images of God, and redeemed with the blood of Christ.

Q. Why especially Catholics ?

A. Because they are all members of the mystical Body of Christ, which is the church.

Q. Whence ariseth the obligations of loving our neighbour ?

A. Because God hath commanded it : and 'tis

say, I love God, and hateth his brother, he is a liar.' 1 John, iv. 20.

Q. Are we not also bound to love our enemies?

A. We are, according to that, "It was said of old, Thou shalt not kill: but I say unto you, Love your enemies." Matt. v. 43, 44.

Q. What kind of love are we bound to show to our enemies?

A. We are bound to use a civil behaviour towards them, to pray for them in general, and to be disposed to do any charitable office for them when their necessity require it.

Q. What is the highest act of charity?

A. To give our life for God's honour, and the salvation of our neighbour.

Q. Why is charity the greatest and most excellent of virtues?

A. Because it is the life of all the rest, "Faith without charity is dead." James ii. 26.

Q. What state of life do we conceive to be of greatest perfection?

A. That which of its own nature and proper institution obligeth to the highest and greatest charity, for charity is perfection, and such is the state not only of bishops, but also, as many probably think, of pastors who have the charge of souls.

Q. How prove you that?

A. Out of 1 John xv. 13; "Greater charity than this no man hath, that a man yield his life for his friends," which is the proper obligation of every parish priest, according to that, "The good pastor giveth his life for his sheep," John x. 12.

Q. How prove you the necessity of charity?

A. Out of John iv. 16. "He that remains in charity, remains in God, and God in him," and chap. iii. ver. 14, "He that loves not, remains in death."

Q. What are the effects of charity?

A. It destroys sin. "Charity covers a multitude of sins," James v. 20, and gives spiritual life to the soul. "In this we know that we are translated from death to life, because we love the brethren." 1 John iii. 14.

CHAP. VIII.

Of the Commandments in general.

Q. WHAT is the principal aim or end of the commandments?

A. To teach us the will and pleasure of the God, or the love of God, and our neighbour. 'loveth his neighbour hath fulfilled the law.' *Rom.*

Q. Why are the commandments (excepting the prohibition of the sabbath-day) called the commandments of the law of nature?

A. Because God wrote them in the heart of man at the creation, being the very dictates of natural reason.

Q. When did he renew them in the written law?

A. When he gave them to *Moses* on mount Sinai by thunder and lightning, written in two tables of stone. *Exod. xx.*

Q. Why in thunder and lightning?

A. To move us to a careful observance of the law.

Q. Are all men bound to know the commandments?

A. For the substance of them they are, because they are the rule of our whole life and actions.

Q. How do you prove them to be only ten?

A. Out of *Deut. iv. 13.* "He shewed his commandments which he commanded you to do, and the ten words which he wrote in two tables of stone."

Q. By what kind of sins are the commandments violated?

A. By mortal sins only; for venial sins are not directly speaking contrary to the end of the commandments, which is charity.

Q. How declare you that?

A. Because a venial sin, for example, a vain or officious or jesting lie, which hurts nobody, or of a pin or an apple, is not of weight enough to break the charity between man and man, much less between man and God.

Q. Is it possible for us to keep all the commandments?

A. Not only possible, but necessary and easy with the assistance of God's grace.

Q. How do you declare that?

A. Because God is not a tyrant to command

sibilities under pain of eternal damnation, as he doth the keeping his commandments.

Q. How prove you that ?

A. First out of *Exod.* xx. and *Deut.* xxviii. 15. where he often commands them to be kept, threatening grievous punishments to such as break them.

Secondly, out of *Matt.* v. 19. "Whosoever, therefore, shall break one of these least commandments, and shall teach men so, he shall be called the least in the kingdom of heaven : but whosoever shall do and teach, the same shall be called great in the kingdom of heaven."

Thirdly, out of *Matt.* xi. 29, 30. "Take up my yoke upon you (saith our Lord) for my yoke is sweet, and my burthen light." And again, 1 *John* v. 3. "His commandments are not heavy."

Q. Hath God ever promised to enable man to keep them ?

A. He hath, and also actually to make them keep and do them.

Q. How prove you that ?

A. Out of *Ezek.* xxxvi. 27. "I will put my spirit in the middle of you, (saith our Lord) and I will make ye walk in my precepts, and keep my judgments and do them."

And again, chap. xxxvii. 23, 24. "They shall be my people, and I will be their God : there shall be one pastor of them all, they shall walk in my judgments and keep my commandments and do them."

Q. How do you prove that any have kept them ?

A. Out of *Luke* i. 6. "*Zachary* and *Elizabeth* were both just before God : walking in all the commandments and justifications of our Lord without reproof.

Q. How prove you the keeping them to be necessary to salvation ?

A. First, out of *Matt.* xix. 17. "If thou wilt enter into life (saith our Lord) keep the commandments."

Secondly, out of *Luke* x. 25, 28, where the lawyer had asked, what he should do to possess everlasting life, and had repeated the sum of the commandments : *Christ* answered him saying, "Do this, and thou shalt live."

10 *The First Commandment Expounded.*

Thirdly, out of *Rom. ii. 13.* "Not hearers of the law are just with God, but doers of the law shall be justified"

OF THE COMMANDMENTS IN PARTICULAR.

The First Commandment Expounded.

Q. WHAT is the first commandment?

A. I am the Lord thy God, who brought thee out the land of Egypt, and out of the house of bondage. Thou shalt not have strange gods before me. Thou shalt not make to thyself a graven thing, nor the likeness of any thing that is in heaven above, or in the earth below, or of those things that are in the waters under the earth. Thou shalt not adore nor worship them; I am the Lord thy God, mighty, jealous, visiting the sins of the fathers upon their children, to the third and fourth generation of them that hate me; and showing mercy to thousands of those that love me, and keep my commandments. *Exod. xx.*

Q. What are we commanded by this precept?

A. To serve, love, adore, and worship one only, true living, and eternal God, and no more.

Q. What are we forbidden by this precept?

A. Not to worship any creature for a God, or give it the honour which is due to God.

Q. What is the honour due to God?

A. A supreme and sovereign honour, which is due by divines *Latria*; by which we honour him as the master of life and death, as our creator, redeemer, server, and last end.

Q. How do men sin against this commandment?

A. By worshipping idols and false gods, by er doubting in faith, by superstition and witchcraft.

Q. How else?

A. By communicating with infidels or here believing dreams, &c.

Q. How do you prove it a great sin to go to with heretics?

A. Because by so doing we outwardly deny and profess their false faith.

Q. What scripture have you against it?

A. Out of *Luke* xvii. 23, 24, where Christ forbids it, saying, "And they shall say to you, Lo! here Christ, Lo! there Christ; go ye not, neither do you follow them."

Q. What other proof have you?

A. Out of *Tit.* iii. 10, 11. "A man that is a heretic, after the first and second admonition, avoid, knowing that he that is such an one is subverted and sinneth."

Q. How do you prove it unlawful to go to witches and fortune-tellers?

A. Out of *Deut.* xviii. 10, 11. "There shall not be found among you any one that shall expiate his son or daughter making them to pass through the fire, or that useth divination, or any observer of times, or enchanter, or witch, or a charmer, or a wizard, or necromancer, &c. For all these things our Lord abhorreth."

Q. What understand you by these words. Thou shalt not make to thyself any graven thing, &c. Thou shalt not adore them, &c.

A. I understand that we must not make idols or images, nor any graven thing whatsoever, to adore it as a god, or with God's honour.

Q. Why are not these words expressed at length in many of our short catechisms?

A. Because they are sufficiently included in the preceding words, "Thou shalt not have strange (or other) gods before me."

Q. How declare you that?

A. Because if we must have no other but the only true God, who created heaven and earth, then it is clear to the reason of every child, that we must not have many gods, or any graven things for gods, or adore any other things for God.

Q. Why do Protestants or those of new religions, instead of graven things, translate graven images?

A. Because they have a will to corrupt the text, in hope by so doing to persuade ignorant people, that Catholics are idolaters, and break the first commandment by making and worshipping images.

Q. How do you prove they corrupt the text?

A. Because the Hebrew word is *Pesel*, which signifies a graven thing, the Greek is *Idolon*, an Idol, and the

And, "Our Lord is well pleased in them that hope in his mercy." *Psalm cxlvi. 11.*

Q. What other good doth Hope?

A. It moves us to devout and humble prayer.

Q. What is prayer?

A. It is the lifting up of the mind to God, by which we beg for good things, and to be free from evils, or by which we bless and praise God.

Q. What are the conditions of good prayer?

A. That it may be made with reverence, attention, humility, and perseverance.

Q. What vices are opposite to hope?

A. Despair and presumption.

Q. What is despair?

A. It is a diffidence in the mercy of God, and merits of Christ, even to death.

Q. What is presumption?

A. It is a foolish and desperate confidence of salvation, without endeavouring to live well or keep the commandments.

Q. How is despair the cause of sin?

A. Because despairing men are wont to say, if I shall be damned, I shall be damned, and so use no endeavour to do good or avoid evil.

Q. How is presumption the cause of sin?

A. Because presumptuous men used to say, God is merciful and will forgive our sins, how great soever, and at what time soever, we do penance; and out of this take liberty to sin.

Q. How must our hope be balanced between these two extremes?

A. By a filial fear, and an humble distrust of our own works, as they are ours.

Q. Is prayer good against both these?

A. It is, according to that of *Luke xxii. 40*, "pray ye, that so ye may not fall into temptation."

Q. For what else availeth prayer?

A. For the avoiding of evils and the obtaining all benefits.

Q. How prove you that?

A. Out of *John xv. 23*, "Whatsoever (saith our Sa-

a crucifix, or tear a picture of *Jesus Christ* in pieces, and throw the pieces into the fire ; and would show him the council of *Trent*, Sess. 25, which teaches thus, " Images are not to be venerated for any virtue of divinity that is believed to be in them, or for any trust or confidence that is to be put in them, as the *Gentiles* did of old, who reposed their hope and trust in their idols ; but because the honour that is exhibited to them, is referred to the prototypes represented by them," &c.

Q. What benefits do we receive by images ?

A. Very great, because they movingly represent to us the mysteries of our Saviour's passion, as also the martyrdoms and examples of his saints.

Q. Is there not some danger of Idolatry in the frequent use of images ?

A. Truly none at all ; for it is not possible that any rational man, who is instructed in Christianity, would conceive or think a piece of painted wood or marble, is that God and man, *Christ Jesus*, who was born of the Virgin *Mary*, died on the cross, arose from the dead, ascended into heaven, and sits now on the right hand of God.

Q. But how, if such inconveniences happen, at least by accident ?

A. Let the abuse be mended, and not the good institution taken away, or blamed ; For man's nature is subject to hurt itself, even in the best things, which must not therefore be given over.

Q. How do you prove it lawful to paint God the Father like an old man, seeing he is a pure spirit, and hath no body ?

A. Because he appeared to the prophet *Daniel* in the shape of an old man, *Dan. 7*, but this is to be understood, that the pictures we make, are not the proper images of God the Father, but that shape wherein he appeared to *Daniel*. And the like is to be understood of the pictures of angels, to wit, that they are not proper images of them, according to their spiritual substance, but of the shape they appear in to men.

Q. What utility doth accrue to us by our honouring and canonizing Saints ?

A. Very great, seeing it much conduceth to the attainment of their virtues, and the love of God, make know that it is possible even for ourselves, to receive the like reward.

Q. How declare you that ?

A. Because the higher esteem we have of the and the excellency of their state, the more ardent needs be our desire, and the stronger our courage and undertake what they did and practised.

Q. Is it lawful to honour the angels and saints?

A. It is with *Dulia*, an inferior honour, proper to their excellency, which they have from God whom we honour in them.

Q. How prove you that ?

A. First, out of *Josue* v. 14, where the angel Lord said to Josue, "I am the prince of the host Lord," Josue fell on his face to the ground; and shipping, said, "What saith my Lord to his servant?"

Secondly, out of *Apoc.* xxii. 8, where John (the angel had already forbidden him so to do, for of his apostolical dignity, chap xix. 10.) "fell down to adore before the feet of the angel, who sheweth these things."

Q. Is it lawful to honour the relics of saints?

A. With a relative honour it is, referring it to God.

Q. How prove you that ?

A. First, because a dead man was raised from the dead to life by touching the bones of *Eliseus* the prophet, *4 Kings* xiii. 21.

Secondly, out of *Matt.* ix. 20, 21, where a woman was healed of her bloody flux, by touching the hem of our Saviour's garment, and she would be healed.

Thirdly, out of *Acts* xviii. 19. "The handkerchiefs and aprons which had but touched the body of Paul, cast out devils, and cured all diseases."

Q. How prove you that dead and inanimate things (for example, medals, crosses, churches, and the like) are capable of sanctity and grace?

A. First, out of *Joshua* iv. 16, and *Ex*

the Angel saith to *Moses* and *Joshua*, "Loose the shoes from thy feet, for the ground whereon thou standest is holy ground."

Secondly, out of *Matt.* xxiii. 17, 18, where we read, that the temple sanctifieth the gold, and the altar the gift. "Ye fools and blind, (saith our Lord,) whether is the greater, the gold, or the temple that sanctifieth the gold? the gift, or the altar that sanctifieth the gift?"

Thirdly, out of *Tim.* iv. 4, 5. "Every creature of God is sanctified by the word of God and prayer," and out of 2 *Peter* i. 18, where he calls the mountain *Tabor* a holy hill, because Christ was transfigured upon it.

Q. How prove you that pilgrimages to holy places, as to mount *Calvary*, mount *Tabor*, and the sepulchre of Christ, are laudable and pious practices?

A. First, out of *Deut.* xvi. 16, where God himself commanded, that thrice a year all the people should come up into *Jerusalem*, to adore and make their offerings to him.

Secondly, the example of Christ himself, our blessed Lady, and St. Joseph, "who went up to *Jerusalem*, the solemn day of the *Pasch*." *Luke* ii. 41, 42.

Thirdly, out of *Acts* i. 27, 28, where the *Ethiopian* eunuch, going on a pilgrimage to *Jerusalem*, was in his return converted and baptized by St. Philip, so pleasing was his pilgrimage to God.

Finally, because it was foretold by the prophets, that those places which Christ sanctified by his passion should be of great pilgrimage and adoration, "We will adore (saith *David*) in the place where his feet stood," *Psalms* cxxxi. 7. And in *Isa.* xi. 10, we read, "To him shall the Gentiles pray, and his sepulchre shall be glorious."

Q. How do you prove it lawful to go on pilgrimages to the shrines of Saints?

A. Because, as you have read already, their relics are holy and venerable things, and God is pleased to work great cures and miracles by them for such as are devout honourers of them.

Q. Is there any power now in the church to do miracles?

A. There is according to that unlimited promise of

56 *The Second Commandment Expounded.*

Christ. "And these signs shall follow them that believe: In my name they shall cast out devils: they shall speak with new tongues: they shall lay their hands upon the sick, and they shall recover." *Mark xvi. 17.*

Q. Have these things been done in latter ages?

A. They have, and are, as you may see in the unquestioned histories and records of all Catholic countries where many great miracles wrought by the servants of God, especially at pilgrimages and shrines of Saint are yearly registered under the depositions of eye-witnesses, men above all exceptions, which cannot be denied unless we deny all history.

Q. Why do the pretended reformers say miracles are ceased?

A. Because they have never yet been able to do any in confirmation of their errors.

Q. Why are so few done here in our days?

A. By reason of the incredulity of many bad Christians. *Matt. xiii. 58.*

Q. What necessity is there for the belief of miracles?

A. Doubtless very great; because the belief of miracles well grounded, make men extremely apprehensive of the presence of God, and his immediate government of human affairs; so that he who absolutely denies miracles, is to be suspected of not believing particular providence, which is the main string on which all Christians depend.

The Second Commandment Expounded.

Q. WHAT is the second commandment?

A. Thou shalt not take the name of the Lord thy God in vain.

Q. What is forbidden by this precept?

A. All false, rash, and unnecessary oaths.

Q. What kind of sins are false and rash oaths?

A. Mortal sins, if they be voluntary and deliberate because by such oaths, we call God to witness a lie; at least to that which is uncertain.

Q. What are the necessary conditions of a lawful oath?

A. *Truth*, that we hurt not God's honour; *just*

A. That Christ may reign in us in this life by grace, and in the next by glory, presenting us a kingdom to his Father.

Q. Who say this petition ill?

A. Such as are willing slaves to sin, and to the devil.

The Third Petition.

Q. WHAT is the third petition?

A. Thy will be done on earth as it is in heaven.

Q. What do we beg by this?

A. That God would enable us by his holy grace to keep his commandments, and obey his will in all things.

Q. What mean you by the words, on earth as it is in heaven?

A. We beg by those, that we may be as ready and willing to do the will of God on earth, as the blessed saints and angels are in heaven.

The Fourth Petition.

Q. WHAT is the fourth petition?

A. Give us this day our daily bread.

Q. What do we beg by this?

A. All food and nourishment for our souls and bodies.

Q. What is the food of the soul?

A. The word of God, the holy sacraments, especially the blessed Eucharist, and divine grace.

Q. How prove you, that by this petition Christ intended the blessed bread of the *Eucharist*?

A. Because in *Matt. vi. 11*, we read "our supersubstantial bread."

Q. Why is the *Eucharist* called our daily bread?

A. Because it is daily offered for our sins on the altar, and we ought daily to receive it, at least in spirit and desire.

Q. Who say this petition ill?

A. Such as are cold and careless in coming to the sacraments, and in hearing divine service, or exhortations; and such as ascribe their temporal goods and blessings to their own industry and providence, and not to any special bounty or gift of God.

A. In the old law; when God gave the commandments to *Moses*, on mount *Sinai*, written with his own finger in two tables of stone, *Exod. xx. 1, &c. xxxi. 18*

Q. Why was the *Jewish Sabbath* changed into the *Sunday*?

A. Because *Christ* was born upon a *Sunday*, rose from the dead upon a *Sunday*, and sent down the Holy Ghost upon a *Sunday*: works not inferior to the creation of the world.

Q. By whom was it changed?

A. By the Governors of the Church, the Apostles, who also kept it; for St. John was in Spirit on the Lord's Day, (which was Sunday.) *Apoc. i. 10.*

Q. How prove you that the Church hath power to command feasts and holydays?

A. By the very act of changing the sabbath into *Sunday*, which Protestants allow of; and therefore they fondly contradict themselves, by keeping *Sunday* strictly, and breaking most other feasts commanded by the same Church.

Q. How prove you that?

A. Because by keeping *Sunday*, they acknowledge the Church's power to ordain feasts, and to command them under sin: and by not keeping the rest by her command, they again deny, in fact, the same power.

Q. What other proof have you?

A. Out of *John x. 22*, where we read that *Christ* himself was present, and kept the Dedication of the temple in *Jerusalem*, a feast ordained by *Judas Maccabæus*, 1 *Macc. iv. 59.*

And out of *Acts ii. 1, 4*, where the Apostles, keeping the feast of *Pentecost*, "were all filled with the Holy Ghost." Neither do Protestants as yet differ from this, though some have lately prohibited and profaned both it and the holy feast of the Resurrection, and all the other feasts of the Church.

Q. What commandment have you from God for obedience to the Church in things of this nature?

A. Out of *Acts xv. 41*, where we read that "St. Paul went about confirming the Churches, and commanding them to keep the precepts of the Apostles and the wo-

icients." And out of *Luke* x. 16. "He that heareth you, heareth me; and he that despiseth you (the Church) despiseth me."

Q. May temporal princes and the laity make a holyday?

A. With consent and approbation of the Church, they may, otherwise not; because this is an act of spiritual jurisdiction.

Q. For what end doth the Church ordain holydays?

A. For the increase of piety, and the memory of special benefits received from God.

Q. If keeping the *Sunday* be a church precept, why is it numbered in the decalogue, which are the Commandments of God, and the Law of Nature?

A. Because the substance or chief part of it, namely, "That a day be set apart for the service of God," is of Divine Right, and of the Law of Nature; though the determining this particular day, *Sunday* rather than *Saturday*, be a Church ordinance and precept.

Q. Did not *Christ*, when he confirmed the rest, confirm also this commandment?

A. In as much as it belongeth to the law of nature, he did: but not as it belonged to the ceremonial law of the *Jews*, and was affixed to *Saturday*, therefore, now we are not bound to keep *Saturday*.

Q. Why so, I pray you?

A. Because that particular day was a command of the ceremonial law of the *Jews*, which was abrogated, and ceased to oblige after the death of *Christ*.

Q. To what are we obliged by this precept?

A. To spend the *Sunday* in prayer and divine service.

Q. What is the best means to sanctify the *Sunday*?

A. By hearing mass, confessing our sins, communicating, hearing sermons, and reading good books.

Q. What is forbidden by this precept?

A. All profane employments, and servile labours, excepting such as are of necessity, as dressing meat, serving cattle, &c. or such as appertain to piety and works of mercy.

Q. Who break this commandment?

A. Such as without necessity spend any considerable part of the *Sunday* in servile labours.

Q. Who say this petition ill?

A. They who commit their evils before God, and multiply their sins without remorse.

CHAP. VI.

The Hail Mary, or Angelical Salutation.

Q. What is the Hail Mary?

A. It is a most honourable salutation to the blessed Virgin Mary, and prayer to her.

Q. How do you prove it lawful to honour her?

A. Out of *Luke* i. 48, where (by inspirations from God) she prophesied, saying, "All generations shall call me blessed."

Q. How many parts hath the Hail Mary?

A. It hath three parts.

Q. What is the first part?

A. Hail Mary, full of grace, the Lord is with thee.

Q. Who made this part?

A. The Holy Ghost, though it was delivered by the angel *Gabriel*, *Luke* i. 28.

Q. What signifies the word Hail?

A. It signifies, Rejoice or be glad, O Mother of God.

Q. Why do we invite her by this prayer to rejoice?

A. Because it renews the memory of her blessed Son's conception, which is an infinite cause of joy to her and the whole court of heaven.

Q. What signifies the word Mary?

A. It signifies star of the sea.

Q. Why is she properly called the star of the sea?

A. Because she shines on us by her exemplary virtue in this sea of miseries, like a most glorious star.

Q. What mean you by the words, full of grace?

A. I mean that the Blessed Virgin hath a special fullness and prerogative of grace for the conception of her Son.

Q. What means, The Lord is with thee?

A. It means that the whole Trinity was with her at *is time in a particular manner.*

THE SECOND TABLE OF THE LAW.

The Fourth Commandment Expounded.

Q. WHAT is the fourth commandment?

A. Honour thy father and mother.

Q. What are we commanded by this precept?

A. To love, reverence, obey, and relieve our parents in their wants.

Q. Why to love them?

A. Because, under God they are the chief causes of our very life and being; and do not only bring us forth with much grief and pain, but bring us up with much love, labour, and solicitude.

Q. How are we bound to reverence them?

A. Not only inwardly in our heart, but also outwardly in our carriage and comportment.

Q. Why to obey them?

A. Because they are God's vicegerents, and have received power from him (from whom is all paternity in heaven and earth) both to direct us, instruct us, and correct us.

Q. In what things are we bound to obey our parents?

A. In all that is not sin, according to that, "Children obey your parents in all things, for that is pleasing unto God." *Col.* iii. 20.

Q. What is prohibited by this precept?

A. All sourness, stubbornness, and disobedience to parents.

Q. What is the reward of dutiful children?

A. Long and happy life; "The blessing of heaven comes upon them, and remains to the end of their days." *Ecc.* iii. 10.

Q. What is the reward of undutiful children?

A. A short and sinful life, accompanied with an untimely death: witness the example of *Absalom*, *2 Kings* viii. 14.

Q. What other proof have you?

A. That of *Prov.* xxx. 17. "The eye that mocketh at his father, and that despiseth the travail of his mother in bearing him, let the ravens of the torreat pick it out and the young of the eagle eat it."

2 *The Fourth Commandment Expounded.*

Q. What signifies the word Father ?

A. It signifies not only our corporal parents, but our Ghostly Father, and all lawful superiors.

Q. What owe we to the Ghostly Father ?

A. Love, reverence, obedience, and maintenance.

Q. Why love ?

A. Because they are the fathers and feeders of our souls, and under God and his saints, the instrumental cause of our spiritual good : " For in Christ Jesus I have begun to live through the gospel," (saith St. Paul.) 1 Cor. iv.

Q. Why reverence ?

A. Because they are God's anointed, and represent the person of Christ.

Q. Why obedience ?

A. Because God hath appointed them to be our spiritual pastors, guides, and governors.

Q. In what are we bound to obey them ?

A. In all things belonging to faith, doctrine, and government of our souls.

Q. Is any great honour due to priests and ghostly fathers ?

A. There is, according to that of St. Paul. the priests who rule well be esteemed worthy of honour ; especially they who labour in the word and doctrine." 1 Tim. v. 17.

Q. Have you any other place ?

A. Yes, *Eccle. vii. 13, 32, 33*, " With all thy heart and reverence his priests, with all thy love them that made thee and forsake not his honour God with all thy soul, and honour the king. And the reason is, for if we owe love, honour, and obedience to our carnal parents, much more to our spiritual, by how much the soul surpasseth the body, as there is none greater than priests, who are ordained to shut and open the gates of heaven, as to convert the substance of bread and wine, into precious body and blood of our blessed Saviour, person is greater honour due, than to them that be our fathers, and the disregard of *spiseth* Christ himself, and the disregard of *origin of impiety.*

Q. How may we sin against priests and ghostly fathers?

A. By disobeying or detracting them, or believing slanderous reports against them, upon mere hearsay, or the testimony of insufficient witnesses, or without witnesses.

Q. What testimony is sufficient against a priest?

A. I will tell you out of St. Paul's mouth: "Against a priest (saith he to *Timothy* the bishop of *Ephesus*) receive not an accusation under two or three witnesses." 1 Tim. v. 19, and 21, "I charge thee before God, and Christ Jesus, and the elect angels, that thou observe these things without prejudice, doing nothing by declining to either side."

Q. Is it convenient to ask a blessing of priests?

A. It is, because they give it in the name and person of Christ.

Q. What warrant have you for it?

A. First out of *Mark* 14, 16, where "Christ laying his hands upon the children, blessed them."

Secondly, the example of *Melchisedech* blessing *Abraham*; upon which St. Paul saith, "without all contradiction, that which is less, is blessed of the better." *Heb.* vii. 7.

Q. What scripture have you for obedience to priests?

A. *Heb.* xiii. 17. "Obey your prelates, and be subject to them; for they watch, as being to render an account for your souls." And in the old law, disobedience to the priests was punished with death, *Deut.* xvii. 12.

Q. In what are we bound under sin to obey princes and temporal magistrates?

A. In all things (which are not sin) belonging to the good and peace of the commonwealth.

Q. How prove you that?

A. First, out of *Rom.* xiii. 1. "Let every soul be subject to the higher powers, for there is no power but of God: he therefore that resists power, resists the ordinance of God."

Secondly, out of 1 *Pet.* ii. 13, 14. "Be ye subject to every creature for God, whether to the king as ex-

say, I love God, and hateth his brother, he is a liar.' 1 John, iv. 20.

Q. Are we not also bound to love our enemies?

A. We are, according to that, "It was said of old, Thou shalt not kill: but I say unto you, Love your enemies." Matt. v. 43, 44.

Q. What kind of love are we bound to show to our enemies?

A. We are bound to use a civil behaviour towards them, to pray for them in general, and to be disposed to do any charitable office for them when their necessity require it.

Q. What is the highest act of charity?

A. To give our life for God's honour, and the salvation of our neighbour.

Q. Why is charity the greatest and most excellent of virtues?

A. Because it is the life of all the rest, "Faith without charity is dead." James ii. 26.

Q. What state of life do we conceive to be of greatest perfection?

A. That which of its own nature and proper institution obligeth to the highest and greatest charity, for charity is perfection, and such is the state not only of bishops, but also, as many probably think, of pastors who have the charge of souls.

Q. How prove you that?

A. Out of 1 John xv. 13; "Greater charity than this no man hath, that a man yield his life for his friends," which is the proper obligation of every parish priest, according to that, "The good pastor giveth his life for his sheep," John x. 12.

Q. How prove you the necessity of charity?

A. Out of John iv. 16. "He that remains in charity, remains in God, and God in him," and chap. iii. ver. 14, "He that loves not, remains in death."

Q. What are the effects of charity?

A. It destroys sin. "Charity covers a multitude of sins," James v. 20, and gives spiritual life to the soul. "In this we know that we are translated from death to life, because we love the brethren." 1 John iii. 14.

any one strike thee on the right cheek, turn to him also the other."

Q. What else is forbidden by this precept?

A. To seek, wish, or desire our own, or any other man's death, out of impatience or passion, or to cause women with child to miscarry.

The Sixth Commandment Expounded.

Q. WHAT is the sixth commandment?

A. Thou shalt not commit adultery.

Q. What is prohibited by this precept?

A. All carnal sin with another man's wife, or another woman's husband, and chiefly adultery; as also fornication and pollution.

Q. How prove you fornication and pollution to be mortal sins?

A. Out of *Col.* iii. 5, 6. "Mortify, therefore, (saith St. Paul,) your members, which are upon the earth: fornication, uncleanness, lust, evil concupiscence, and covetousness, which is the service of idols: for which things the wrath of God cometh upon the children of unbelief."

Q. In what case is it lawful for a man to dismiss his wife?

A. Only in case of evident adultery.

Q. Can he that hath so dismissed his wife, marry another during her life?

A. He cannot; for "he that dismisseth his wife and marries another, committeth adultery," *Matt.* v. 32. And *Luke* xvi. 18. "He that marries her, that is so dismissed, commits adultery."

Q. Why is adultery a far greater sin than fornication?

A. Because it is a greater injury to our innocent neighbour, as also to the sacrament of matrimony.

Q. How prove you that a wife so dismissed from her husband, cannot marry again during her husband's life?

A. Out of 1 *Cor.* vii. 10, 11. "But to them, that are married, not I, but the Lord commandeth, that the wife depart not from her husband: and if she depart, that she remain unmarried." And ver. 39. "A woman is bound to the law, so long as her husband liveth; but if her husband sleep (that is be dead) she is at liberty, let her marry whom she will."

abilities under pain of eternal damnation, as he doth the keeping his commandments.

Q. How prove you that ?

A. First out of *Exod.* xx. and *Deut.* xxviii. 15. where he often commands them to be kept, threatening grievous punishments to such as break them.

Secondly, out of *Matt.* v. 19. "Whosoever, therefore, shall break one of these least commandments, and shall teach men so, he shall be called the least in the kingdom of heaven : but whosoever shall do and teach, the same shall be called great in the kingdom of heaven."

Thirdly, out of *Matt.* xi. 29, 30. "Take up my yoke upon you (saith our Lord) for my yoke is sweet, and my burthen light." And again, 1 *John* v. 3. "His commandments are not heavy."

Q. Hath God ever promised to enable man to keep them ?

A. He hath, and also actually to make them keep and do them.

Q. How prove you that ?

A. Out of *Ezek.* xxxvi. 27. "I will put my spirit in the middle of you, (saith our Lord) and I will make ye walk in my precepts, and keep my judgments and do them."

And again, chap. xxxvii. 23, 24. "They shall be my people, and I will be their God : there shall be one pastor of them all, they shall walk in my judgments and keep my commandments and do them."

Q. How do you prove that any have kept them ?

A. Out of *Luke* i. 6. "*Zachary* and *Elizabeth* were both just before God : walking in all the commandments and justifications of our Lord without reproof.

Q. How prove you the keeping them to be necessary to salvation ?

A. First, out of *Matt.* xix. 17. "If thou wilt enter into life (saith our Lord) keep the commandments."

Secondly, out of *Luke* x. 25, 28, where the lawyer had asked, what he should do to possess everlasting life, and had repeated the sum of the commandments : *Christ* answered him saying, "Do this, and thou shalt live."

Q. What is usury?

A. It is to receive, or to hope for some money or money's worth, as gain, above the principal, immediately out of the consideration of loan.

Q. How prove you usury and bribery to be great sins?

A. Out of *Psalm* xiv. 1, 6. "O Lord, who shall dwell in thy tabernacle, or who shall rest in thy holy mountain? He that hath not given his money to use, nor taken bribes upon the innocent man." And from *Ezek.* xxii. 12. "Thou hast taken usury and increase, and hast covetously oppressed thy neighbours. I will disperse thee in the nations, and will scatter thee among the countries." Likewise from *Luke* vi. 35, where the Lord says, "Do good and lend, hoping for nothing thereby." See on this the Catechism of the holy council of Trent.

Q. How are rich men soonest brought to beggary?

A. By mingling other men's goods among their own.

Q. How do men generally sin against this precept?

A. Princes, by imposing unjust taxes on their subjects; subjects, by not paying their due taxes to their princes: buyers and sellers, by deceitful weight and measure, or by exceeding the just prices: masters, by defrauding servants of their wages: and servants, by embezzling their masters' goods. "And that no man over-reach or deceive his brother in business: because the Lord is the avenger of all such things, as we have told you before, and have testified." 1 *Thess.* iv. 6.

The Eighth Commandment Expounded.

Q. WHAT is the eighth commandment.

A. Thou shalt not bear false witness against thy neighbour.

Q. What is prohibited by this precept?

A. All false testimonies, rash judgment, and lies.

Q. Why is false testimony so great a sin?

A. Because it is against the justice of God, and our neighbour.

Q. How prove you that corrupt judgment is a great sin?

A. Out of *Isai.* v. 22, 23, 24. "Wo be to you that call evil good, that justify the impious man for bribe

A. Out of *Luke* xvii. 23, 24, where Christ forbids it, saying, "And they shall say to you, Lo! here Christ, Lo! there Christ; go ye not, neither do you follow them."

Q. What other proof have you?

A. Out of *Tyt.* iii. 10, 11. "A man that is a heretic, after the first and second admonition, avoid, knowing that he that is such an one is subverted and sinneth."

Q. How do you prove it unlawful to go to witches and fortune-tellers?

A. Out of *Deut.* xviii. 10, 11. "There shall not be found among you any one that shall expiate his son or daughter making them to pass through the fire, or that useth divination, or any observer of times, or enchanter, or witch, or a charmer, or a wizard, or a necromancer, &c. For all these things our Lord abhorreth."

Q. What understand you by these words. Thou shalt not make to thyself any graven thing, &c. Thou shalt not adore them, &c.

A. I understand that we must not make idols or images, nor any graven thing whatsoever, to adore it as a god, or with God's honour.

Q. Why are not these words expressed at length in many of our short catechisms?

A. Because they are sufficiently included in the preceding words, "Thou shalt not have strange (or other) gods before me."

Q. How declare you that?

A. Because if we must have no other but the only true God, who created heaven and earth, then it is clear to the reason of every child, that we must not have many gods, or any graven things for gods, or adore any other things for God.

Q. Why do Protestants or those of new religions, instead of graven things, translate graven images?

A. Because they have a will to corrupt the text, in hope by so doing to persuade ignorant people, that Catholics are idolaters, and break the first commandment by making and worshipping images.

Q. How do you prove they corrupt the text?

A. Because the *Hebrew* word is *Peasel*, which signifies a graven thing, the *Greek* is *Idolon*, an Idol, and the

Latin is *Sculptile*, a graven thing; therefore the word *Image* is a mere corruption.

Q. Is it lawful then to give any honour to the images of *Christ* and his saints?

A. Yes, an inferior or relative honour, as much as they represent unto us heavenly things, but not God's honour, nor yet the honour due to saints.

Q. How prove you that?

A. Out of *Exod.* xxv. 18, 19, 22, where God himself commanded "two cherubims to be made of beaten gold, and to be set on both sides of the ark (before which the people were to pray) and promised that he would speak unto them from the middle of the cherubims;" therefore it is lawful to make images and pray before them.

Q. Do not Catholics pray to images and relics?

A. By no means; we pray before them, indeed, to excite our devotion, and to keep our thoughts collected upon heavenly subjects; but we do not, at all, pray to them: for we know well they can neither see, nor hear, nor help us.

Q. What other proof have you for the lawful use of images?

A. First, out of *John* iii. 14, where Christ approves the making and exalting the brazen serpent, by which the *Israelites* were healed in the desert, and owns it to be an image or figure of himself, exalted on the cross.

Secondly, because we read in *Baronius*, that famous church historian, in the year of Christ, 31, that Christ himself sent his own image to king *Abdagar*, and made it also by the miracle on the handkerchief of St. *Veronica*, and on his own shroud.

Add to this, that the second *Nicene* council, Actio 4. anathematizes image-breakers, that is such as shall break them in contempt or scorn, and all such as allege the places in scripture, which are against idols, are against the sacred images; and also those who say that Catholics honour images as God, with sovereign honour.

Q. How could you further satisfy a Protestant, that should charge you with idolatry, in giving sovereign honour to pictures and images?

A. I would for satisfaction herein, if necessary, break

a crucifix, or tear a picture of *Jesus Christ* in pieces, and throw the pieces into the fire ; and would show him the council of *Trent*, Sess. 25, which teaches thus, "Images are not to be venerated for any virtue of divinity that is believed to be in them, or for any trust or confidence that is to be put in them, as the *Gentiles* did of old, who reposed their hope and trust in their idols ; but because the honour that is exhibited to them, is referred to the prototypes represented by them," &c.

Q. What benefits do we receive by images ?

A. Very great, because they movingly represent to us the mysteries of our Saviour's passion, as also the martyrdoms and examples of his saints.

Q. Is there not some danger of Idolatry in the frequent use of images ?

A. Truly none at all ; for it is not possible that any rational man, who is instructed in Christianity, would conceive or think a piece of painted wood or marble, is that God and man, *Christ Jesus*, who was born of the *Virgin Mary*, died on the cross, arose from the dead, ascended into heaven, and sits now on the right hand of God.

Q. But how, if such inconveniences happen, at least by accident ?

A. Let the abuse be mended, and not the good institution taken away, or blamed ; For man's nature is subject to hurt itself, even in the best things, which must not therefore be given over.

Q. How do you prove it lawful to paint God the Father like an old man, seeing he is a pure spirit, and hath no body ?

A. Because he appeared to the prophet *Daniel* in the shape of an old man, *Dan. 7*, but this is to be understood, that the pictures we make, are not the proper images of God the Father, but that shape wherein he appeared to *Daniel*. And the like is to be understood of the pictures of angels, to wit, that they are not proper images of them, according to their spiritual substance, but of the shape they appear in to men.

Q. What utility doth accrue to us by our honouring, and canonizing Saints ?

A. Very great, seeing it much conduceth to the imitation of their virtues, and the love of God, making know that it is possible even for ourselves, to come the like reward.

Q. How declare you that ?

A. Because the higher esteem we have of the saint and the excellency of their state, the more ardent our needs be our desire, and the stronger our courage, to undertake what they did and practised.

Q. Is it lawful to honour the angels and saints ?

A. It is with *Dulia*, an inferior honour, proportioned to their excellency, which they have from God ; it God we honour in them.

Q. How prove you that ?

A. First, out of *Josue* v. 14, where the angel of the Lord said to Josue, "I am the prince of the host of the Lord," Josue fell on his face to the ground ; and whispering, said, "What saith my Lord to his servant"

Secondly, out of *Apoc.* xxii. 8, where John (though the angel had already forbidden him so to do, because of his apostolical dignity, chap xix. 10.) "fell down adore before the feet of the angel, who shewed him these things."

Q. Is it lawful to honour the relics of saints ?

A. With a relative honour it is, referring it to God's honour.

Q. How prove you that ?

A. First, because a dead man was raised from death to life by touching the bones of *Eliseus* the prophet *4 Kings* xiii. 21.

Secondly, out of *Matt.* ix. 20, 21, where we read a woman was healed of her bloody flux, but by touching the hem of our Saviour's garment, and believing would heal her.

Thirdly, out of *Acts* xviii. 19. "The handkerchiefs and aprons which had but touched the body of St. Paul cast out devils, and cured all diseases."

Q. How prove you that dead and inanimate things (for example, medals, crosses, churches, bread, water and the like) are capable of sanctity and honour ?

A. First, out of *Joshua* iv. 16, and *Exod.* iii. 5, where

he Angel saith to *Moses* and *Joshua*, "Loose the shoes from thy feet, for the ground whereon thou standest is holy ground."

Secondly, out of *Matt.* xxiii. 17, 18, where we read, that the temple sanctifieth the gold, and the altar the gift. "Ye fools and blind, (saith our Lord,) whether is the greater, the gold, or the temple that sanctifieth the gold? the gift, or the altar that sanctifieth the gift?"

Thirdly, out of *Tim.* iv. 4, 5. "Every creature of God is sanctified by the word of God and prayer," and out of 2 *Peter* i. 18, where he calls the mountain *Tabor* a holy hill, because Christ was transfigured upon it.

Q. How prove you that pilgrimages to holy places, as to mount *Calvary*, mount *Tabor*, and the sepulchre of *Christ*, are laudable and pious practices?

A. First, out of *Deut.* xvi. 16, where God himself commanded, that thrice a year all the people should come up into *Jerusalem*, to adore and make their offerings to him.

Secondly, the example of *Christ* himself, our blessed Lady, and St. Joseph, "who went up to *Jerusalem*, the solemn day of the *Pasch*." *Luke* ii. 41, 42.

Thirdly, out of *Acts* i. 27, 28, where the *Ethiopian* eunuch, going on a pilgrimage to *Jerusalem*, was in his return converted and baptized by St. Philip, so pleasing was his pilgrimage to God.

Finally, because it was foretold by the prophets, that those places which *Christ* sanctified by his passion should be of great pilgrimage and adoration, "We will adore (saith *David*) in the place where his feet stood," *Psalms* xxxi. 7. And in *Isa.* xi. 10, we read, "To him shall be Gentiles pray, and his sepulchre shall be glorious."

Q. How do you prove it lawful to go on pilgrimages to the shrines of Saints?

A. Because, as you have read already, their relics are holy and venerable things, and God is pleased to work great cures and miracles by them for such as are devout honourers of them.

Q. Is there any power now in the church to do miracles?

A. There is according to that unlimited promise of

Q. What ground have you for that ?

A. Out of *Acts* xiii. 2, 3. "And as they (the apostles) were ministering to our Lord, and fasting, the Holy Ghost said, Separate ye unto me Saul and Barnabas to the work whereto I have them : Then with fasting and praying, and imposing hands on them, they dismissed them."

Q. Why abstinence on Fridays ?

A. In memory that Christ suffered for us upon a Friday ; drinking gall and vinegar on the cross ; but especially by custom, which is as good as law.

Q. Why abstinence on Saturdays ?

A. To prepare ourselves for a devout keeping of the Sunday, as also in honour of the blessed Virgin Mary, who stood firm in faith on that day, the apostles themselves wavering.

The Third Precept of the Church Expounded.

Q. WHAT is the third commandment of the church ?

A. To confess our sins at least once a year.

Q. Why was that commanded ?

A. Because otherwise, libertines would not have done it once in many years.

The Fourth Precept of the Church Expounded.

Q. WHAT is the fourth ?

A. To receive the blessed Sacrament at least once a year, and that at Easter, or thereabouts.

Q. Why at Easter ?

A. Because Christ instituted the blessed Sacrament of the Eucharist at his last supper, the Thursday before Easter day.

Q. Why is it said, or thereabouts ?

A. Because it will satisfy the precept, if it be done at any time between Palm Sunday and Low-Sunday.

The Fifth Precept of the Church Expounded.

Q. WHAT is the fifth ?

A. To pay tithes to our pastors.

Q. Why so ?

A. Because as they feed us spiritually, it is should feed them corporally.

Q. How prove you that?

A. Out of *Gal.* vi. 6. Let him that is catech the word communicate to him that catechised all his goods. And 1 *Cor.* ix. 13, 14. They the altar participate with the altar, and so the L dained that they who preach the gospel should the gospel.

The Sixth Precept of the Church Expounded

Q. WHAT is the sixth?

A. Not to solemnize marriage on times prot that is, from the first Sunday of Advent, until T day be past, nor from Ash-Wednesday, until L day be past.

Q. Why so?

A. Because those are times of special piety ar ance, and should not therefore be spent in feast carnal pleasures.

Q. What sin is it to break any of these church mandments?

A. A mortal sin of disobedience, according 1 "He that will not hear the church, let him be un as a heathen and a publican." *Matt.* xviii. 17.

CHAP. X.

The Counsel of Christ and his Church Expoun

Q. How many counsels are there?

A. There be three principal ones.

Q. What is the first of them?

A. Voluntary poverty, which is observed by w leaving all things to follow Christ.

Q. How prove you that to be a work of perfe

A. Out of *Matt.* xix. 21. "If thou wilt be 1 go, sell what thou hast, and give to the poor, as shalt have treasure in heaven, and come and follo

Q. How prove you this to be meritorious?

A. Out of the same chap. ver. 27, 28, 29. "Peter, answering, said to him: Behold, we have

things, and have followed thee : what, therefore, shall we have ? And Jesus said to them : Amen I say to you, that you, who have followed me, in the regeneration, when the Son of man shall sit on the seat of his majesty, you also shall sit on twelve seats judging the twelve tribes of Israel. And every one that hath left house, or brethren, or sisters, or father, or mother, or wife, or lands for my name's sake, shall receive a hundred-fold, and shall possess life everlasting."

The Second Counsel.

Q. WHAT is the second counsel ?

A. Perpetual chastity ; which is a voluntary abstaining from marriage, and all carnal pleasures, for the love of God.

Q. Is this also a work of perfection ?

A. It is, for Christ himself was born of a virgin, and counselled virginity, though he commanded it not.

Q. How prove you that ?

A. Out of *Matt. xix. 12.* "There be eunuchs, (said he,) which have made themselves so for the kingdom of heaven ; he that can take let him take."

Q. How prove you that virginity is a more perfect state than marriage, or that it is lawful to vow virginity ?

A. Out of *1 Cor. vii. 37, 38.* "He that hath determined in his heart, being settled, not having any necessity, but having power of his own will to keep his virgin, doth well ; therefore he that joineth his virgin in marriage doth well, but he that joineth her not, doth better."

Q. What other proof have you ?

A. Out of *1 Tim. v. 5.* "But she that is a widow indeed, (that is, a vowed widow,) and desolate, let her hope in God, and continue in prayer and supplications night and day." And ver. 11, 12. "But the younger widows avoid, for they, when they shall be wanton in Christ, will marry, having damnation, because they have made void their first faith, that is, their vow of chastity, according to the fourth council of Carthage, Canon 104, and all the Fathers."

Q. Who was the first that taught marriage to be better than virginity, and persuaded priests and nuns to marry ?

icients." And out of *Luke* x. 16. "He that heareth you, heareth me; and he that despiseth you (the Church) despiseth me."

Q. May temporal princes and the laity make a holyday?

A. With consent and approbation of the Church, they may, otherwise not; because this is an act of spiritual jurisdiction.

Q. For what end doth the Church ordain holydays?

A. For the increase of piety, and the memory of special benefits received from God.

Q. If keeping the *Sunday* be a church precept, why is it numbered in the decalogue, which are the Commandments of God, and the Law of Nature?

A. Because the substance or chief part of it, namely, "That a day be set apart for the service of God," is of Divine Right, and of the Law of Nature; though the determining this particular day, *Sunday* rather than *Saturday*, be a Church ordinance and precept.

Q. Did not *Christ*, when he confirmed the rest, confirm also this commandment?

A. In as much as it belongeth to the law of nature, he did: but not as it belonged to the ceremonial law of the *Jews*, and was affixed to *Saturday*, therefore, now we are not bound to keep *Saturday*.

Q. Why so, I pray you?

A. Because that particular day was a command of the ceremonial law of the *Jews*, which was abrogated, and ceased to oblige after the death of *Christ*.

Q. To what are we obliged by this precept?

A. To spend the *Sunday* in prayer and divine service.

Q. What is the best means to sanctify the *Sunday*?

A. By hearing mass, confessing our sins, communicating, hearing sermons, and reading good books.

Q. What is forbidden by this precept?

A. All profane employments, and servile labours, excepting such as are of necessity, as dressing meat, serving cattle, &c. or such as appertain to piety and works of mercy.

Q. Who break this commandment?

A. Such as without necessity spend any considerable part of the *Sunday* in servile labours.

A. To be confirmed in our strength and growth, without which we can never be made men : to this answers confirmation, by which we are made strong and perfect Christians, able to profess our faith before our enemies.

Q. What is our third corporal necessity ?

A. That (being now made men) we have a competence of daily food and sustenance : to which the blessed Eucharist corresponds, by which our souls are fed with divine grace as often as we worthily receive it, or offer it with the priest on the altar.

Q. What is the fourth necessity of the body ?

A. That we have physic when we are sick and wounded : to this the sacrament of penance answers ; by which our maladies and sores of sin are healed.

Q. What is our fifth necessity of the body ?

A. That we have the necessary helps against the agonizing pangs of death ; to this corresponds extreme unction, by which our soul is strengthened in her last agony, against the violent assaults of the devil.

Q. What is the sixth corporal necessity ?

A. " That we be governed by laws and magistrates, so to avoid injustice and confusion : " to this Holy Order corresponds, by which we are provided with spiritual magistrates to guide and govern us.

Q. What is the seventh corporal necessity ?

A. That we be multiplied in a lawful manner ; and to this matrimony corresponds, by which we are not only multiplied in a natural, but in a holy and sacramental way.

Q. What is a Sacrament in general ?

A. It is a visible sign of invisible grace, divinely instituted by Christ, for our sanctification.

Q. How prove you that Christ ordained them all ?

A. Because it is not in the power of any pure creature to give infallible virtue, causing grace, to sensible and material things, such as the sacraments are ; according to the council of *Trent*, *Sess. 7. Can. 1.*

Q. From what have the Sacraments their force and efficacy ?

A. *From the blood and passion of Christ, which they apply to our souls.*

Q. How prove you that?

A. *Rom.* vi. 3. "Know you not that all we, who are baptized in Christ Jesus, are baptized in his death?" *Rom.* v. 9. "Much more therefore, now being justified by his blood, shall we be saved from wrath by him."

Q. For what end did Christ ordain the Sacraments?

A. To be external and visible marks and proofs of his holy faith, by which the faithful might be preserved from Infidels and Heretics; and also to be effectual means of our salvation, and certain remedies against sin.

Q. What things are essential to a Sacrament?

A. Matter and form.

Q. Do all the seven Sacraments give grace?

A. They do, according to the council of *Trent*.

Q. What is grace?

A. It is a supernatural quality produced in our souls, and inherent in them, by which we are made the adopted children of God, special partakers of the divine nature, and like to God, in some degree; as iron is made like to fire by heat.

Q. How many of these Sacraments give a character?

A. Three: Baptism, Confirmation, and Holy Orders.

Q. What is a sacramental character?

A. It is a supernatural mark in the soul, whereby we are marked for God's servants, which can never be blotted out.

Q. In what manner do the sacraments give an increase of grace?

A. As means or instruments only; for God is the principal cause thereof.

Q. Who is the ordinary minister of a Sacrament?

A. A priest; excepting Holy Orders and Confirmation, which are referred to the Bishops alone.

Q. Why did Christ confine the administration of the Sacraments to the Hierarchy and to the priests?

A. "O the depth of the riches, of the wisdom and knowledge of God! How incomprehensible are his judgments, and how unsearchable his ways! For who hath known the mind of the Lord? Or who hath been his counsellor?" *Rom.* xi. And we know from *Paul, Ephes.* iv. 11, that "Christ gave indeed

stles, and some prophets, and others evangelists, and some pastors and teachers. That we may not now be tossed to and fro, and carried about with wind of doctrine, in the wickedness of men, in which we are by which they lie in wait to deceive." Hence, Paul, speaking of the Sacraments, says, 1 Cor. iv. 1. Let them consider us as the ministers of Christ and stewards of the mysteries of God." "And we are (2 Cor. 5. 20.) therefore ambassadors of Christ: God, as by us, exhorting by us."

What is the intention of the ministers to do what Christ has commanded, on a condition, without which the Sacraments are of no avail?

It is; also the intention of the receiver to receive what is ordained, if he be at the years of understanding. They say you, If he be at the years of understanding? because for infants in the Sacraments of baptism the intention of the Church sufficeth.

Baptism Expounded.

Why is Baptism the first Sacrament?

Because by it we are born again, or created anew in Christ Jesus, and therefore before it we are not capable of receiving any other.

What is Baptism?

It is an exterior washing of the body, under a set of words.

What is the necessary matter of Baptism?

Natural water only; for artificial water will not

What is the form of it?

I baptize thee in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Ghost.

What if a man leave out the word, (I baptize) or the three persons?

Then the baptism is invalid.

Where did Christ express the form of baptism, or give us a command to baptize?

1 Matt. xxviii. 29. "Go therefore, (saith he) and baptize all nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Ghost."

Q. Can a man be saved without baptism ?

A. He cannot, unless he have it either actual or in desire, with contrition, or to be baptized in his blood as the holy *Innocents* were, which suffered for Christ.

Q. How prove you that ?

A. Out of *John* iii. 5. "Unless a man be born again of water, and the Holy Spirit, he cannot enter into the kingdom of God."

Q. Can no man but a priest baptize ?

A. Yes, in case of necessity, any layman or woman may do it, and not otherwise.

Q. What is a chief necessity ?

A. When a child is in danger of death, and a priest cannot be had.

Q. What are the effects of baptism ?

A. It makes us the children of God, and remits both original and actual sin, if he that is baptized be guilty of it.

Secondly, it infuseth justifying grace into the soul, with habits of faith, hope, and charity, and all supernatural gifts and virtues.

Q. How prove you that ?

A. Out of *Gal.* iii. 27. "As many of you as are baptized in Christ, have put on Christ."

Secondly, out of *1 Cor.* vi. 10, 11, where speaking of fornicators, idolaters, thieves, adulterers, and liars: "These things, (saith St. Paul) ye were, but ye are washed, but ye are sanctified, but ye are justified in the name of our Lord Jesus Christ, and in the spirit of God."

Thirdly, out of *Tit.* v. 6, 7. "He hath saved us by the laver of regeneration and renovation of the Holy Ghost, whom he hath abundantly poured out upon us, by Jesus Christ our Saviour, that being justified by his grace we may be heirs, according to the hope of life everlasting."

Q. What other effect hath baptism ?

A. It makes a spiritual mark or character in the soul, which shall remain for ever, either to our great joy in heaven, or our confusion in hell.

Q. What sin is it to baptize a man twice ?

A. A mortal sin of sacrilege.

Q. How prove you that ?

A. Out of *Heb. vi. 4, 5, 6.* "It is impossible for those that have been illuminated, and made partakers of the Holy Ghost, (*to wit, by baptism*) and are fallen, &c. to be renewed again unto penance," &c. viz. by a second baptism.

Q. What if a man die for the faith, before he can be baptized ?

A. He is a true martyr, and baptized in his own blood.

Q. Why have we a Godfather and a Godmother in baptism ?

A. That if our parents should neglect it, or be prevented by death, they may instruct us in the faith of Christ, which obligation lies on them.

Q. How many godfathers may we have ?

A. But one godfather and one godmother, since the council of *Trent*.

Q. Why so few ?

A. To prevent the too great spread of spiritual affinity, which is contracted between them and their god-child, and his father and mother, which is an impediment, that makes the marriage not only unlawful, but also invalid between the parties.

Q. How can infants be christened, which have no actual faith ?

A. In the faith of the Church, and of their godfathers and godmothers.

Q. Why do we use so many ceremonies in baptism ?

A. To stir up reverence to the sacrament, and signify its inward effects.

Q. What meaneth the priest's breathing on the child's face, according to the use of some rituals ?

A. It signifies, that by baptism, the evil spirit is cast out, and the spirit of God is given to him.

Q. Why is the child signed on the breast and forehead with the sign of the Cross ?

A. To signify that he is there made the servant of Christ crucified.

Q. Why is salt put into the child's mouth ?

A. To signify, that by baptism he receives grace and gifts to preserve his soul from corruption of sin: and

warn Christians, that their actions and words ought to be seasoned with prudence and discretion signified by salt.

Q. Why doth the priest lay spittle on his ears and nostrils?

A. Because Christ by so doing, healed one that was both deaf and dumb; as also to signify, that by baptism his ears are opened to the word of faith, and his nostrils to the good odour of all Christian virtues.

Q. Why doth the priest ask the child, "If he renounce the Devil, and his pomps?"

A. To signify, that he who will be the child of God, cannot be the child of the Devil.

Q. What means the several anointings of the child?

A. They signify the interior anointings, or unction of divine grace, given to the soul in baptism.

Q. What mean they in particular?

A. He is anointed on the head to signify, "that by baptism he is made partaker of the kingly dignity of Christ;" on the shoulders to signify, "he must bear his Cross courageously," on the breast, to signify, "that the heart is there strengthened with grace, to fight against the Devil."

Q. What signifies the white garment given to the child?

A. The purity and innocence which he there receives.

Q. What signifies the hallowed light given to the child?

A. The light of faith, and fire of charity with which his soul is endued by baptism; and that he is bound to hold up through life the lamp of good works, always burning, always shining before men, that they may glorify our Father who is in Heaven.

Confirmation Expounded.

Q. WHAT is the second Sacrament?

A. Confirmation.

Q. When did Christ ordain this Sacrament?

A. The time is not certain; but divines most probably hold, it was instituted at Christ's last supper.

Q. What is the matter of this Sacrament?

A. Oil, mingled with balm, blessed by a bishop.

What is the form of it?

I confirm thee with the sign of the Cross, I confirm the chrism of salvation, in the name of the Father, of the Son, and of the Holy Ghost.

What scripture have you for this Sacrament?

1st, 2 Cor. i. 22. "And he that confirmeth us in Christ, and hath anointed us, is God, who sealed us; (with the spiritual character) and pledge of the spirit in our hearts."

2dly, Acts viii. 14, 15, 16, where when Philip had converted the city of Samaria to the apostles who were at Jerusalem, sent to two St. Peter and St. John, to confirm them; "who when they were come (saith the text) prayed for them, that they might receive the Holy Ghost; for he was not yet come upon any of them, but they were only baptized in the name of our Lord Jesus; then did they impose their hands upon them, and they received the Holy

Spirit, Acts xix. 5, 6, where we read that St. Paul came and confirmed about twelve of St. John's disciples. Hearing these things, they were baptized in the name of our Lord Jesus; and when St. Paul had imposed his hands on them, the Holy Ghost came upon them.

Why is oil used in this Sacrament?

It signifies that the principal and proper effect of this Sacrament is the interior unction of the Holy Ghost, which makes us perfect Christians, and able to profess our faith against persecuting tyrants.

Why is balm used in it?

It signifies the good odour of a Christian name. According to that, "We are a good odour of Christ to the world," 2 Cor. ii. 15.

What are the effects of confirmation?

It gives us the undaunted confidence and sufferings of the martyrs, and saints of God, after they had received the Holy Spirit.

When were the apostles confirmed?

At Whitsunday, in an extraordinary manner, the Holy Spirit descending upon them in tongues of fire.

Q. Doth confirmation give a character.

A. It doth, according to 2 *Cor.* i. 22, above ei where we read "who also has sealed us," (that is, v a character.)

Q. Who is the minister of this Sacrament?

A. A bishop only, as appears by *Acts* viii. ab cited, where two bishops were sent into *Samaria*, give it.

Q. Is there any necessity for this Sacrament?

A. There is a moral necessity for it, according to council of *Laodicea*, *Can.* 48: "Those that have b baptized, must after baptism receive the most h chrism, and be made partakers of the heavenly ki dom."

Q. What authority of fathers and school divines h you for its necessity?

A. First, the authority of *St. Thomas*, who in the crament of confirmation, 3 P. Q. 72, *Art.* 8, *ad* 4, affir that it is a dangerous thing to die without it.

Secondly, that of *St. Jerome*, in his epistles aga the Luciferians. "Dost thou not know also (saith that this is the custom of the churches, that hands sh be imposed on such as have been baptized, and so Holy Ghost be invocated? Dost thou require to kn where it is written? In the acts of the apostles, though there were no authority of scripture for it, the consent of the whole world in this behalf, would equal to a precept; for many other things also w are observed in the churches by tradition, do usurp themselves the authority of a written law." You he owns it to be commanded in the scripture; and it were not so, yet to be equal to a precept, and h the authority of a written law, because it is an ap lical tradition, that such as have been baptized, i also be confirmed.

Q. What authority of Popes have you for it?

A. First, that of *St. Clement*, pope and marty his epistle to *Julius*, "All must make haste, (mark word *must*) without delay to be regenerated to God, at length consigned (confirmed) by a bishop; that i receive the seven-fold grace of the Holy Ghost."

reason is, first, "Because the end of every one's life is uncertain," secondly, "Because otherwise he that is baptized, cannot be a perfect Christian, nor have a seat among the perfect; if not by necessity, he shall remain and not have that confirmation, which we have received from blessed *Peter*, and all the rest of the apostles have taught, our Lord commanding." Secondly, that of Pope *Melchides*, teaching "That baptism and confirmation can by no means be separated one from another, unless by death prevented, and that one of them cannot rightly be perfected without the other. And moreover, that as confirmation is given by greater men, so it is to be held in greater veneration than baptism," see *De Cons., Dist. 5, Cap. De his*.

Add to this, that without confirmation (according to all the fathers) we are not perfect Christians.

Q. What then would you think of those, who for particular and private ends, should slight this Sacrament, and teach the laity not to receive it, when they might conveniently have it?

A. Truly I think they would slight the mission of the Holy Ghost, (for this Sacrament is a continuance of that mission unto us) and would be great enemies of Christianity.

Q. What sin is it not to receive it, when we may conveniently have it?

A. Mortal sin, if it be done out of contempt, or any gross neglect, especially in a place of persecution.

Q. How prove you that?

A. Because by so doing we expose ourselves to great danger of denying our faith, against which danger, it was peculiarly ordained by Christ our Lord.

Q. At what age is confirmation now commonly received?

A. At seven years old.

Q. Why not sooner?

A. That so we may be able to prepare ourselves for it, and remember that we have received it; for it cannot be twice given.

Q. Why is a little blow given on the cheek to him that is confirmed?

A. Jovinian, an old condemned Heretic, according to St. Augustin, in his book of Heresies, *Her.* 82, and in the 2d book of Retractions, he calls him a monster for it, saith the church stoutly resisted him, chap. 22.

The Third Counsel.

Q. WHAT is the third counsel?

A. Obedience, which is a voluntary submission to another's will, and in all that is not sin.

Q. What warrant have you for that?

A. First the example of Christ himself, who was obedient to our Lady and St. Joseph, "And he went down with them, and came to Nazareth, and was subject to them." *Luke* ii. 51.

Secondly, *Heb.* xiii. 17. "Obey your prelates, and be subject to them; for they watch, being to render an account for your souls."

CHAP. XI.

Of the Sacraments in general.

Q. How many Sacraments are there?

A. Seven.

Q. How call you them?

A. Baptism, Confirmation, Eucharist, Penance, Extreme Unction, Holy Order, and Matrimony. See Council of Trent, *Sess.* 7. *Can.* 1.

Q. Is there any cause why the number of Sacraments should be seven?

A. Yes; a probable cause is the proportion which is between spiritual and corporal life.

Q. In what consists this proportion?

A. In this; that as in corporal and natural life, there be seven principal or chief necessities, so are there likewise seven spiritual, to which the seven Sacraments correspond.

Q. What is our first corporal necessity?

A. To be born into this world: to this baptism corresponds, by which we are regenerated unto God, and become the heirs of God and co-heirs of Christ.

Q. What is the second corporal necessity?

A. To be confirmed in our strength and growth, without which we can never be made men: to this answers confirmation, by which we are made strong and perfect Christians, able to profess our faith before our enemies.

Q. What is our third corporal necessity?

A. That (being now made men) we have a competence of daily food and sustenance: to which the blessed Eucharist corresponds, by which our souls are fed with divine grace as often as we worthily receive it, or offer it with the priest on the altar.

Q. What is the fourth necessity of the body?

A. That we have physic when we are sick and wounded: to this the sacrament of penance answers; by which our maladies and sores of sin are healed.

Q. What is our fifth necessity of the body?

A. That we have the necessary helps against the agonizing pangs of death; to this corresponds extreme unction, by which our soul is strengthened in her last agony, against the violent assaults of the devil.

Q. What is the sixth corporal necessity?

A. "That we be governed by laws and magistrates, so to avoid injustice and confusion:" to this Holy Order corresponds, by which we are provided with spiritual magistrates to guide and govern us.

Q. What is the seventh corporal necessity?

A. That we be multiplied in a lawful manner; and to this matrimony corresponds, by which we are not only multiplied in a natural, but in a holy and sacramental way.

Q. What is a Sacrament in general?

A. It is a visible sign of invisible grace, divinely instituted by Christ, for our sanctification.

Q. How prove you that Christ ordained them all?

A. Because it is not in the power of any pure creature to give infallible virtue, causing grace, to sensible and material things, such as the sacraments are; according to the council of *Trent*, *Sess. 7. Can. 1.*

Q. From what have the Sacraments their force and efficacy?

A. *From the blood and passion of Christ, which they apply to our souls.*

Q. How prove you that ?

A. *Rom.* vi. 3. "Know you not that all we, who are baptized in Christ Jesus, are baptized in his death?" *Rom.* v. 9. "Much more therefore, now being justified by his blood, shall we be saved from wrath by him."

Q. For what end did Christ ordain the Sacraments?

A. To be external and visible marks and proofs of his holy faith, by which the faithful might be distinguished from Infidels and Heretics; and also to be effectual means of our salvation, and certain remedies against sin.

Q. What things are essential to a Sacrament?

A. Matter and form.

Q. Do all the seven Sacraments give grace?

A. They do, according to the council of *Trent*, &c.

Q. What is grace?

A. It is a supernatural quality produced in our souls, and inherent in them, by which we are made the adopted children of God, special partakers of the divine nature, and like to God, in some degree; as iron is like to fire by heat.

Q. How many of these Sacraments give a character?

A. Three: Baptism, Confirmation, and Holy Orders.

Q. What is a sacramental character?

A. It is a supernatural mark in the soul, whereby we are marked for God's servants, which can never be blotted out.

Q. In what manner do the sacraments give an increase of grace?

A. As means or instruments only; for God is the principal cause thereof.

Q. Who is the ordinary minister of a Sacrament?

A. A priest; excepting Holy Orders and Confirmation, which are referred to the Bishops alone.

Q. Why did Christ confine the administration of the Sacraments to the Hierarchy and to the priests?

A. "O the depth of the riches, of the wisdom and knowledge of God! How incomprehensible are his judgments, and how unsearchable his ways! For who hath known the mind of the Lord? Or who hath counselled him?" *Rom.* xi. And we know from *Paul*, *Ephes.* iv. 11, that "Christ gave indeed

apostles, and some prophets, and others evangelists, and others pastors and teachers. That we may not now be children, tossed to and fro, and carried about with every wind of doctrine, in the wickedness of men, in craftiness by which they lie in wait to deceive." Hence, St. Paul, speaking of the Sacraments, says, 1 Cor. iv. 1. So let them consider us as the ministers of Christ and dispensers of the mysteries of God." "And we are (2 Cor. v. 20.) therefore ambassadors of Christ: God, as we were, exhorting by us."

Q. Is the intention of the ministers to do what Christ ordained, a condition, without which the Sacraments subsist not?

A. It is; also the intention of the receiver to receive what Christ ordained, if he be at the years of understanding.

Q. Why say you, If he be at the years of understanding?

A. Because for infants in the Sacraments of baptism the intention of the Church sufficeth.

Baptism Expounded.

Q. Why is Baptism the first Sacrament?

A. Because by it we are born again, or created anew in Christ Jesus, and therefore before it we are not capable of receiving any other.

Q. What is Baptism?

A. It is an exterior washing of the body, under a set form of words.

Q. What is the necessary matter of Baptism?

A. Natural water only; for artificial water will not suffice.

Q. What is the form of it?

A. I baptize thee in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Ghost.

Q. What if a man leave out the word, (I baptize) or any of the three persons?

A. Then the baptism is invalid.

Q. Where did Christ express the form of baptism, and give us a command to baptize?

A. In Matt. xxviii. 29. "Go therefore, (saith he) baptize ye all nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Ghost."

thily, shall be guilty of the body and blood of the Lord:

Q. What is an exterior visible sacrifice ?

A. It is a most necessary act of religion whereby some sensible thing is offered to God by a priest, in order to acknowledge his supreme dominion over us, and our entire dependence on him. It is offered to God as an act of pure adoration, or to render him thanks for his benefits received, or to turn away his anger, or to obtain from him some new blessing, or for all those purposes together.

Q. Is the blessed Eucharist a sacrifice ?

A. It is that *clean oblation*, which the prophet Malachi i. 11, foretold would be offered from the rising to the going down of the sun, in every place among the Gentiles; which was prefigured by Melchisedech, priest of the Most High (Gen. xiv. 28,) when he brought forth bread and wine; and which was, in reality, instituted at the last supper by Jesus Christ, when he took bread and wine, blessed them, and distributed them with his own hands amongst the apostles, saying, **THIS IS MY BODY; THIS IS MY BLOOD.** Christ Jesus is a priest forever, according to the order of Melchisedech (*Heb. v. 8,*) and so he instituted, according to his order; that is to say, in bread and wine, this great sacrifice of the New Law.

All the Holy Popes, and Fathers, and Councils of the primitive ages, teach that the mass is the self same sacrifice of bread and wine that had been instituted by our Saviour; whilst the histories and annals of all countries, not excepting England herself, declare that the Holy Mass, but no other sacrifice, came down to them as a part and parcel of Christianity, from the apostolic age.

Q. Why are the priests obliged to receive under both kinds ?

A. Because they offer sacrifice, and represent the bloody sacrifice made upon the cross, where the blood was actually divided from the body, and being offered of the sacrifice, are bound to receive also the cup. Christ's command expressed, *Matt. xxvi. 27.* "Drink all of this,"

Q. Did the laity ever communicate under both kinds?

A. They did sometimes in the primitive church, and may again, if holy church shall so appoint; but now it is prohibited by the church, to prevent the great danger of shedding the cup, neither are the laity in this defrauded of any thing; for they receive whole Christ under one kind, which is incomparably more than the pretended reformers have under both, who receive only a bit of baker's bread, with a cup of common vintner's wine. See "Holy Order expounded." See also, "The Mass expounded," ch. 22.

Penance Expounded.

Q. WHAT is the fourth Sacrament?

A. Penance.

Q. What warrant have you for doing acts of penance?

A. First, out of *Apoc. ii. 4.* "Thou hast left thy first charity, therefore be mindful from whence thou art fallen, and do penance?"

Secondly, "And JESUS began to preach, and say, Do ye penance; for the kingdom of heaven is at hand." *Matt. iv. 17.*

Q. When did Christ ordain this Sacrament?

A. When he breathed on his disciples, saying, "Receive ye the Holy Ghost, whose sins ye shall forgive, they are forgiven, and whose sins ye shall retain, they are retained." *John xx. 22, 23.*

Q. What is the matter of this Sacrament?

A. The sins and confession of the penitent.

Q. What is the form of it?

A. I absolve thee from thy sins, in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Ghost.

Q. What are the effects of it?

A. It reconciles us to God, and either restores or increases grace?

Q. How prove you that?

A. Out of *John xx. 23*, before cited. And out of *John i. 9.* "If we confess our sins, he is faithful and just to forgive us our sins, and cleanse us from all iniquity."

Q. How many parts hath the Sacrament of penance?

A. It hath three parts; namely, contrition, confession, and satisfaction.

Q. What is contrition?

A. It is a hearty sorrow for our sins, proceeding immediately from the love of God above all things, and joined with a firm purpose of amendment.

Q. What is attrition?

A. It is imperfect contrition, arising from the consideration of the turpitude of sin, or fear of punishment; and if it contain a detestation of sin, and hope of pardon, it is so far from being itself wicked, that though alone it justify not, yet it prepares the way to justification; and disposes it at least remotely towards obtaining God's grace in this Sacrament.

Q. What if a dying man be in mortal sin, and cannot have a priest?

A. Then nothing but perfect contrition will suffice, it being impossible to be saved, without the love of God.

Q. What is a firm purpose of amendment?

A. It is a resolution not only to shun sin, but also the occasions of it.

Q. How long has confession been in use and practice?

A. Ever since the Apostles' time, according to *James*, v. 16. "Confess therefore your sins to one another, and pray for one another, that you may be saved." And *Acts* xix. 18. "Many of them that believed came confessing and declaring their deeds."

Q. What is confession?

A. It is a full, sincere, and humble declaration of our sins to a priest, to obtain absolution.

Q. Is there any special good or comfort to man from confession?

A. Very great, because as to a mind laden with secret griefs, the best of comforts is to disclose her case to some faithful friend; so to a soul laden with secret sins one of the greatest comforts, and best remedies possible, is to have selected persons ordained for that end by Christ himself, men of singular piety and learning, and not questionable by any law of what they hear in confession, to whom one may confess his sins, with

an assurance both of comfort, correction, and direction for the amendment of his faults.

Q. What are the necessary conditions of a good confession?

A. That it be short, diligent, humble, sorrowful, sincere, and entire.

Q. How, short?

A. By avoiding superfluous words and circumlocutions.

Q. How, diligent?

A. By using a competent time and care in the examining of our conscience.

Q. How, humble?

A. By making our confession with humble hearts.

Q. How, sorrowful?

A. By stirring up sorrow for our sins.

Q. How, sincere?

A. By confessing our sins plainly, without seeking to lessen or excuse them.

Q. How, entire?

A. By confessing not only in what things we have sinned mortally, but also how often, as near as we are able to remember.

Q. What if a man do knowingly leave out any mortal sin in his confession for fear of shame?

A. He makes his whole confession void, and commits a great sacrilege by lying to the Holy Ghost, and abusing the Sacrament.

Q. How prove you that?

A. By the example of Ananias and his wife Saphira, who were struck dead at the feet of St. Peter, for daring to lie to the Holy Ghost. *Acts* v. 5, 10.

Q. Is he that hath so done bound to confess all again?

A. Yes, all that are mortal, together with that which he left out, and the sacrilege he committed.

Q. What is satisfaction?

A. The sacramental penance, enjoined us by the priest at confession, (which is considered a part of this sacrament,) besides which we may also add more, for our own sins, by our voluntary prayers, fasting, or other good works, or sufferings.

Q. For what do we satisfy by that penance?

A. For such temporal punishments as remain due sometimes for our sins, after they are forgiven us.

Q. How do you prove that priests have power to impose penance?

A. Out of 1 *Cor.* vi. 3, where St. *Paul* excommunicated the incestuous *Corinthian*; “*I* (saith he) absent in body, but present in spirit, have already judged him that hath so done, &c. to deliver such a one to Satan for the destruction of the flesh, that the soul may be saved,” ver. 5.

Q. How prove you that temporal punishments may remain due for our sins, after the sins themselves be forgiven us?

A. First, because *Adam*, after his sin was forgiven him, was notwithstanding cast out of paradise for ever, and his whole posterity made subject unto death and many miseries, in punishment of that sin. *Gen.* iii. 25.

Secondly, because *David*, after his sin of adultery was forgiven him, was temporally punished for it with the death of his child: “Our Lord (saith *Nathan*) hath taken away thy sin, nevertheless thy son shall die.” 2 *Kings* xii. 13, 14.

Thirdly, because “Whom our Lord loveth he chastiseth.” *Heb.* xii. 6.

Q. By what other means are those temporal punishments released?

A. By indulgences.

Q. What is an indulgence?

A. Not a pardon for sins to come, or leave to commit sin, (as Protestants do falsely and slanderously teach) but a releasing only of such temporal punishments, as remain due to those sins, which have already been forgiven us by penance and confession.

Q. How doth an indulgence release those punishments?

A. By the superabundant merits of Christ and his saints, which it applies to our souls by the special grant of the church.

Q. When did Christ give his church power to grant indulgences?

A. When he said to St. *Peter*, "To thee will I give the keys of the kingdom of Heaven, whatsoever thou shalt bind on earth, it shall be bound in Heaven, and whatsoever thou shalt loose on earth, shall be loosed in Heaven." *Matt.* xvi. 19.

How prove you that the apostles did ever use this power?

A. Out of 2 *Cor.* ii. 10, where St. *Paul* remitted part of the *Corinthian's* penance. "To him that is such a one (said he) this rebuke sufficeth, &c. whom you have pardoned any thing, I also pardon."

Q. What is required for the gaining an indulgence?

A. That we perform the works enjoined us, and that the last part of them be done in a state of grace.

Q. What are those works?

A. Fasting, prayer, and alms deeds; as also confession and communion.

Extreme Unction Expounded.

Q. WHAT is the fifth Sacrament?

A. Extreme unction.*

Q. When did Christ institute it?

* Unction is twofold, exterior and interior; by the former is the body anointed, and by the latter the soul: there is an instance of the former in *James* v. 14, and of the latter in the parable of the ten talents, *Matt.* xxv. The exterior anointing of the body is expressive of the interior unction or invisible grace produced in the soul. Under the Old Law were the priests, prophets and kings anointed: *Kings* ix. 16; 2 *Kings* ii. 4; and 3 *Kings* xix. 15. Our Blessed Redeemer is called the Anointed, from the Greek verb *Krio* which signifies to *anoint*, because God anointed him with the Holy Spirit: *Acts* x. 38. And we are called Christians, because we profess the law and doctrine of God, the Anointed; and because we are anointed with holy oil and chrism. The child is anointed at baptism, the priest in receiving Holy Orders, the king and queen at their coronation. That the Apostles anointed the sick is clear from *Mark* vi. 13, and that they taught the practice is clear from *Matt.* v. 14. Would they teach or practise the rite if they had not permission from their Divine Master so to do? It is indeed extremely astonishing that the Protestants who pretend to be enamoured with the Bible would discard a rite so sanctioned in both testaments and the usage of all antiquity. See *Canon, Lib.* i. 15.

A. The time is uncertain: some think it was instituted at his last supper; others that it was done between his resurrection and ascension.

Q. By whom was this sacrament promulgated?

A. By *James*, v. 13, 14, 15. "Is any man sick among you, let him bring in the priests of the church, and let them pray over him, anointing him with oil, in the name of our Lord, and the prayer of faith shall save the sick man, and our Lord will lift him up, and if he be in his sins shall be forgiven him."

Q. Who is capable of this sacrament?

A. Every true and faithful Christian who is in mortal danger of death by sickness, excepting infants, fools, and such as are always mad.

Q. What is the matter of it?

A. Oil blessed by a bishop.

Q. What is the form of it?

A. "By his own anointing, and his own most pious mercy, our Lord pardon thee, whatsoever thou hast sinned by thy seeing," &c. And so of the other senses, repeating the same words.

Q. What are the effects of extreme unction?

A. It comforts the soul in her last agony against despair, it remits venial sins and removes the relics of sin, and restores corporal health, if it be expedient.

Q. How prove you that?

A. Out of *Mark* vi. 13, where we read, That the apostles anointed with oil many sick, and healed them. Which anointing is understood by many to have been a previous sign of extreme unction, and consequently of its effects.

Q. Why then do so few recover after it?

A. Either because the recovery of the body is not expedient for the soul, or because the sick deferred the sacrament too long, as too many do, or for other indispositions in the receiver of it.

Holy Order Expounded.

Q. WHAT is the sixth Sacrament?

A. Holy order.

Q. To whom doth this appertain?

Q. Can a man be saved without baptism?

A. He cannot, unless he have it either actual or in desire, with contrition, or to be baptized in his blood as the holy *Innocents* were, which suffered for Christ.

Q. How prove you that?

A. Out of *John* iii. 5. "Unless a man be born again of water, and the Holy Spirit, he cannot enter into the kingdom of God."

Q. Can no man but a priest baptize?

A. Yes, in case of necessity, any layman or woman may do it, and not otherwise.

Q. What is a chief necessity?

A. When a child is in danger of death, and a priest cannot be had.

Q. What are the effects of baptism?

A. It makes us the children of God, and remits both original and actual sin, if he that is baptized be guilty of it.

Secondly, it infuseth justifying grace into the soul, with habits of faith, hope, and charity, and all supernatural gifts and virtues.

Q. How prove you that?

A. Out of *Gal.* iii. 27. "As many of you as are baptized in Christ, have put on Christ."

Secondly, out of *1 Cor.* vi. 10, 11, where speaking of fornicators, idolaters, thieves, adulterers, and liars: "These things, (saith St. Paul) ye were, but ye are washed, but ye are sanctified, but ye are justified in the name of our Lord Jesus Christ, and in the spirit of God."

Thirdly, out of *Tit.* v. 6, 7. "He hath saved us by the laver of regeneration and renovation of the Holy Ghost, whom he hath abundantly poured out upon us by Jesus Christ our Saviour, that being justified by his grace we may be heirs, according to the hope of life everlasting."

Q. What other effect hath baptism?

A. It makes a spiritual mark or character in the soul which shall remain for ever, either to our great joy in heaven, or our confusion in hell.

Q. What sin is it to baptize a man twice?

A. A mortal sin of sacrilege.

Q. How prove you that the bishops are of divine right, and have authority from God to rule the church?

A. Out of *Acts* xx. 28. "Take heed unto yourself and to the whole flock, wherein the Holy Ghost has made you bishops to rule the church of God."

Q. How prove you that the bishops only can ordain priests?

A. Out of *Titus* i. 5. "For this cause left I thee Crete, that thou shouldest order the things that we wanting, and ordain priests in every city," (he was bishop.)

Q. What sin is it therefore to oppose *Hierarchy* or *Episcopacy* either in the whole church, or in particular churches?

A. It is a sin of rebellion and high treason against the peace and safety of Christ's spiritual commonwealth the church.

Q. How prove you that?

A. Because no law can subsist without guards and officers for it. Since therefore Christ hath ordained bishops to be the guards and teachers of his law, they who strike at bishops, strike also at the whole law of Christ, and safety of the people.

Q. Why is it requisite that bishops and pastors should have revenues?

A. Because as they bear a considerable charge and office in the commonwealth, therefore, they ought to have a competence for the performance of it. Secondly, to enable them, as good soldiers of Christ Jesus, to keep clear of worldly cares: for "no man, being a soldier to God, entangleth himself with worldly business; that he may please him to whom he hath engaged himself." 2 *Tim.* ii. 4.

Q. What is the office of a priest?

A. To offer sacrifice, and administer the rest of the sacraments, excepting holy order and confirmation.

Q. How prove you a sacrifice in the new law?

A. First, because there is a priesthood, as you have heard, and an altar according to that, "We have an altar (saith St. Paul) whereof they have not power eat, who serve in the tabernacle." *Heb.* xiii. 10.

Secondly, out of *Mal.* i. 11, where he foretold

sacrifice in the new law, saying, "From the rising of the sun, even to the going down, great is my name among the Gentiles, and in every place there is sacrificing, and there is offered to my name a clean oblation, with the Lord of Hosts."

Thirdly, out of *Luke* xxii. 19, 20, where Christ who high priest for ever (according to the order of *Melchisedech*) offered the sacrifice of his own body and blood under the form of bread and wine, saying, "This is my body which is given for you, (it is given for us, you find at his last supper) this is the chalice of the new Testament in my blood, which chalice (according to the great text) is shed for you."

Q. Is it lawful for priests to marry?

A. It is not; there being a precept of the church against it, descending to us by tradition from the apostles; neither did any of the Apostles ever accompany their wives, after their calling to the apostleship; and a vow of perpetual chastity being annexed to the holy orders, in the *Latin* or *Western* church.

Q. Why is it requisite that priests should live chaste and unmarried?

A. Because, as by their ordination they are bound to teach and instruct the faithful, their minds should be totally disengaged from the cares and pleasures of the world, and wholly employed in the study and piety of heavenly things, which is incompatible with the marriage state. *1 Cor.* vii. 32.

Q. What are the lesser orders of the church?

A. *Acolyte*, *lector*, *exorcist*, and *porter*, according to the fourth council of *Carthage*, *Can.* 6.

Q. Is it lawful for women to preach, or to be priests?

A. It is not, according to *1 Cor.* xiv. 34. "Let women keep silence in the churches: for it is not permitted to them to speak, but to be subject, as also the law saith."

Q. Is it lawful for a man to usurp and take upon him priestly power, without the ordination of the church?

A. It is not, according to *Heb.* v. 1, 4. "For every high priest taken from among men, is appointed for men, &c. that he may offer gifts and sacrifices for sins."

neither doth any man take the honour to himself, but that is called of God, as was *Aaron*.

Q. What other proof have you ?

A. Out of *John* x. 1. "Amen I say unto you, he entereth not by the door (*Holy Order*) into the fold of the sheep, but climbs up another way, is a thief and a robber."

Q. What if any man pretend an extraordinary calling ?

A. He must prove it by miracles, or else he esteems himself an impostor.

Q. What examples have you against the usurpation of the priestly power ?

A. That of king *Ozeas*, who was presently visited by God with a leprosy in his forehead, for usurping the priestly office of offering or burning incense in the temple. *2 Paral.* xxvi. 19.

Q. What besides ?

A. The example of *Core*, *Dathan*, and *Abiram* for usurping the office of priest, (though they were themselves true believers) were swallowed up alive beneath the earth, *Numb.* xvi. 32, and two hundred and fifty who were offering incense with them, were consumed with fire from heaven, v. 34, with fourteen thousand seven hundred more, which were also burnt with fire from heaven, for only joining with them, v. 49.

Matrimony Expounded.

Q. WHAT is the seventh Sacrament ?

A. Matrimony.

Q. Where was matrimony first ordained ?

A. In paradise by Almighty God, when he gave Eve as wife to *Adam*, who presently said, "Thereto shall man leave his father and his mother, and cleave unto his wife, and they shall be two in one flesh." *Gen.* ii. 22, 24.

Q. Where was it made a sacrament of the new law ?

A. Where and when Christ instituted this sacrament is uncertain ; some think it done, or at least insinuated at the wedding at *Cana* in *Galilee*, where Christ was present, and wrought his first miracle, "by turning water into wine."

ter into wine." *John* ii. Others, more probably, say it was done, when Christ declared the indissolubility of marriage, saying, "therefore now they are not two, but one flesh: that therefore which God hath joined together, let no man separate." *Matt.* xix. 6.

Q. Why was it requisite that marriage should be made a sacrament?

A. Because it is a contract whereon depends the chief happiness of a married life; as being ordained for the restraint of sinful concupiscence, the good of posterity, the well-ordering our domestic affairs, and the education of our children in the fear and service of God, and therefore ought to be ranked in the highest order of those actions, which Christ hath sanctioned for the use of man.

Q. How prove you marriage to be a sacrament?

A. Because, as you heard, it is a conjunction made and sanctioned by God himself, and not to be dissolved by any power of man.

Q. What other proof have you?

A. Out of *Ephes.* v. 31, 32. "They shall be two in one flesh; this is a great sacrament. But I speak in Christ, and in the church."

Q. What is the matter of this sacrament?

A. The mutual consent of the parties, and giving themselves to one another.

Q. What are the effects of matrimony?

A. It gives special grace to the married couple, to love and bear one with another, as also to bring up their children in the fear and love of God.

Q. What is the principal end of marriage?

A. To beget children, and bring them up in the service of God; and the next to this is, that man may have a remedy against concupiscence, and a helper in the way of salvation.

Q. How great is the tie of marriage?

A. So great that it can never be dissolved but by death, as you have heard out of *Matt.* xix.

Q. What are the obligations of man and wife?

A. To love, honour, and comfort one another,

Q. What besides?

A. Husbands are obliged to cherish and comfort the wives; wives to be subject, obey, and love their husbands.

Q. How prove you that?

A. Out of *Col.* iii. 18, 19. "Women, be subject to your own husbands, as behooveth in our Lord. Men love your wives, and be not bitter towards them." And out of *Ephes.* iv. 22, 23. "Let women be subject to their husbands, as to the Lord, because the man is head of the woman as Christ is head of the church," v. 2 "But as the Church is subject to Christ, so also women to their husbands in all things." And again, v. 3 "Let each man love his wife as himself, and let the wife reverence her husband."

Q. What else?

A. To render mutually the marriage debt, and according to that, "Let the husband render his debt unto his wife, and the wife also in like manner to her husband. The woman now hath no power of her own body, but the husband, and in like manner the man hath no power of his own body, but the woman." *1 Cor.* vii. 3, 4.

Q. Is it lawful for children to marry without the consent of their parents?

A. It is not; neither is it lawful for parents to forbid them to marry against their will.

Q. Why are so many unhappy in their marriages?

A. Because they never consulted with God about them, nor sought to have his blessing in them.

Q. For what other reason?

A. Because they were in the state of sin at the marriage, or married for inordinate love or wealth, and not for the right end of marriage.

Q. What meaneth the blessing of the priest given marriage?

A. It is to beg all blessings of God for the new married couple.

Q. Why is the ring put on the fourth finger?

A. Because that is called the heart finger and hence (they say) a vein in it, which reacheth to the heart; to signify the true and constant love which ought to be between man and wife.

What signifies the ring itself?

It is a symbol of perfection and eternity, being in all parts, and round in figure, without beginning or end, to imitate the perfect and perpetual love of man and wife.

What are the spiritual means to obtain the blessed good children?

Fasting, prayer, and alms-deeds, for so St. Joachim and St. Anne obtained Blessed Virgin Mary; and the Blessed Virgin became the mother of God.

What obligations have parents to their children?

To instruct them in the faith of Christ, to bring up in the fear of God, to give them good example, to keep them out of ill company and other occasions, to feed and nourish them, to provide for them in age, and to correct their faults.

What are the chief and most common impediments of marriage?

Consanguinity and affinity, to the fourth degree inclusively; and in the right line all degrees are prohibited by law of nature, indispensable.

Can the church dispense in these collateral degrees?

She can, excepting only the first collateral degrees of consanguinity, but always sufficient motives must be given.

How prove you that?

The Church having made these laws, for just causes may dispense in them; but when such dispensations are given, those who seek them ought to consider that they may deprive themselves of the blessings attending the marriage state, if the motives alleged be not well founded.

CHAP. XII.

The Cardinal Virtues Expounded.

How many cardinal virtues are there?

There are four: prudence, justice, fortitude, and temperance.

Why are they called cardinal virtues?

Because they are the fountains, and as it were the

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hinges of all good works, from the word *Cardo*, which signifies a *hinge*.

Q. What is prudence ?

A. It is a virtue which makes us wary in all our actions, that we may neither deceive others, nor be deceived ourselves ; or which (according to the rule of honesty) prescribes us what to be desired, and what to be avoided.

Q. How prove you that ?

A. Out of *Eccles.* iii. 32. "A wise heart that hath understanding, will keep itself from all sin, and in the works of justice shall have success."

Q. What is justice ?

A. It is a virtue which gives every man his own according to that, "Render to all men their due, to whom tribute, tribute ; to whom custom, custom ; to whom fear, fear ; to whom honour, honour." *Rom.* xiii. 7.

Q. What is temperance ?

A. It is a virtue which moderates our appetites and desires, that they be according to reason, and not inordinate : "He that is abstinent, (saith the wise man) shall increase in life." *Ecc.* xxxvii.

Q. What is fortitude ?

A. It is a virtue, by which the labours and dangers even of death itself, that are opposite unto virtue, are courageously undertaken and patiently sustained, "The wicked fleeth (saith *Solomon*) when no man pursueth ; but the just man, as a confident lion, shall be without fear." *Prov.* xxviii. 1. And in *1 Pet.* iii. 14, we read, "The fear of them fear ye not, and be not troubled, but sanctify our Lord Christ in your hearts."

Q. Is it necessary for a Christian to be exercised in these virtues ?

A. It is ; for "we must not only decline from evil, but do good," *Psal.* xxxvi. 27.

CHAP. XIII.

The Gifts of the Holy Ghost Expounded.

Q. How many are the Gifts of the Holy Ghost ?

A. *Seven* : wisdom, understanding, counsel, forti-

tude, knowledge, piety, and the fear of the Lord. *Isa.*
xi. 2.

Q. What is wisdom ?

A. It is a gift of God, which teacheth us to direct our whole lives and actions to his honour, and the salvation of our souls.

Q. What is understanding ?

A. It is a gift of God, by which we are enabled to comprehend the high mysteries of our Faith.

Q. What is counsel ?

A. It is a gift of God, by which we discover the frauds and deceits of the Devil, and are not deceived by him.

Q. What is fortitude ?

A. It is a gift of God, whereby we are enabled to undergo and despise all dangers for his sake.

Q. What is knowledge ?

A. It is a gift of God, by which we know and understand the will of God.

Q. What is piety ?

A. It is a gift of God, which makes us devout and zealous in his service.

Q. What is the fear of the Lord ?

A. It is the gift of God, which curbs our rashness, withholds us from sin, and makes us obedient to God's law.

CHAP. XIV.

The Twelve Fruits of the Holy Ghost Expounded.

Q. How many are the fruits of the Holy Ghost ?

A. There are twelve, as you may see, *Gal. v. 22, 23.*

Q. What is the first ?

A. Charity, whose nature and effects you know already.

Q. What is the second ?

A. Joy, by which we are enabled to serve God with cheerful hearts.

Q. What is the third ?

A. Peace, which keeps us unmoved in our minds amidst the storms and tempests of the world.

Q. What is the fourth ?

A. Patience, which enables us to suffer all adversities for the love of God.

Q. What is the fifth?

A. Longanimity, which is an untired confidence of mind, in expecting the good things of the life to come.

Q. What is the sixth?

A. Goodness, which makes us hurt no man, and do good to all.

Q. What is the seventh?

A. Benignity, which causeth an affable sweetness in our manners and conversation.

Q. What is the eighth?

A. Mildness, which allays in us all the motions of passion and anger.

Q. What is the ninth?

A. Fidelity, which makes us punctual observers of our covenants and promises.

Q. What is the tenth?

A. Modesty, which observes a becoming deportment in all our outward actions.

Q. What is the eleventh?

A. Contineney, which makes us not only abstemious in meat and drink, but in all other sensible delights.

Q. What is the twelfth?

A. Chastity, which keeps a pure soul in a pure body.

Q. Who are they that have these fruits?

A. The children of God only; for "whosoever are led by the Spirit of God, they are the sons of God." *Rom. viii. 14.*

CHAP. XV.

The Works of Mercy (corporal and spiritual) Expounded.

Q. How many are the corporal works of mercy?

A. Seven. 1. To feed the hungry. 2. To give drink to the thirsty. 3. To clothe the naked. 4. To harbour the harbourless. 5. To visit the sick. 6. To visit the imprisoned. 7. To bury the dead.

Q. How prove you that these works are meritorious of a reward?

thily, shall be guilty of the body and blood of the Lord."

Q. What is an exterior visible sacrifice ?

A. It a most necessary act of religion whereby some sensible thing is offered to God by a priest, in order to acknowledge his supreme dominion over us, and our entire dependence on him. It is offered to God as an act of pure adoration, or to render him thanks for his benefits received, or to turn away his anger, or to obtain from him some new blessing, or for all those purposes together.

Q. Is the blessed Eucharist a sacrifice ?

A. It is that *clean oblation*, which the prophet Malachy i. 11, foretold would be offered from the rising to the going down of the sun, in every place among the Gentiles ; which was prefigured by Melchisedech, priest of the Most High (Gen. xiv. 28,) when he brought forth bread and wine ; and which was, in reality, instituted at the last supper by Jesus Christ, when he took bread and wine, blessed them, and distributed them with his own hands amongst the apostles, saying, **THIS IS MY BODY ; THIS IS MY BLOOD.** Christ Jesus is a priest for ever, according to the order of Melchisedech (*Heb. v. 8,*) and so he instituted, according to his order ; that is to say, in bread and wine, this great sacrifice of the New Law.

All the Holy Popes, and Fathers, and Councils of the primitive ages, teach that the mass is the self same sacrifice of bread and wine that had been instituted by our Saviour ; whilst the histories and annals of all countries, not excepting England herself, declare that the Holy Mass, but no other sacrifice, came down to them as a part and parcel of Christianity, from the apostolic age.

Q. Why are the priests obliged to receive under both kinds ?

A. Because they offer sacrifice, and represent the bloody sacrifice made upon the cross, where the blood was actually divided from the body, and being offerers of the sacrifice, are bound to receive also the cup, &c. Christ's command expressed, *Matt. xxvi. 27.* "**Drink ye all of this,**"

CHAP. XVI.

The Eight Beatitudes.

Q. WHAT are the eight Beatitudes?

A. Christ "opening his mouth he taught them, saying: 1. Blessed are the poor in spirit: for theirs is the kingdom of heaven. 2. Blessed are the meek: for they shall possess the land. 3. Blessed are they that mourn: for they shall be comforted. 4. Blessed are they that hunger and thirst after justice: for they shall be filled. 5. Blessed are the merciful: for they shall obtain mercy. 6. Blessed are the clean of heart: for they shall see God. 7. Blessed are the peace-makers: for they shall be called the children of God. 8. Blessed are they that suffer persecution for justice sake: for theirs is the kingdom of heaven." *Matt. v. 3, 10.*

Q. Whence ariseth the necessity of suffering persecution?

A. Because all that will live piously in Jesus Christ shall suffer persecution. 2 *Tim. iii. 12.*

CHAP. XVII.

The Kinds of Sin Expounded.

Q. WHY is it necessary for a Christian to know the nature and kinds of sins?

A. That so he may detest and avoid them.

Q. How many kinds of sins are there?

A. Two, namely, *Original* and *Actual*.

Q. What is original sin.

A. It is a privation of original justice, which we inherit from our first parent *Adam*, being all by course of nature, conceived and born in that privation or original sin.

Q. How prove you that?

A. Out of *Rom. v. 12.* "Therefore as by one man sin entered into the world, and by sin death, and so unto all men death did pass, in whom all have sinned."

Q. What are the effects of original sin?

Concupiscence, ignorance, evil inclination, prone to sin, sickness, and death.

How is original sin taken away?

By holy baptism.

Whither go infants that die without baptism?

To a part of hell, where they endure the pain of but not of sense, and shall never see the face of

How prove you that?

Out of *John* iii. 5. "Unless a man be born again, neither by water, nor by the Holy Ghost, he cannot enter into the kingdom of God."

What is actual sin?

It is a thought, word or deed, contrary to the law of God.

What is the sin of omission?

To omit any thing willingly, which is commanded by God or his Church.

Why is actual sin so called?

Because the material part of it is commonly some voluntary acts of ours.

Is all sin voluntary and deliberate?

It is, because (speaking of actual sin) no man sins in doing that which it is not in his power to avoid.

What other proof have you?

Because the whole gospel of Christ is nothing else but an exhortation to do good, and avoid evil, than which nothing were more vain, if it be not in the free will and power of man, assisted by God's grace, to be able to do such things.

What scripture have you for that?

First out of *Gen.* iv. 7. "If thou dost well, shalt thou not receive? But if ill, shall not thy sin be forth-present at the door? But the lust thereof shall be against thee, and thou shalt have dominion over it."

Secondly out of *Deut.* xxx. 19, 20. "I call heaven and earth to witness this day, that I have proposed to thee life and death, blessing and cursing, choose therefore life, that thou mayest live."

Thirdly, out of *1 Cor.* vii. 37. "He that hath determined in his heart being settled, not having necessity,

an assurance both of comfort, correction, and direction for the amendment of his faults.

Q. What are the necessary conditions of a good confession?

A. That it be short, diligent, humble, sorrowful, sincere, and entire.

Q. How, short?

A. By avoiding superfluous words and circumlocutions.

Q. How, diligent?

A. By using a competent time and care in the examining of our conscience.

Q. How, humble?

A. By making our confession with humble hearts.

Q. How, sorrowful?

A. By stirring up sorrow for our sins.

Q. How, sincere?

A. By confessing our sins plainly, without seeking to lessen or excuse them.

Q. How, entire?

A. By confessing not only in what things we have sinned mortally, but also how often, as near as we are able to remember.

Q. What if a man do knowingly leave out any mortal sin in his confession for fear of shame?

A. He makes his whole confession void, and commits a great sacrilege by lying to the Holy Ghost, and abusing the Sacrament.

Q. How prove you that?

A. By the example of Ananias and his wife Saphira, who were struck dead at the feet of St. Peter, for daring to lie to the Holy Ghost. *Acts* v. 5, 10.

Q. Is he that hath so done bound to confess all again?

A. Yes, all that are mortal, together with that which he left out, and the sacrilege he committed.

Q. What is satisfaction?

A. The sacramental penance, enjoined us by the Priest at confession, (which is considered a part of this sacrament,) besides which we may also add more, for our own sins, by our voluntary prayers, fasting, or other good works, or sufferings.

der an account for it at the day of judgment." Now God forbid every idle word should be a mortal sin.

Q. What are the effects of venial sin?

A. It doth not rob the soul of life, as mortal sin doth, but only weakeneth the fervour of charity, and by degrees disposeth unto mortal.

Q. Why are we bound to shun not only mortal, but venial sins?

A. Because "he that contemneth small things, shall fall by little and little." *Eccles. xix. 1.*

Q. What other proof have you?

A. Because "no polluted thing shall enter into the heavenly Jerusalem." *Apoc. xxi. 27*, be it polluted with mortal, or venial sin.

Q. How shall we be able to know when any sin is mortal, and when but venial?

A. Because to any mortal sin it is required, both that it be deliberate, and perfectly voluntary; and that it be a matter of weight against the law of God; one or both of which conditions are always wanting in a venial sin.

Q. How is mortal sin remitted?

A. By hearty penance and contrition.

Q. How is venial sin remitted?

A. By all the sacraments, by holy water, devout prayer, alms-deeds, and the like good works.

Q. Whither go such as die in mortal sin?

A. To hell for all eternity, as you have heard in the Creed.

Q. Whither go such as die in venial sin, or not having fully satisfied for the temporal punishments due to their mortal sins which are forgiven them?

A. To purgatory till they have made full satisfaction for them, and then to heaven.

Q. How prove you there is a purgatory, or a place of punishment, where souls are purged after death?

A. Out of 1 *Pet. iii. 10.* "Christ being dead for our sins, came in spirit, and preached to them also that were in prison, who had been incredulous in the days of Noah, when the Ark was building."

Q. What other proof have you?

A. Out of 1 *Cor. iii. 13.* "The work of every man

A. When he said to St. *Peter*, "To thee will I give the keys of the kingdom of Heaven, whatsoever thou shalt bind on earth, it shall be bound in Heaven, and whatsoever thou shalt loose on earth, shall be loosed in Heaven." *Matt.* xvi. 19.

How prove you that the apostles did ever use this power?

A. Out of 2 *Cor.* ii. 10, where St. *Paul* remitted part of the *Corinthian's* penance. "To him that is such a one (said he) this rebuke sufficeth, &c. whom you have pardoned any thing, I also pardon."

Q. What is required for the gaining an indulgence?

A. That we perform the works enjoined us, and that the last part of them be done in a state of grace.

Q. What are those works?

A. Fasting, prayer, and alms deeds; as also confession and communion.

Extreme Unction Expounded.

Q. WHAT is the fifth Sacrament?

A. Extreme unction.*

Q. When did Christ institute it?

* Unction is twofold, exterior and interior; by the former is the body anointed, and by the latter the soul: there is an instance of the former in *James* v. 14, and of the latter in the parable of the ten virgins, *Matt.* xxv. The exterior anointing of the body is expressive of the interior unction or invisible grace produced in the soul. Under the Old Law were the priests, prophets and kings anointed: 1 *Kings* ix. 16; 2 *Kings* ii. 4; and 3 *Kings* xix. 15. Our Blessed Redeemer is called the Anointed, from the Greek verb *Krio* which signifies to *anoint*, because God anointed him with the Holy Ghost: *Acts* x. 38. And we are called Christians, because we profess the law and doctrine of God, the Anointed; and because we are anointed with holy oil and chrism. The child is anointed at baptism, the priest in receiving Holy Orders, the king and queen at their coronation. That the Apostles anointed the sick is clear from *Mark* vi. 13, and that they taught the practice is clear from *James* v. 14. Would they teach or practise the rite if they had not commission from their Divine Master so to do? It is indeed extremely astonishing that the Protestants who pretend to be enamoured with the Bible would discard a rite so sanctioned in both Testaments and the usage of all antiquity. See *Canons, Lib. 1. tit. 15.*

A. The time is uncertain: some think it was instituted at his last supper; others that it was done his resurrection and ascension.

Q. By whom was this sacrament promulgated?

A. By *James*, v. 13, 14, 15. "Is any man sick among you, let him bring in the priests of the church: they shall pray over him, anointing him with oil, in the name of our Lord, and the prayer of faith shall save him: and our Lord will lift him up, and if he has committed any sins, they shall be forgiven him."

Q. Who is capable of this sacrament?

A. Every true and faithful Christian who is in mortal danger of death by sickness, excepting infidels and such as are always mad.

Q. What is the matter of it?

A. Oil blessed by a bishop.

Q. What is the form of it?

A. "By his own anointing, and his own mercy, our Lord pardon thee, whatsoever thou hast sinned by thy seeing," &c. And so of the others, repeating the same words.

Q. What are the effects of extreme unction?

A. It comforts the soul in her last agony and despair, it remits venial sins and removes the relief, and restores corporal health, if it be expedient.

Q. How prove you that?

A. Out of *Mark* vi. 13, where we read, "The apostles anointed with oil many sick, and healed them." Which anointing is understood by many to have been the previous sign of extreme unction, and consecrated its effects.

Q. Why then do so few recover after it?

A. Either because the recovery of the body is not expedient for the soul, or because the sick delay the sacrament too long, as too many do, or for other reasons in the receiver of it.

Holy Order Expounded.

Q. WHAT is the sixth Sacrament?

A. Holy order.

Q. To whom doth this appertain?

For the rulers and ministers of the church, as
priests, deacons, and sub-deacons.

What proof have you for bishops, priests, and
deacons?

For bishops and deacons, out of *Phil. i. 1.* "To
saints at *Philippi*, (saith *St. Paul*) with the
deacons," and for priests out of *St. James*
cited. "Is any man sick among you, let him
call for the priests of the church," &c.

Where did Christ ordain this Sacrament?

At his last supper, where he made his Apostles
partakers, saying, "This is my body which is given for you;
his in commemoration of me." *Luke xxii. 19.*

What did Christ give them power to do?

To offer the unbloody sacrifice of his own body
and blood, which he himself had there ordained, and
under the outward forms of bread and wine.

Why did he say, Do ye this in commemoration
of him?

Because the unbloody sacrifice of the *Mass* is a
commemoration or memorial of the bloody sacrifice
on the Cross; nay more, it is a renewal of it in
bloody manner.

What are the effects of holy order?

It gives spiritual power, to ordain priests, to con-
secrate the body and blood of Christ, to administer the
sacraments, serve the altar, and to preach.

What else?

It gives also a spiritual grace, for the well-doing
of these offices.

How prove you that?

Out of *1 Tim. iv. 14.* "Neglect not the grace
that is thine by prophecy, with the imposition of the
hands of the presbytery."

What is the proper office of a bishop?

To give holy orders and confirmation, to preach
and govern the church.

How prove you that?

To confirm, out of *Acts viii.* above cited, where
it is said, "Two bishops were sent to confirm the Samaritans."

Q. How prove you that the bishops are of divine right, and have authority from God to rule the church?

A. Out of *Acts* xx. 28. "Take heed unto yourselves and to the whole flock, wherein the Holy Ghost hath made you bishops to rule the church of God."

Q. How prove you that the bishops only can ordain priests?

A. Out of *Titus* i. 5. "For this cause left I thee in *Crete*, that thou shouldest order the things that were wanting, and ordain priests in every city," (he was a bishop.)

Q. What sin is it therefore to oppose *Hierarchy* and *Episcopacy* either in the whole church, or in particular churches?

A. It is a sin of rebellion and high treason against the peace and safety of Christ's spiritual commonwealth, the church.

Q. How prove you that?

A. Because no law can subsist without guards and officers for it: Since therefore Christ hath ordained bishops to be the guards and teachers of his law, they who strike at bishops, strike also at the whole law of Christ, and safety of the people.

Q. Why is it requisite that bishops and pastors should have revenues?

A. Because as they bear a considerable charge and office in the commonwealth, therefore, they ought to have a competence for the performance of it. Secondly, to enable them, as good soldiers of Christ Jesus, to keep clear of worldly cares: for "no man, being a soldier to God, entangleth himself with worldly business; that he may please him to whom he hath engaged himself." 2 *Tim.* ii. 4.

Q. What is the office of a priest?

A. To offer sacrifice, and administer the rest of the sacraments, excepting holy order and confirmation.

Q. How prove you a sacrifice in the new law?

A. First, because there is a priesthood, as you have heard, and an altar according to that, "We have an altar (saith *St. Paul*) whereof they have not power to eat, who serve in the tabernacle." *Heb.* xiii. 10.

Secondly, out of *Mal.* i. 11, where he foretold that

in the new law, saying, "From the rising of the sun to the going down, great is my name among the Gentiles, and in every place there is sacrificed to my name a clean oblation, Lord of Hosts."

And out of *Luke* xxii. 19, 20, where Christ who liveth for ever (according to the order of *Melchisedech*) offered the sacrifice of his own body and blood in the form of bread and wine, saying, "This is my body which is given for you, (it is given for us, you find it at supper) this is the chalice of the new Testament in my blood, which chalice (according to the great commandment) is given for you."

Is it lawful for priests to marry?

It is not; there being a precept of the church, that, descending to us by tradition from the apostles, neither did any of the Apostles ever marry, nor have their wives, after their calling to the apostleship; and of perpetual chastity being annexed to the office, in the *Latin* or *Western* church.

Why is it requisite that priests should live chaste and unmarried?

Because, as by their ordination they are bound to instruct the faithful, their minds should be disengaged from the cares and pleasures of the world, and wholly employed in the study and piety of things, which is incompatible with the marriage. *1 Cor.* vii. 32.

What are the lesser orders of the church?

Subdeacon, deacon, lector, exorcist, and porter, according to a council of *Carthage*, *Can.* 6.

Is it lawful for women to preach, or to be priests?

It is not, according to *1 Cor.* xiv. 34. "Let women be silent in the churches: for it is not permitted to them to speak, but to be subject, as also the law saith." It is not lawful for a man to usurp and take upon himself the sacerdotal power, without the ordination of the church.

Is it not, according to *Heb.* v. 1, 4. "For every high priest first taken from among men, is appointed for sacrifice, that he may offer gifts and sacrifices for sinners?"

Q. How prove you that to be a mortal sin ?

A. Out of *Cor. vi. 10.* "Drunkards shall not possess the kingdom of God." And *Luke xxi. 34.* "Take heed to yourselves, lest your hearts be overcharged with surfeiting and drunkenness."

Q. What are the daughters of gluttony ?

A. Babbling, scurrility, spewing, sickness, and dullness of soul and body.

Q. What are the remedies of it ?

A. To consider the abstinence of Christ and his Saints, and that "gluttons are enemies to the cross of Christ, whose end is destruction." *Phil. iii. 19.*

Anger Expounded.

Q. WHAT is anger ?

A. An inordinate desire of revenge.

Q. How prove you anger to be mortal ?

A. Out of *Matt. ver. 22.* "Whosoever shall be angry with his brother, shall be guilty of judgment, &c. And whosoever shall say, thou fool, shall be guilty of hell fire."

Q. What are the daughters of anger ?

A. Hatred, passion, fury, clamour, threats, contumely, cursing, blasphemy, and murder.

Q. What are the remedies of anger ?

A. To remember the holy lesson of Christ, *Luke xxi. 19.* "In your patience you shall possess your souls." And that of *St. Paul.* "Be gentle one to another, pardoning one another, as also God in Christ hath pardoned you." *Ephes. iv. 32.*

Q. What is the virtue opposite to anger ?

A. Patience, which suppresseth in us all passion, and desire of revenge.

Q. How prove you the necessity and force of patience ?

A. Out of *Heb. x. 36.* "Patience is necessary for you, that doing the will of God, you may partake of the promise."

Sloth Expounded.

Q. WHAT is sloth ?

A. Laziness of mind, neglecting to begin, or prosecute good things.

ter into wine." *John* ii. Others, more probably, say it was done, when Christ declared the indissolubility of marriage, saying, "therefore now they are not two, but one flesh: that therefore which God hath joined together, let no man separate." *Matt.* xix. 6.

Q. Why was it requisite that marriage should be made a sacrament?

A. Because it is a contract whereon depends the chief happiness of a married life; as being ordained for the restraint of sinful concupiscence, the good of posterity, the well-ordering our domestic affairs, and the education of our children in the fear and service of God, and therefore ought to be ranked in the highest order of those actions, which Christ hath sanctioned for the use of man.

Q. How prove you marriage to be a sacrament?

A. Because, as you heard, it is a conjunction made and sanctioned by God himself, and not to be dissolved by any power of man.

Q. What other proof have you?

A. Out of *Ephes.* v. 31, 32. "They shall be two in one flesh; this is a great sacrament. But I speak in Christ, and in the church."

Q. What is the matter of this sacrament?

A. The mutual consent of the parties, and giving themselves to one another.

Q. What are the effects of matrimony?

A. It gives special grace to the married couple, to love and bear one with another, as also to bring up their children in the fear and love of God.

Q. What is the principal end of marriage?

A. To beget children, and bring them up in the service of God; and the next to this is, that man may have a remedy against concupiscence, and a helper in the way of salvation.

Q. How great is the tie of marriage?

A. So great that it can never be dissolved but by death, as you have heard out of *Matt.* xix.

Q. What are the obligations of man and wife?

A. To love, honour, and comfort one another,

Q. What besides?

A. Husbands are obliged to cherish and comfort their wives ; wives to be subject, obey, and love their husbands.

Q. How prove you that ?

A. Out of *Col.* iii. 18, 19. " Women, be subject to your own husbands, as behooveth in our Lord. Men, love your wives, and be not bitter towards them." And out of *Ephes.* iv. 22, 23. " Let women be subject to their husbands, as to the Lord, because the man is head of the woman as Christ is head of the church," v. 24. " But as the Church is subject to Christ, so also women to their husbands in all things." And again, v. 33. " Let each man love his wife as himself, and let the wife reverence her husband."

Q. What else ?

A. To render mutually the marriage debt, and according to that, " Let the husband render his debt unto his wife, and the wife also in like manner to her husband. The woman now hath no power of her own body, but the husband, and in like manner the man hath no power of his own body, but the woman." 1 *Cor.* vii. 3, 4.

Q. Is it lawful for children to marry without the consent of their parents ?

A. It is not ; neither is it lawful for parents to force them to marry against their will.

Q. Why are so many unhappy in their marriages ?

A. Because they never consulted with God about them, nor sought to have his blessing in them.

Q. For what other reason ?

A. Because they were in the state of sin at their marriage, or married for inordinate love or wealth, and not for the right end of marriage.

Q. What meaneth the blessing of the priest given in marriage ?

A. It is to beg all blessings of God for the new married couple.

Q. Why is the ring put on the fourth finger ?

A. Because that is called the heart finger and hath (they say) a vein in it, which reacheth to the heart ; so to signify the true and constant love which ought to be *between man and wife.*

Q. What signifies the ring itself?

A. It is a symbol of perfection and eternity, being equal in all parts, and round in figure, without beginning or end, to imitate the perfect and perpetual love of man and wife.

Q. What are the spiritual means to obtain the blessing of good children?

A. Fasting, prayer, and alms-deeds, for so St. *Joa-
chim* and St. *Anne* obtained Blessed *Virgin Mary*; and so the Blessed Virgin became the mother of God.

Q. What obligations have parents to their children?

A. To instruct them in the faith of Christ, to bring them up in the fear of God, to give them good example, to keep them out of ill company and other occasions of sin, to feed and nourish them, to provide for them in marriage, and to correct their faults.

Q. What are the chief and most common impediments of marriage?

A. Consanguinity and affinity, to the fourth degree inclusively; and in the right line all degrees are prohibited by the law of nature, indispensable.

Q. Can the church dispense in these collateral degrees?

A. She can, excepting only the first collateral degrees of consanguinity, but always sufficient motives must be given.

Q. How prove you that?

A. The Church having made these laws, for just reasons may dispense in them; but when such dispensations are given, those who seek them ought to consider, that they may deprive themselves of the blessings attending the marriage state, if the motives alleged be not well founded.

CHAP. XII.

The Cardinal Virtues Expounded.

Q. How many cardinal virtues are there?

A. There are four: prudence, justice, fortitude, and temperance.

Q. Why are they called cardinal virtues?

A. Because they are the fountains, and as it were the

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hinges of all good works, from the word *Cardo*, which signifies a hinge.

Q. What is prudence ?

A. It is a virtue which makes us wary in all our actions, that we may neither deceive others, nor be deceived ourselves ; or which (according to the rule of honesty) prescribes us what to be desired, and what to be avoided.

Q. How prove you that ?

A. Out of *Eccles.* iii. 32. "A wise heart that hath understanding, will keep itself from all sin, and in the works of justice shall have success."

Q. What is justice ?

A. It is a virtue which gives every man his own according to that, "Render to all men their due, to whom tribute, tribute ; to whom custom, custom ; to whom fear, fear ; to whom honour, honour." *Rom.* xiii. 7.

Q. What is temperance ?

A. It is a virtue which moderates our appetites and desires, that they be according to reason, and not inordinate : "He that is abstinent, (saith the wise man) shall increase in life." *Eccl.* xxxvii.

Q. What is fortitude ?

A. It is a virtue, by which the labours and dangers even of death itself, that are opposite unto virtue, are courageously undertaken and patiently sustained, "The wicked fleeth (saith *Solomon*) when no man pursueth ; but the just man, as a confident lion, shall be without fear." *Prov.* xxviii. 1. And in *1 Pet.* iii. 14, we read, "The fear of them fear ye not, and be not troubled, but sanctify our Lord Christ in your hearts."

Q. Is it necessary for a Christian to be exercised in these virtues ?

A. It is ; for "we must not only decline from evil, but do good," *Psalms* xxxvi. 27.

CHAP. XIII.

The Gifts of the Holy Ghost Expounded.

Q. How many are the Gifts of the Holy Ghost ?

A. Seven : wisdom, understanding, counsel, forti-

ude, knowledge, piety, and the fear of the Lord. *Isa.* xi. 2.

Q. What is wisdom ?

A. It is a gift of God, which teacheth us to direct our whole lives and actions to his honour, and the salvation of our souls.

Q. What is understanding ?

A. It is a gift of God, by which we are enabled to comprehend the high mysteries of our Faith.

Q. What is counsel ?

A. It is a gift of God, by which we discover the frauds and deceits of the Devil, and are not deceived by him.

Q. What is fortitude ?

A. It is a gift of God, whereby we are enabled to undergo and despise all dangers for his sake.

Q. What is knowledge ?

A. It is a gift of God, by which we know and understand the will of God.

Q. What is piety ?

A. It is a gift of God, which makes us devout and zealous in his service.

Q. What is the fear of the Lord ?

A. It is the gift of God, which curbs our rashness, withholds us from sin, and makes us obedient to God's law.

CHAP. XIV.

The Twelve Fruits of the Holy Ghost Expounded.

Q. How many are the fruits of the Holy Ghost ?

A. There are twelve, as you may see, *Gal.* v. 22, 23.

Q. What is the first ?

A. Charity, whose nature and effects you know already.

Q. What is the second ?

A. Joy, by which we are enabled to serve God with cheerful hearts.

Q. What is the third ?

A. Peace, which keeps us unmoved in our minds amidst the storms and tempests of the world.

Q. What is the fourth ?

A. Patience, which enables us to suffer all adversities for the love of God.

Q. What is the fifth?

A. Longanimity, which is an untired confidence of mind, in expecting the good things of the life to come.

Q. What is the sixth?

A. Goodness, which makes us hurt no man, and do good to all.

Q. What is the seventh?

A. Benignity, which causeth an affable sweetness in our manners and conversation.

Q. What is the eighth?

A. Mildness, which allays in us all the motions of passion and anger.

Q. What is the ninth?

A. Fidelity, which makes us punctual observers of our covenants and promises.

Q. What is the tenth?

A. Modesty, which observes a becoming deportment in all our outward actions.

Q. What is the eleventh?

A. Continency, which makes us not only abstemious in meat and drink, but in all other sensible delights.

Q. What is the twelfth?

A. Chastity, which keeps a pure soul in a pure body.

Q. Who are they that have these fruits?

A. The children of God only; for "whosoever are led by the Spirit of God, they are the sons of God." *Rom. viii. 14.*

CHAP. XV.

The Works of Mercy (corporal and spiritual) Expounded.

Q. How many are the corporal works of mercy?

A. Seven. 1. To feed the hungry. 2. To give drink to the thirsty. 3. To clothe the naked. 4. To harbour the harbourless. 5. To visit the sick. 6. To visit the imprisoned. 7. To bury the dead.

Q. How prove you that these works are meritorious of a reward?

A. Because Christ hath promised the kingdom of heaven as the reward of them. "Come, O ye blessed of my Father (saith he) and possess ye the kingdom, for I was hungry, and ye gave me to eat," &c. *Matt.* xv. 35, 36.

Q. When are we said to feed and clothe Christ?

A. As often as we feed and clothe the poor, "What we have done (saith he) to one of my little ones, that we have done unto me." ver. 40.

Q. Is the reward of these works a reward of justice?

A. It is; according to *2 Tim.* iv. 7, 8. "I have fought a good fight (saith *Paul*) there is a crown of justice laid up for me, which our Lord will render to me at that day as a just judge."

Q. What other proof have you?

A. Out of *Heb.* vi. 10. "For God is not unjust, that he should forget the work and love, which you have shown in his name, who have ministered unto the saints, and do minister."

Q. How many are the works of mercy, spiritual?

A. Seven also. 1. To give counsel to the doubtful. 2. To instruct the ignorant. 3. To admonish sinners. 4. To comfort the afflicted. 5. To forgive offences. 6. To bear patiently the troublesome. 7. To pray for the quick and the dead.

Q. How prove you your prayer for the dead?

A. First, out of the places before and after cited for arguatory. Secondly, out of *1 John* v. 16. "He that noweth his brother to sin a sin not unto death, let him ask, and life shall be given him, not sinning to death; (i. e.) to final impenitence. Therefore it is lawful to pray for all such as die penitent, confessing their sins." And in *2 Mac.* xii. we read, "It is a wholesome and only thought to pray for the dead, that they may be released from their sins."

Q. How show you these works to be meritorious?

A. Out of *Dan.* xii. 3. "They who instruct others in justice, shall shine as stars to all eternity."

CHAP. XVI.

The Eight Beatitudes.

Q. WHAT are the eight Beatitudes?

A. Christ "opening his mouth he taught them, saying: 1. Blessed are the poor in spirit: for theirs is the kingdom of heaven. 2. Blessed are the meek: for they shall possess the land. 3. Blessed are they that mourn: for they shall be comforted. 4. Blessed are they that hunger and thirst after justice: for they shall be filled. 5. Blessed are the merciful: for they shall obtain mercy. 6. Blessed are the clean of heart: for they shall see God. 7. Blessed are the peace-makers: for they shall be called the children of God. 8. Blessed are they that suffer persecution for justice sake: for theirs is the kingdom of heaven." *Matt. v. 3, 10.*

Q. Whence ariseth the necessity of suffering persecution?

A. Because all that will live piously in Jesus Christ shall suffer persecution. *2 Tim. iii. 12.*

CHAP. XVII.

The Kinds of Sin Expounded.

Q. WHY is it necessary for a Christian to know the nature and kinds of sins?

A. That so he may detest and avoid them.

Q. How many kinds of sins are there?

A. Two, namely, *Original* and *Actual*.

Q. What is original sin.

A. It is a privation of original justice, which we inherit from our first parent *Adam*, being all by course of nature, conceived and born in that privation or original sin.

Q. How prove you that?

A. Out of *Rom. v. 12.* "Therefore as by one man sin entered into the world, and by sin death, and so unto all men death did pass, in whom all have sinned."

Q. What are the effects of original sin?

A. Concupiscence, ignorance, evil inclination, proneness to sin, sickness, and death.

Q. How is original sin taken away?

A. By holy baptism.

Q. Whither go infants that die without baptism?

A. To a part of hell, where they endure the pain of loss, but not of sense, and shall never see the face of God.

Q. How prove you that?

A. Out of *John* iii. 5. "Unless a man be born again of water, and the Holy Ghost, he cannot enter into the kingdom of God."

Q. What is actual sin?

A. It is a thought, word or deed, contrary to the law of God.

Q. What is the sin of omission?

A. To omit any thing willingly, which is commanded by God or his Church.

Q. Why is actual sin so called?

A. Because the material part of it is commonly some voluntary acts of ours.

Q. Is all sin voluntary and deliberate?

A. It is, because (speaking of actual sin) no man sinneth in doing that which it is not in his power to avoid.

Q. What other proof have you?

A. Because the whole gospel of Christ is nothing else but an exhortation to do good, and avoid evil, than which nothing were more vain, if it be not in the free election and power of man, assisted by God's grace, to do, or not to do such things.

Q. What scripture have you for that?

A. First out of *Gen.* iv. 7. "If thou dost well, shalt thou not receive? But if ill, shall not thy sin be forthwith present at the door? But the lust thereof shall be under thee, and thou shalt have dominion over it."

Secondly out of *Deut.* xxx. 19, 20. "I call heaven and earth to witness this day, that I have proposed to thee life and death, blessing and cursing, choose therefore life that thou mayest live."

Thirdly, out of *1 Cor.* vii. 37. "He that hath determined in his heart being settled, not having necessity,

A. It is the voice of men rejoicing, and aspiring to the joys of heaven.

Q. Why is the *Alleluiah* repeated so often at the feast of *Easter*?

A. Because it is the joyful solemnity of our Saviour's resurrection.

Q. Why between *Septuagesima* and *Easter*, is the *Tract* read in the place of the *Gradual*?

A. Because it is a time of penance and mourning: and therefore the *Tract* is read with a mournful and slow voice, to signify the miseries and punishments of this life.

Q. What is the *Tract*?

A. Two or three versicles between the Epistle and the Gospel, sung with a slow, long protracted tone.

Q. Why do we rise up at the reading of the *Gospel*?

A. To signify our readiness to go, and do, whither, and whatsoever it commands us.

Q. What means the *Gospel*?

A. It signifies the preaching of Christ; and is the happy embassy or message of Christ unto the world.

Q. Why is the *Gospel* read at the North end, or left side of the Altar?

A. To signify that by the preaching of the Gospel of Christ, the kingdom of the Devil was overthrown.

Q. How prove you that?

A. Because the Devil hath chosen the North (figuratively infidels, and the wicked) for the seat of his malice. "From the North shall all evil be opened upon all the inhabitants of the land." *Jer.* i. 14. and *Zach.* ii. 7.

Q. Why doth the priest before he begins the Gospel, salute the people with *Dominus vobiscum*?

A. To prepare them for a devout hearing of it, and to beg of our Lord to make them worthy hearers of his word, which can save their souls.

Q. Why then doth he say, *Sequentia sancti Evangelii*, &c. The sequel of the Holy Gospel, &c.?

A. To move attention, and to signify what part of the Gospel he then reads.

Q. Why doth the clerk answer, *Gloria tibi Domine* Glory be to thee, O Lord?

der an account for it at the day of judgment." Now God forbid every idle word should be a mortal sin.

Q. What are the effects of venial sin?

A. It doth not rob the soul of life, as mortal sin doth, but only weakeneth the fervour of charity, and by degrees disposeth unto mortal.

Q. Why are we bound to shun not only mortal, but venial sins?

A. Because "he that contemneth small things, shall fall by little and little." *Eccles. xix. 1.*

Q. What other proof have you?

A. Because "no polluted thing shall enter into the heavenly Jerusalem." *Apoc. xxi. 27*, be it polluted with mortal, or venial sin.

Q. How shall we be able to know when any sin is mortal, and when but venial?

A. Because to any mortal sin it is required, both that it be deliberate, and perfectly voluntary; and that it be a matter of weight against the law of God; one or both of which conditions are always wanting in a venial sin.

Q. How is mortal sin remitted?

A. By hearty penance and contrition.

Q. How is venial sin remitted?

A. By all the sacraments, by holy water, devout prayer, alms-deeds, and the like good works.

Q. Whither go such as die in mortal sin?

A. To hell for all eternity, as you have heard in the Creed.

Q. Whither go such as die in venial sin, or not having fully satisfied for the temporal punishments due to their mortal sins which are forgiven them?

A. To purgatory till they have made full satisfaction for them, and then to heaven.

Q. How prove you there is a purgatory, or a place of punishment, where souls are purged after death?

A. Out of 1 *Pet. iii. 10.* "Christ being dead for our sins, came in spirit, and preached to them also that were in prison, who had been incredulous in the days of Noah, when the Ark was building."

Q. What other proof have you?

A. Out of 1 *Cor. iii. 12.* "The work of every man

shall be manifest, for the day of our Lord will declare it, because it shall be revealed in fire; and the work of every one of what kind it is, the fire shall try; If a man's work abides," (as theirs doth who deserve no purgatory) "he shall receive a reward; if any man's work burn, (as theirs doth who go to purgatory) he shall suffer loss, but himself shall be saved, yet so as by fire."

Q. What besides?

A. Out of *Matt.* v. 25. "Be thou at agreement with thy adversary betimes whilst thou art in the way with him (that is in this life) lest perhaps the adversary deliver thee to the judge, and the judge deliver thee to the officer, and thou be cast into prison (*Purgatory*): Amen, I say unto thee, thou shalt not go out from thence, till thou pay the last farthing."

Q. What other yet?

A. Out of *Matt.* xii. 32. "Some sins shall neither be forgiven in this world, nor in the world to come." Therefore there is a place of purging and pardoning sins after this life.

Q. How is a man made guilty, or said to co-operate to other men's sins?

A. As often as he is an actual cause of sin in others by any of these nine means: 1. By counsel. 2. By command. 3. By consent. 4. By provocation. 5. By praise or flattery. 6. By silence. 7. By connivance. 8. By participation; or 9. By defence of the ill done.

CHAP. XVIII.

The Seven Deadly Sins Expounded.

Q. How call you the seven deadly, or capital sins?

A. Pride, covetousness, lechery, anger, gluttony, envy, and sloth.

Q. What is pride?

A. It is an inordinate desire of our own excellency or esteem.

Q. Why is pride called a capital sin?

A. Because it is the head or fountain of many other sins.

Q. What for example?

A. Vain-glory, boasting, hypocrisy, ambition, arrogance, presumption, and contempt of others.

Q. What is vain-glory ?

A. An inordinate desire of human praise.

Q. What is boasting ?

A. A foolish bragging of ourselves.

Q. What is hypocrisy ?

A. Counterfeiting of more piety and virtue than we have.

Q. What is ambition ?

A. An inordinate desire of honour.

Q. What is arrogance ?

A. A high contempt of others, joined with insolence and rashness.

Q. What is presumption ?

A. An attempting of things above our strength.

Q. What is contempt of others ?

A. A disdainful preferring ourselves before others.

Q. What other daughters hath pride ?

A. Pertinency, discord, disobedience, and ingratitude.

Q. What is pertinency ?

A. A wilful sticking to our own opinions, contrary to the judgment of our betters.

Q. What is discord ?

A. A wrangling in words, with such as we ought to assent and yield unto.

Q. What is disobedience ?

A. An opposition to the will or commands of parents and superiors.

Q. What is ingratitude ?

A. A forgetting or neglecting of benefits.

Q. How prove you pride to be a mortal sin ?

A. Because we read, that "God resists the proud, and gives his grace to the humble." 1 Pet. v. 5. And "pride is odious before God and men." Eccl. x. 7.

Q. What are the remedies of pride ?

A. To remember that holy lesson of Christ, "learn of me, because I am meek and humble of heart." Matt. xi. 29. And to consider that we are sinful dust, and shall return again to dust; and that whatsoever good we have or do, is the free gift of God.

Q. What is the virtue opposite to pride?

A. Humility, which teaches us a lowly opinion of ourselves. "He that humbleth himself shall be exalted." *Matt. xxiii. 12.*

Covetousness Expounded.

Q. WHAT is covetousness?

A. An inordinate desire of riches.

Q. When is covetousness a mortal sin?

A. When either we desire to get unjustly that which is another man's of considerable value, or else refuse to give of that which is our own, to such as are in any extreme or great necessity.

Q. How prove you the first part?

A. Out of 1 *Tim. vi. 9.* "They, who would become rich, fall into temptation, and into the snare of the devil and into many unprofitable and hurtful desires, which drown men in destruction and perdition: for covetousness is the root of all evils."

Q. How prove you the latter part?

A. Out of 1 *John iii. 17.* "He that hath the substance of this world, and shall see his brother in necessity, and shall shut up his bowels from him; how doth the charity of God abide in him?"

Q. What other proof have you for alms?

A. Out of *Luke xi. 41.* "But yet that which remain give alms, and behold all things are clean unto you And out of *Dan. iv. 24.* "Redeem thy sins with alms and thy iniquity with the mercies of the poor."

Q. What are the daughters of covetousness?

A. Hardness of heart, unmercifulness to the poor, inquiet solicitude, neglect of heavenly things, and confidence in things of this world.

Q. What else?

A. Usury, fraud, rapine, theft, &c.

Q. What are the remedies of covetousness?

A. To consider "that it is a kind of idolatry," according to *Col. iii. 5.* And that "it is harder for rich man to enter into heaven, than for a camel to go through the eye of a needle." *Matt. xix. 24.*

Q. What are the virtues opposite to covetousness?

A. Liberality, which makes a man give freely to the poor; and justice, which renders to all men that which is theirs. "It is a more blessed thing to give (saith our Lord) than to take." *Acts* xxvi. 35. And *2 Cor.* ix. 6, *St. Paul* saith, "He that soweth sparingly, sparingly also shall he reap; but he that soweth in blessings, of blessings also shall he reap; for God loves the cheerful giver."

Lechery Expounded.

Q. WHAT is lechery, or lust?

A. An inordinate desire of carnal sin, or delights of the flesh.

Q. How prove you the malice of this sin?

A. Because the whole world was once drowned, and the cities of *Sodom* and *Gomorrah* were burnt with fire from heaven for it. *Gen.* vii. 21, and xix. 24.

Q. What other proof have you?

A. Out of *Rom.* viii. 13. "For if you live according to the flesh, you shall die; but if by the spirit you mortify the deeds of the flesh, you shall live."

Q. What are the degrees of lust?

A. Thought, delight, consent, and act.

Q. What are the daughters of lust?

A. Fornication, whoredom, adultery, voluntary pollution, unchaste signs and touches, wanton kisses and speeches.

Q. How prove you voluntary pollution to be a mortal sin?

A. Out of *Gen.* xxxviii. 9, where we read, that *Onan* was struck dead by God in the place, for shedding the seed of nature out of the due use of marriage to hinder generation, which fact the holy text calls a *detestable thing*. He also who was eldest brother to this *Onan*, was slain by God, as we read in the same chapter, ver. 7. And it is generally thought by expositors, that his sudden death was in punishment for the like sin of pollution.

Q. Why are lustful kisses and touches mortal sins?

A. Because they vehemently dispose to fornication and pollution.

with me in Paradise. 3. Behold thy mother; woman behold thy son. 4. My God, my God, why hast thou forsaken me. 5. I thirst. 6. Into thy hands I commend my spirit. 7. It is consummated."

Q. What means the priest laying down the Host upon the corporal, and then covering the chalice again?

A. It signifies the taking of our Saviour down from the Cross, and his burial.

Q. Why, then is the priest silent for a time?

A. To signify our Saviour's rest in the sepulchre on the Sabbath.

Q. Why is the Host divided into three parts?

A. To signify the division of our Saviour's soul and body made on the Cross, and that the body was broken, and divided in three principal parts, namely, his hands, side, and feet.

Q. Why after this doth he sign the chalice three times with a particle of the Host, and raise his voice, saying, *Pax Domini, &c.*, The peace of our Lord be always with you?

A. To signify that the frequent voice of Christ to his disciples, *Pax vobis*, Peace be to you; as also to signify the triple peace which he hath purchased for us, by his Cross, namely, external, internal, and eternal.

Q. Why then is the particle of the Host put into the chalice?

A. To signify the reuniting of our Saviour's body, blood and soul, made at his resurrection; as also to signify, that we cannot partake of the blood and merits of Christ, unless we partake of his cup of sufferings.

Q. Why is the *Agnus Dei*, or Lamb of God, which taketh away the sins of the world, said with a loud voice?

A. To commemorate the glory of our Saviour's ascension, and to signify that he was slain like an innocent lamb to take away our sins and give us peace.

Q. Why is the *Pax*, or kiss of peace, given before communion?

A. To signify, that peace and mutual charity, which ought to be among the faithful, who all eat of one bread of the Eucharist, and are all members of one mystical body.

Q. How prove you that to be a mortal sin ?

A. Out of *Cor.* vi. 10. "Drunkards shall not possess the kingdom of God." And *Luke* xxi. 34. "Take heed to yourselves, lest your hearts be overcharged with surfeiting and drunkenness."

Q. What are the daughters of gluttony ?

A. Babbling, scurrility, spewing, sickness, and dullness of soul and body.

Q. What are the remedies of it ?

A. To consider the abstinence of Christ and his Saints, and that "gluttons are enemies to the cross of Christ, whose end is destruction." *Phil.* iii. 19.

Anger Expounded.

Q. WHAT is anger ?

A. An inordinate desire of revenge.

Q. How prove you anger to be mortal ?

A. Out of *Matt.* ver. 22. "Whosoever shall be angry with his brother, shall be guilty of judgment, &c. And whosoever shall say, thou fool, shall be guilty of hell fire."

Q. What are the daughters of anger ?

A. Hatred, passion, fury, clamour, threats, contumely, cursing, blasphemy, and murder.

Q. What are the remedies of anger ?

A. To remember the holy lesson of Christ, *Luke* xxi. 19. "In your patience you shall possess your souls." And that of St. *Paul*. "Be gentle one to another, pardoning one another, as also God in Christ hath pardoned you." *Ephes.* iv. 32.

Q. What is the virtue opposite to anger ?

A. Patience, which suppresseth in us all passion, and desire of revenge.

Q. How prove you the necessity and force of patience ?

A. Out of *Heb.* x. 36. "Patience is necessary for you, that doing the will of God, you may partake of the promise."

Sloth Expounded.

Q. WHAT is sloth ?

A. Laziness of mind, neglecting to begin, or prosecute good things.

A. It signifies the Apostles preaching the gospel to all nations. *Luke* xxiv. 50.

Q. What is the missal?

A. It is the Mass book, wherein this holy service is contained.

CHAP. XXIII.

The Primer or Office of our Blessed Lady, Expounded.

Q. Who composed this office?

A. The church, directed by the Holy Ghost?

Q. Why is the Primer so called?

A. From the Latin word *Primo*, which signifies, first of all, so to teach us, that prayer should be the first work of the day, according to that, "Seek ye first the kingdom of heaven, and all these things shall be given you."

Q. Why is the office divided into Hymns, Psalms, Canticles, Antiphons, Versicles, Responsories, and Prayers?

A. For order, beauty, and variety sake.

Q. What warrant have you for that?

A. Out of *Col.* iii. 16. "Sing ye in your hearts unto the Lord in spiritual Psalms, Hymns, and Canticles."

Q. Why should the laity pray out of the Psalms, which they little understand?

A. 1. Because, by so doing, they pray out of the mouth of the Holy Ghost. 2. Because, if they do it with devout and humble hearts, it is as meritorious in them, as in the greatest scholars; for a petition hath the same force, whether it be delivered by a learned or unlearned man; so hath also prayer. 3. Because a psalm is of the same value in the sight of God, in the mouth of a child or woman, as from the mouth of the most learned doctor.

Q. Why is the office divided into seven several hours?

A. That so it might be a daily memorial of the seven principal parts, and seven hours of our Saviour's passion.

Q. What ground have you for that?

A. Out of *Zac.* xii. 10. "At that day I will pour

deserve pardon." *Gen.* iv. 13. And of *Judas*, "when casting down the silver pieces in the temple, he went and hanged himself." *Matt.* xxvii. 4, 5.

Q. What is presumption of God's mercy?

A. A foolish confidence of salvation, without leading a good life, or any care to keep the commandments; such as they entertain who think they will be saved by faith only, without good works.

Q. What is it to impugn the known truth?

A. To argue obstinately against known points of faith, or to prevent the way of our Lord by forging lies and slander, as Heretics do, when they teach the ignorant people, that Catholics worship images as God, and give Angels and Saints the honour which is due to God; or that the Pope for money gives us pardon to commit what sins we please; than all which, greater falsehoods cannot be invented.

Q. What is envy to another's spiritual good?

A. A sadness or repining at another's growth in virtue and perfection; such as sectaries seem to have when they scoff and are troubled at the frequent fasts, prayers, feasts, pilgrimages, alms-deeds, vows, and religious orders of the Catholic Church, calling them superstitions and fooleries, because they have not in their churches any such practices of piety.

Q. What is obstinacy in sin?

A. A wilful persisting in wickedness, and running on from sin to sin, after sufficient instructions and admonition.

Q. How show you the malice of this sin?

A. Out of *Heb.* x. 26, 27. "If we sin wilfully after having received the knowledge of the truth, there is now left no sacrifice for sins, but a certain dreadful expectation of judgment."

Q. What other proof have you?

A. Out of 2 *Pet.* ii. 21. "It was better for them not to know the way of justice, than after the knowledge to turn back from the holy commandment which was given them."

Q. What is final impenitence?

A. To die without either confession or contrition for

A. His drinking gall and vinegar, his dying on the Cross, and the opening his side with a spear.

Q. What by the even-song ?

A. His taking down from the Cross, and the darkness which was made upon the face of the earth.

Q. What by the *Complin* ?

A. His funeral and burial.

Briefly thus : The matins and lauds, his agony, and binding in the garden : the crime, his scoffs, and false accusations ; the third hour, his clothing with purple, and crowning with thorns ; the sixth hour, his condemning and nailing to the Cross ; the ninth hour, his yielding up the ghost, and the opening his side ; the even-song, his taking from the Cross ; and the complin, his burial.

The Particulars of the Office Expounded.

Q. WHY doth our Lady's office always begin with an *Ave Maria* ?

A. To dedicate the office of our Lady, and to beg her aid for the devout performance of it to God's honour.

Q. Why do we begin every hour with, *Incline unto my aid, O God: O Lord, make haste to help me* ?

A. To acknowledge our infirmity and misery, and our great need of divine assistance, not only in all other things, but also in our very prayers ; according to that of the Apostle, "No man can say Lord Jesus, but in the Holy Ghost."

Q. Why do we add to this, Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost ?

A. To signify that the intention of the office is, in the first place, to give one and equal glory to the most blessed Trinity, and to invite all creatures to do the like : this is the principal aim of the whole office ; therefore we not only begin every hour, but also end every *Psalm* with the same verse.

Q. Who ordained the *Gloria Patri* ?

A. The Apostles, according to *Baronius* in his 3d Tome.

Q. Why do we join unto the *Gloria Patri*, *Sicut erat, &c.* As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end ?

mites, and their sin. "We will destroy this place because the cry of them hath increased before our Lord, who hath sent us to destroy them," (and they were burnt with fire from heaven.)

Q. What is the third?

A. Oppressing of the poor, which is a cruel, tyrannical, and unjust dealing with inferiors.

Q. What other proof have you of that?

A. Out of *Exod.* xxii. 21. "Ye shall not hurt the widow and the fatherless: If you do hurt them, they will cry unto me, and I will hear their cry, and my fury shall take indignation, and I will strike thee with the sword." And out of *Isa.* x. 1, 2. "Wo to them that make unjust laws, that they might oppress the poor in judgment, and do violence to the cause of the humble of my people."

Q. What is the fourth?

A. To defraud working men of their wages, which is to lessen, or detain it from them.

Q. What proof have you of it?

A. Out of *Eccl.* xxxiv. 37. "He that sheddeth blood, and he that defraudeth the hired man, are brethren," and out of *James* v. 4. "Behold the hire of the workmen that have reaped your fields, which is defrauded of you, crieth, and their cry hath entered into the ears of the Lord God of Sabaoth."

CHAP. XXI.

The Four Last Things Expounded.

Q. WHAT are the four last things?

A. Death, Judgment, Hell, and Heaven.

Q. What understand you by death?

A. That we are mortal, and shall once die; how soon, we are uncertain, and therefore we must be always prepared for it.

Q. How prove you that?

A. Out of *Heb.* ix. 27. "It is decreed for all men once to die." And *Matt.* xxv. 13. "Watch ye therefore, because ye know not the day nor the hour."

Q. What is the best preparation for death?

A. A godly life, and to be often doing penance for our sins, and saying with *St. Paul*, "I desire to be dissolved and to be with Christ." *Phil. i. 23.*

Q. What else?

A. To remember often that of *Matt. xvi. 25.* "He that will save his life shall lose it, and he that shall lose his life for me shall find it."

Q. What understand you by judgment?

A. I understand, that (besides the general judgment at the last day) our souls as soon as we are dead, shall receive their particular judgment at the tribunal of Christ, according to that, "Blessed are the dead that die in the Lord, from henceforth now, saith the spirit, they rest from their labours, for their works follow them." *Apoc. xiv. 13.*

Q. What is the best preparation for this judgment?

A. To remember often that of *Heb. x. 31.* "It is a terrible thing to fall into the hands of the living God." And that of *1 Cor. xi. 21.* "For if we did judge ourselves, we should not be judged."

Q. What understand you by hell?

A. That such as die in mortal sin, "shall be tormented there both day and night, and for ever and ever." *Apoc. xx. 21.* "There shall be weeping, howling, and gnashing of teeth; the worm of conscience shall always gnaw them, and the fire that torments them, shall never be extinguished." *Mark viii. 44, 45.*

Q. What understand you by heaven?

A. That the elect and faithful servants of God, shall for ever reign with him in his kingdom, "where he hath such delights and comforts for them, as neither eye hath seen or ear hath heard, neither hath it entered into the heart of man." *1 Cor. ii. 9.*

Q. How prove you that?

A. Out of *Matt. vii. 21.* "He that doth the will of my Father who is in heaven, shall enter into the kingdom of heaven."

Q. What profit is there in the frequent memory of all those things?

A. Very great according to that, "In all thy works."

remember the last things, and thou shalt never sin." *Eccles.* vii. 40, which God of his great mercy give us grace to do. *Amen.*

CHAP. XXII.

The Substance or Essence, and Ceremonies of the Mass, Expounded.

Q. WHAT is the mass ?

A. It is the unbloody sacrifice of Christ's body and blood, under the forms of bread and wine. The word *Mass*, used in *English*, being derived from *Missa*, *Latin* ; and the word *Missa*, though it may have other derivations, may be well taken from the *Hebrew* word *Missach*, which signifies a free voluntary offering.

Q. Who instituted the substance or essence of the Mass ?

A. Our Saviour Christ at his last supper, when he consecrated, *i. e.* converted the substance of bread and wine into his own true body and blood, and gave the same to his disciples, under the outward forms of bread and wine, commanding them to do what he had done in commemoration of him. *Luke* xxii. 19.

Q. Who ordained the ceremonies of the mass ?

A. The church, directed by the Holy Ghost.

Q. For what end did the church ordain them ?

A. To stir up devotion in the people, and reverence to the sacred mysteries.

Q. For what other end ?

A. To instruct the ignorant in spiritual and high things by sensible and material signs ; and by the glory of the church militant to make them comprehend something of the glory of the triumphant church.

Q. What warrant hath the church to ordain ceremonies ?

A. The authority of God himself in the old law, commanding many and most stately ceremonies in things belonging to his service. See the whole book of *Leviticus*.

Q. What besides ?

A. The example of Christ in the new law using du

and spittle to cure the blind, the deaf, and dumb. He prostrated himself at prayer in the garden three times. He lifted up his eyes to heaven and groaned, when he was raising *Lazarus* from the dead, which were all ceremonies.

Q. Did he use any ceremonies at his last supper, where he ordained the sacrifice of the mass?

A. He did; for he washed the feet of his disciples, he blessed the bread and the cup, and exhorted the communicants.

Q. What signify the several ornaments of the priest?

A. The *Amict*, or linen veil, which he first puts on, represents the veil with which the *Jews* covered the face of Christ, when they buffeted him in the house of *Caiaphas*, and bid him prophesy, "who it was that struck him."

2. The *Alb* signifies the white garment, which *Herod* put on him, to intimate that he was a fool.

3. The *Girdle* signifies the cord that bound him in the garden.

4. The *Maniple*, the cord which bound him to the pillar.

5. The *Stole*, the cord by which they led him to be crucified.

6. The priest's upper *Vestment*, represents both the seamless coat of Christ, as also the purple garment with which they clothed him in derision in the house of *Pilate*.

7. The *Altar-stone*, represents the cross on which he offered himself unto the Father.

8. The *Chalice*, the sepulchre or grave of Christ.

9. The *Paten*, the stone which was rolled to the door of the sepulchre.

10. The *Altar-cloths*, with the *corporal* and *pall*, the linen in which the dead body of Christ was shrouded and buried. Finally, the candles on the *Altar* puts us in mind of the light which Christ brought into the world by his passion, as also of his immortal and ever shining divinity.

Q. What meaneth the priest's coming back thr steps from the Altar, and humbling himself before begins?

rification, from the Latin word *Purifico*, to purify; not that our blessed Lady had contracted any thing by her child-birth, which needed purifying, (being the mother of purity itself) but because other mothers were by this ceremonial rite freed from the legal impurity of their child-births.

And is also called *Candlemas*, or a *Mass Candles*; because before the mass of that day, the church blesses her candles for the whole year, and makes a procession with hallowed candles in the hands of the faithful, in memory of the divine light, wherewith Christ illuminated the whole church at his presentation, where aged *Simeon* styled him, "A light to the Revelation of the Gentiles, and the glory of his people *Israel*." *Luke* ii. 32.

Q. What meaneth the resurrection of our Lord, or Easter-day?

A. It is a solemnity in memory and honour of our Saviour's resurrection, or rising from the dead on the third day, *Matt.* xxviii. 6. And it is called *Easter*, from *Oriens*, which signifies the *East* or *Rising*, which is one of the titles of Christ, "And his name (saith the prophet) shall be called *Oriens*." *Zach.* vi. 12, because as the material sun daily ariseth from the East, the sun of justice, at this day, arose from the dead.

Q. What meaneth ascension-day?

A. It is a feast in memory of Christ's ascension into heaven the fortieth day after his resurrection, in the sight of his Apostles and Disciples, *Acts* i. 9, 10, there to prepare a place for us, being preceded by whole legions of Angels, and waited on by millions of Saints, whom he had freed out of the prison of *Limbo*. *Mich.* ii. 13.

Q. What meaneth *Pentecost* or *Whitsuntide*?

A. It is a solemn feast in memory and honour of the coming of the Holy Ghost upon the heads of the Apostles, in tongues as it were of fire, *Acts* ii. 3. *Pentecost* in Greek signifieth the *Fiftieth*, it being the fiftieth day after the resurrection. It is also called *Whitsunday*, from the *Catechumens*, who were clothed in white, and admitted on the eve of this feast to the sacrament of baptism. It was anciently called *Wied Sunday*, (i. e.)

Holy Sunday, for *wied* or *withed* signifies Holy in the old Saxon language.

Q. What meaneth Trinity Sunday ?

A. It is the octave of Whitsunday, and is so called in honour of the Blessed Trinity, to signify that the works of our redemption and sanctification then completed, are common to all the three persons.

Q. What meaneth *Corpus Christi* day ?

A. It is a feast instituted by the church, in honour of of the body and blood of Christ, really present in the most holy sacrament of the Eucharist; during the octave of which feast, it is exposed to be adored by the faithful in all the principal churches of the world, and great processions are made in honour of it; and therefore is called *Corpus Christi day*, or the day of the body of Christ.

Q. What meaneth the transfiguration of our Lord ?

A. It is a feast in memory of our Saviour's transfiguring himself upon Mount *Tabor*, and showing a glimpse of his glory to his Apostles, *St. Peter*, *St. James*, and *St. John*. "And his face (saith the text) shone as the sun, and his garment became white as snow," &c. *Matt.* xvii. 2. And in them also unto us, for our encouragement to virtue, and perseverance in his holy faith and love. The etymology is obvious from *transfiguro*, to transfigure, or to change shape.

Q. What is *Sunday*, or the Lord's Day in general ?

A. It is a day dedicated by the Apostles to the honour of the most holy Trinity, and in memory that Christ our Lord arose from the dead upon *Sunday*, sent down the holy Ghost on a *Sunday*, &c. and therefore is called the Lord's Day. It is also called *Sunday* from the old *Roman* denomination of *Dies Solis*, the day of the sun, to which it was sacred.

Q. What are the four Sundays of Advent ?

A. They are the four Sundays preceeding *Christmas day*, and were so called by the church, in memory and honour of our Saviour's coming both to redeem the world by his birth in the flesh, and to judge the quick and the dead; from the Latin word *Adventus*, which signifies *Advent*, or coming.

A. It is the voice of men rejoicing, and aspiring to the joys of heaven.

Q. Why is the *Alleluiah* repeated so often at the feast of *Easter*?

A. Because it is the joyful solemnity of our Saviour's resurrection.

Q. Why between *Septuagesima* and *Easter*, is the *Tract* read in the place of the *Gradual*?

A. Because it is a time of penance and mourning: and therefore the *Tract* is read with a mournful and slow voice, to signify the miseries and punishments of this life.

Q. What is the *Tract*?

A. Two or three versicles between the Epistle and the Gospel, sung with a slow, long protracted tone.

Q. Why do we rise up at the reading of the *Gospel*?

A. To signify our readiness to go, and do, whither, and whatsoever it commands us.

Q. What means the *Gospel*?

A. It signifies the preaching of Christ; and is the happy embassy or message of Christ unto the world.

Q. Why is the *Gospel* read at the North end, or left side of the Altar?

A. To signify that by the preaching of the Gospel of Christ, the kingdom of the Devil was overthrow.

Q. How prove you that?

A. Because the Devil hath chosen the North (figuratively infidels, and the wicked) for the seat of his malice. "From the North shall all evil be opened upon all the inhabitants of the land." *Jer. i. 14. and Zach. ii. 7.*

Q. Why doth the priest before he begins the Gospel, salute the people with *Dominus vobiscum*?

A. To prepare them for a devout hearing of it, and to beg of our Lord to make them worthy hearers of his word, which can save their souls.

Q. Why then doth he say, *Sequentia sancti Evangelii*, &c. The sequel of the Holy Gospel, &c.?

A. To move attention, and to signify what part of the Gospel he then reads.

Q. Why doth the clerk answer, *Gloria tibi Domine. Glory be to thee, O Lord*?

A. To give the glory of the gospel to God, who hath of his mercy made us partakers of it.

Q. Why then doth the priest sign the book with the sign of the cross?

A. To signify that the doctrine there delivered, appertains to the cross and passion of Christ.

Q. Why after this do both priest and people sign themselves with the cross in three places?

A. They sign themselves on their foreheads, to signify they are not, nor will be ashamed to profess Christ crucified: on their mouths to signify they will be ready with their mouths, to confess unto salvation: and on their breast to signify that with their hearts they believe unto justice.

Q. Why at the end of the Gospel, do they sign their breast again with the sign of the cross?

A. That the Devil may not steal the seed of God's word out of their hearts.

Q. What means the Creed?

A. It is a public profession of our faith, and the whole some fruit of preaching the Gospel.

Q. What means the first offertory, where the priest offers bread and wine mingled with water?

A. It signifies the freedom wherewith Christ offered himself in his whole life unto his passion, and the desire he had to suffer for our sins.

Q. What signifies the mingling water with wine?

A. It signifies the blood and water flowing from the side of Christ; as also the union of the faithful with Christ.

Q. Why then doth the priest wash the ends of his fingers?

A. To admonish both himself and the people to wash away the unclean thoughts of their hearts, that so they may partake of that clean sacrifice: As also to signify, that the priest is, or ought to be clean from mortal sin.

Q. Why then after some silence, doth he begin the preface with an elevated voice, saying, *Per omnia secula seculorum?*

A. To signify the triumphant entry of Christ into Jerusalem, after he had lain hid a little space; &

therefore it is ended with *Hosanna, Benedictus qui venit*, &c. which was the *Hebrew* children's song.

Q. What else meaneth the preface?

A. It is a preparation of the people, for the approaching action of the sacrifice; and therefore the priest saith, *Sursum corda*, lift your hearts to God; so to move them to lay aside all earthly thoughts, and to think only on heavenly things.

Q. Why at these words, *Benedictus qui venit*, Blessed is he that cometh in our Lord's name, doth he sign himself with the sign of the cross?

A. To signify that the entry of Christ into *Jerusalem* was not to a kingdom of this world, but to a death upon the cross.

Q. What is the *Canon*?

A. It is a most sacred, essential, and substantial part of the mass, because in it the sacrifice is effected.

Q. Why is the *Canon* read with a low voice?

A. To signify the sadness in our Saviour's passion, which is there effectually represented.

Q. Why doth the priest begin the *Canon* bowing his head?

A. To signify the obedience of Christ unto his Father in making himself a sacrifice to sin.

Q. What meaneth the *Te-igitur, clementissime Pater*, &c. Thee therefore, O most clement Father, &c.?

A. It is an humble and devout supplication to God our heavenly Father, made in the name of all the people, that he would vouchsafe to accept and bless the sacrifice which we are offering unto him for the peace, unity and conversation of the whole Catholic Church, and likewise for the Pope, our prelate, and all other the truly faithful.

Q. Why in the middle of this prayer doth the priest kiss the altar, and sign the Host and Chalice thrice with the sign of the cross?

A. He kisseth the altar, to show the kiss of peace which Christ gave us, by reconciling us to God in his own blood. He signeth the Host and Chalice thrice to signify that our redemption made upon the Cross, was done by the will of the Holy Trinity.

Q. What meaneth the *Memento Domine famulorum famularumque tuarum*: Remember, O Lord, thy servants, men and women, &c.?

A. It is a commemoration of the living, in which the priest remembers by name, such as he intends chiefly to say mass for, and then in general, all present and all the faithful, beseeching God by virtue of the sacrifice, to bless them, and be mercifully mindful of them.

Q. What means the *Communicantes and memoriam venerantes*, &c. Communicating and worshipping the memory, &c.?

A. It is an exercise of our communion with the saints, in which having recounted the names of the blessed virgin *Mary*, and many other glorious saints, we beg of God by their merits and intercession, to grant us the assistance of his protection in all things.

Q. What signifies the *Hanc igitur oblationem*, this offering therefore of our servitude, &c. when the priest spreads his hands over the Host and Chalice?

A. It is an earnest begging of God to accept the sacrifice that is presented to be offered for the safety and peace of the whole church, and salvation of all from eternal damnation.

Q. Why then doth he sign the offerings again five times?

A. To signify the mystery of those five days which were between our Saviour's entry into *Jerusalem* and his passion.

Q. What meaneth *Qui pridie quam pateretur*, who the day before he suffered, &c.

A. It is but a repetition and representation of what Christ did at his last supper, where he took bread; blessed it, &c. and immediately precedes the words of consecration spoken by the priest, by which he sacrificeth to God.

Q. What are the words of consecration?

A. "*Hoc est corpus meum*, &c. This is my body; This is the cup of my blood, of the New and eternal Testament; a mystery of faith, which shall be shed for you, and for many, to the remission of sins." Matt. xxvi. 27, 28.

end also the church extinguisheth all her lights after some silence, at the end of the whole office, making a great and sudden noise, to represent the rending veil of the Temple. The darkness also signifies the dark time of the night wherein Christ was apprehended in the garden, and the noise signifies the noise made by the soldiers and catch-poles at their seizing on Saviour's person.

Q. What meaneth Rogation week, being the fifth Easter?

A. It is a week of public prayer and confession; the temperateness of the seasons of the year, and the fruitfulness of the earth, and it is called Rogation from the verb *Roga*, to *ask* by reason of the petitions made to God in that behalf.

Q. What means the *Quatuor tempora*, or four Ember weeks, or Ember Days?

A. Those are times also of public prayer, fasting processions partly instituted for the successful ordering of the priest and ministers of the church, and partly both to beg and render thanks to God for the fruitful blessings of the earth. And are called *Ember days*, *days of Ashes*, from the no less ancient than religious custom of using hair-cloth and ashes, in time of prayer and penance; or from the old custom of eating nothing on those days till night, and then only a cake baked under the embers or ashes, which was called *Panis, subcineritius*, or *Ember bread*.

Q. What mean the two *Holy Rood Days*?

A. Those are two ancient feasts: the one in memory of the miraculous invention, or finding out of the cross by *St. Helen*, mother of *Constantine* the great, after it had been hid and buried by the Infidels one hundred and eighty years, who had erected a statue of *Venus* in the place of it. The other in memory of the exaltation, or setting up the holy cross by *Heraclius* emperor, who having regained it a second time from the *Persians*, after it had been lost fourteen years, carried it on his own shoulders to Mount *Calvary*, there exalted it with great solemnity; and it is called *Holy Rood*, or *Holy Cross*, for the great sanctity

Q. Why then doth he again sign the offerings five times with the sign of the Cross?

A. To signify the five wounds of Christ, which he represents to the eternal Father for us.

Q. What means the *Memento*?

A. It is a commemoration of the dead; in which the priest first nominates those whom he intends especially to apply the sacrifice unto; and then prays in general for all the faithful departed, beseeching God by virtue of that sacrifice, to give them rest, refreshment, an everlasting life.

Q. Why after the *Memento* for the dead, doth the priest elevate or raise his voice, saying, *Nobis quoque peccatoribus*, "and to us sinners also," &c.?

A. In memory of the supplication of the penitent thief made to Christ on the Cross; that so we also (though unworthy sinners) by the virtue of the sacrifice may with him and all the holy saints, be made partakers of the heavenly kingdom.

Q. Why then doth he again sign the Host and Chalice three times with the sign of the Cross?

A. To signify, that this sacrifice is available for three sorts of men: for those in heaven, to the increase of glory; for those in purgatory, to free them from their pains; and for those on earth, to an increase of grace and remission of their sins; as also to signify the three hours which Christ did hang living upon the Cross, and all the griefs he sustained in them.

Q. Why then, uncovering the chalice, doth he sign it five times with the Host?

A. His uncovering the chalice is to signify, that at the death of Christ the veil of the temple was rent asunder. The three crosses made over the chalice, signify the three hours which Christ hung dead on the cross; the other two made at the brim of the chalice, signifying the blood and water flowing from his side.

Q. Why is the *Pater Noster* said with a loud voice?

A. To signify, by the seven petitions thereof, the seven mystical words which Christ spoke upon the Cross with a loud voice, viz. "Father, forgive them, *they know not what they do.* 2. 'To day shalt thou

with me in Paradise. 3. Behold thy mother; woman behold thy son. 4. My God, my God, why hast thou forsaken me. 5. I thirst. 6. Into thy hands I commend my spirit. 7. It is consummated."

Q. What means the priest laying down the Host upon the corporal, and then covering the chalice again?

A. It signifies the taking of our Saviour down from the Cross, and his burial.

Q. Why, then is the priest silent for a time?

A. To signify our Saviour's rest in the sepulchre on the Sabbath.

Q. Why is the Host divided into three parts?

A. To signify the division of our Saviour's soul and body made on the Cross, and that the body was broken, and divided in three principal parts, namely, his hands, side, and feet.

Q. Why after this doth he sign the chalice three times with a particle of the Host, and raise his voice, saying, *Pax Domini*, &c., The peace of our Lord be always with you?

A. To signify that the frequent voice of Christ to his disciples, *Pax vobis*, Peace be to you; as also to signify the triple peace which he hath purchased for us, by his Cross, namely, external, internal, and eternal.

Q. Why then is the particle of the Host put into the chalice?

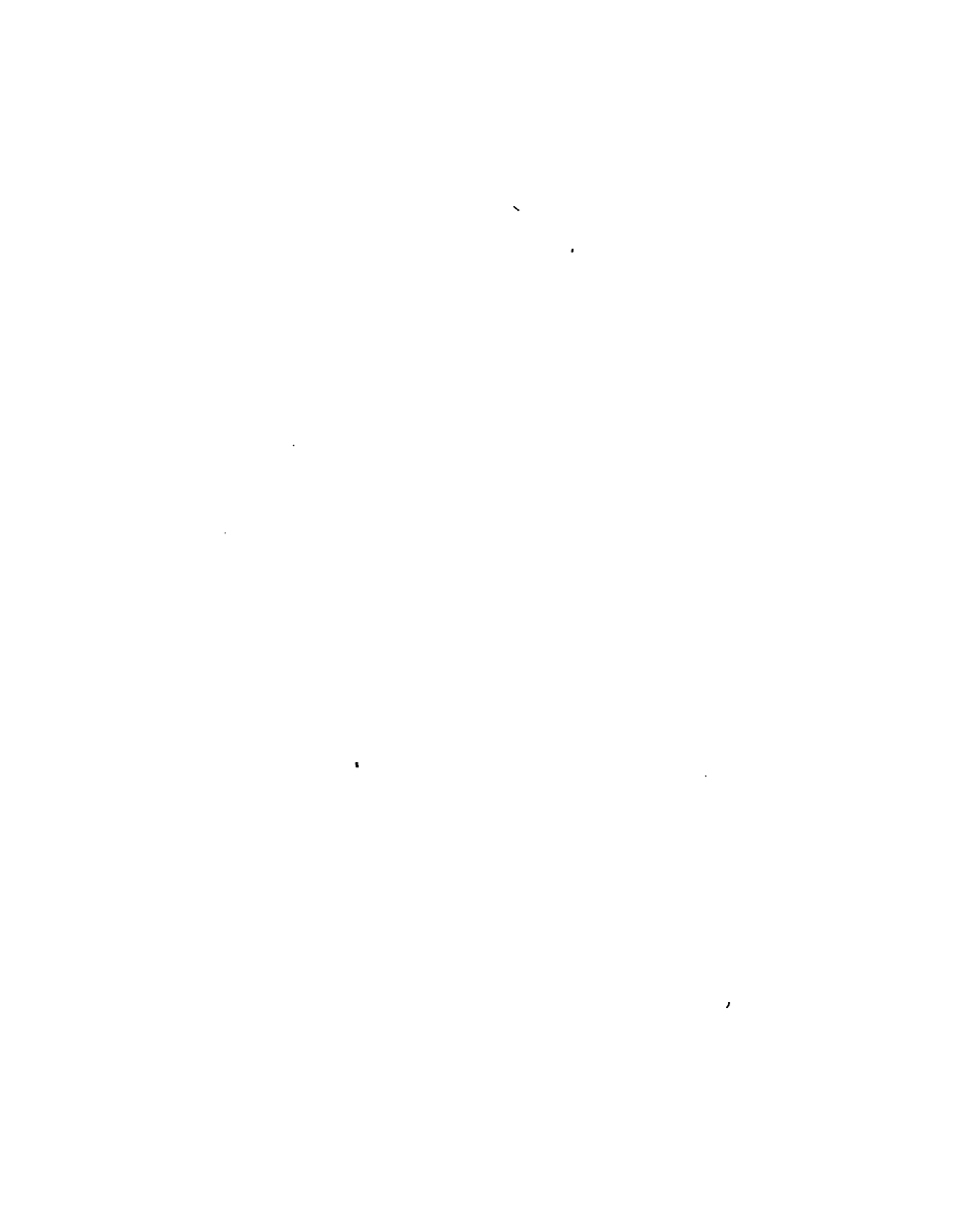
A. To signify the reuniting of our Saviour's body, blood and soul, made at his resurrection; as also to signify, that we cannot partake of the blood and merits of Christ, unless we partake of his cup of sufferings.

Q. Why is the *Agnus Dei*, or Lamb of God, which taketh away the sins of the world, said with a loud voice?

A. To commemorate the glory of our Saviour's ascension, and to signify that he was slain like an innocent lamb to take away our sins and give us peace.

Q. Why is the *Pax*, or kiss of peace, given before communion?

A. To signify, that peace and mutual charity, which ought to be among the faithful, who all eat of one bread of the Eucharist, and are all members of one mystical body.



A. It signifies the Apostles preaching the gospel to all nations. *Luke xxiv. 50.*

Q. What is the missal ?

A. It is the Mass book, wherein this holy service is contained.

CHAP. XXIII.

The Primer or Office of our Blessed Lady, Expounded.

Q. Who composed this office ?

A. The church, directed by the Holy Ghost ?

Q. Why is the Primer so called ?

A. From the Latin word *Primo*, which signifies, first of all, so to teach us, that prayer should be the first work of the day, according to that, "Seek ye first the kingdom of heaven, and all these things shall be given you."

Q. Why is the office divided into Hymns, Psalms, Canticles, Antiphons, Versicles, Responsories, and Prayers ?

A. For order, beauty, and variety sake.

Q. What warrant have you for that ?

A. Out of *Col. iii. 16.* "Sing ye in your hearts unto the Lord in spiritual Psalms, Hymns, and Canticles."

Q. Why should the laity pray out of the Psalms, which they little understand ?

A. 1. Because, by so doing, they pray out of the mouth of the Holy Ghost. 2. Because, if they do it with devout and humble hearts, it is as meritorious in them, as in the greatest scholars; for a petition hath the same force, whether it be delivered by a learned or unlearned man; so hath also prayer. 3. Because a psalm is of the same value in the sight of God, in the mouth of a child or woman, as from the mouth of the most learned doctor.

Q. Why is the office divided into seven several hours ?

A. That so it might be a daily memorial of the seven principal parts, and seven hours of our Saviour's passion.

Q. What ground have you for that ?

A. Out of *Zac. xii. 10.* "At that day I will pour

A. His drinking gall and vinegar, his dying on the Cross, and the opening his side with a spear.

Q. What by the even-song ?

A. His taking down from the Cross, and the darkness which was made upon the face of the earth.

Q. What by the *Complin* ?

A. His funeral and burial.

Briefly thus : The matins and lauds, his agony, and binding in the garden : the crime, his scoffs, and false accusations ; the third hour, his clothing with purple, and crowning with thorns ; the sixth hour, his condemning and nailing to the Cross ; the ninth hour, his yielding up the ghost, and the opening his side ; the even-song, his taking from the Cross ; and the complin, his burial.

The Particulars of the Office Expounded.

Q. WHY doth our Lady's office always begin with an *Ave Maria* ?

A. To dedicate the office of our Lady, and to beg her aid for the devout performance of it to God's honour.

Q. Why do we begin every hour with, *Incline unto my aid, O God : O Lord, make haste to help me* ?

A. To acknowledge our infirmity and misery, and our great need of divine assistance, not only in all other things, but also in our very prayers ; according to that of the Apostle, "No man can say Lord Jesus, but in the Holy Ghost."

Q. Why do we add to this, Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost ?

A. To signify that the intention of the office is, in the first place, to give one and equal glory to the most blessed Trinity, and to invite all creatures to do the like : this is the principal aim of the whole office ; therefore we not only begin every hour, but also end every *Psalm* with the same verse.

Q. Who ordained the *Gloria Patri* ?

A. The Apostles, according to *Baronius* in his 3d Tome.

Q. Why do we join unto the *Gloria Patri*, *Sicut erat, &c.* As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end ?

A. Because it was made by the Council of *Nice* against the *Arians*, who denied Christ to be coequal and consubstantial to his Father, or to have been before the blessed Virgin *Mary*.

Q. Why after this, for a great part of the year, and especially between Easter and Whitsuntide, do we say, Alleluia, Alleluia?

A. Because that is a time of joy, and Alleluia is a *Hebrew* word, signifying, "Praise ye the Lord with all joy, and exultation of heart."

Q. Why were it not better changed into *English*?

A. Because it is the language of the blessed in heaven, according to *Apoc.* viii. 6. Therefore the church hath forbidden it to be translated into any other language.

Q. Why in Lent, and some other times, do we say, instead of Alleluiah, "Praise be to thee, O Lord, King of eternal Glory?"

A. Because those are times of penance; therefore God must be praised rather with tears, than exultation.

Q. Why then do we always say, for the invitatory, Hail *Mary*, full of grace, the Lord is with thee?

A. To congratulate and renew the memory of our blessed Lady's joy, conceived at the conception of her Son Jesus: and to invite both men and angels to do the like.

Q. What signify the five verses following the invitatory, which begin, *Come let us exult unto our Lord*?

A. The five wounds of Christ, from which all our prayer hath its force and merit, and in honour of which all those versicles are said.

Q. What mean the Hymns?

A. They are a poetical expression of prerogatives and praises of the Blessed Virgin.

Q. Why are so many Psalms used in the office?

A. Because they are directed by the Holy Ghost, and do contain in a most moving manner, all the affections of piety and devotion.

Q. Why are there but three Psalms in the most of the hours?

A. In honour of the most blessed Trinity, to whom chiefly the whole office is addressed.

Q. Why was the office divided into so many hours ?

A. I have told you the chief reason already, and one other reason is, that so there might be no hour either by day or night, to which some hour of the office might not correspond.

Q. What do the matins correspond to ?

A. To the first, second, and third watch of the night, consisting of three hours each ; and therefore the matins consist of three psalms, and three lessons.

Q. What do the lauds correspond to ?

A. To the fourth watch of the night.

Q. What do the prime, the third, sixth, and ninth hours correspond to ?

A. To the third, sixth, and ninth hours of the day.

Q. What do the even-song and complin correspond to ?

A. To the evening.

Q. What means the benedictions, or blessings given before the lesson ?

A. They are short aspirations to beg divine assistance ; and the first is in honour of the Father, and the second in honour of the Son, the third in honour of the Holy Ghost.

Q. What doth the lesson contain ?

A. The mystical praises of our blessed Lady, taken out of the Prophets.

Q. Why do we end every lesson, saying, But thou, O Lord, have mercy upon us ?

A. To beg that the praises and virtues of the blessed Virgin, which we have there read, may be deeply settled in our hearts, and that God would pardon our former negligence, both in his and her service.

Q. Why is it answered, Thanks be to God ?

A. To render thanks to God for his mercy, in bestowing such a patroness on us as the blessed Virgin Mary.

Q. What means the responsories ?

A. They are so called, because they answer one another.

Q. What are the antiphons ?

A. The versicles which are begun before the Psalms.

Q. Why do we stand up at the Magnificat, Benedic-